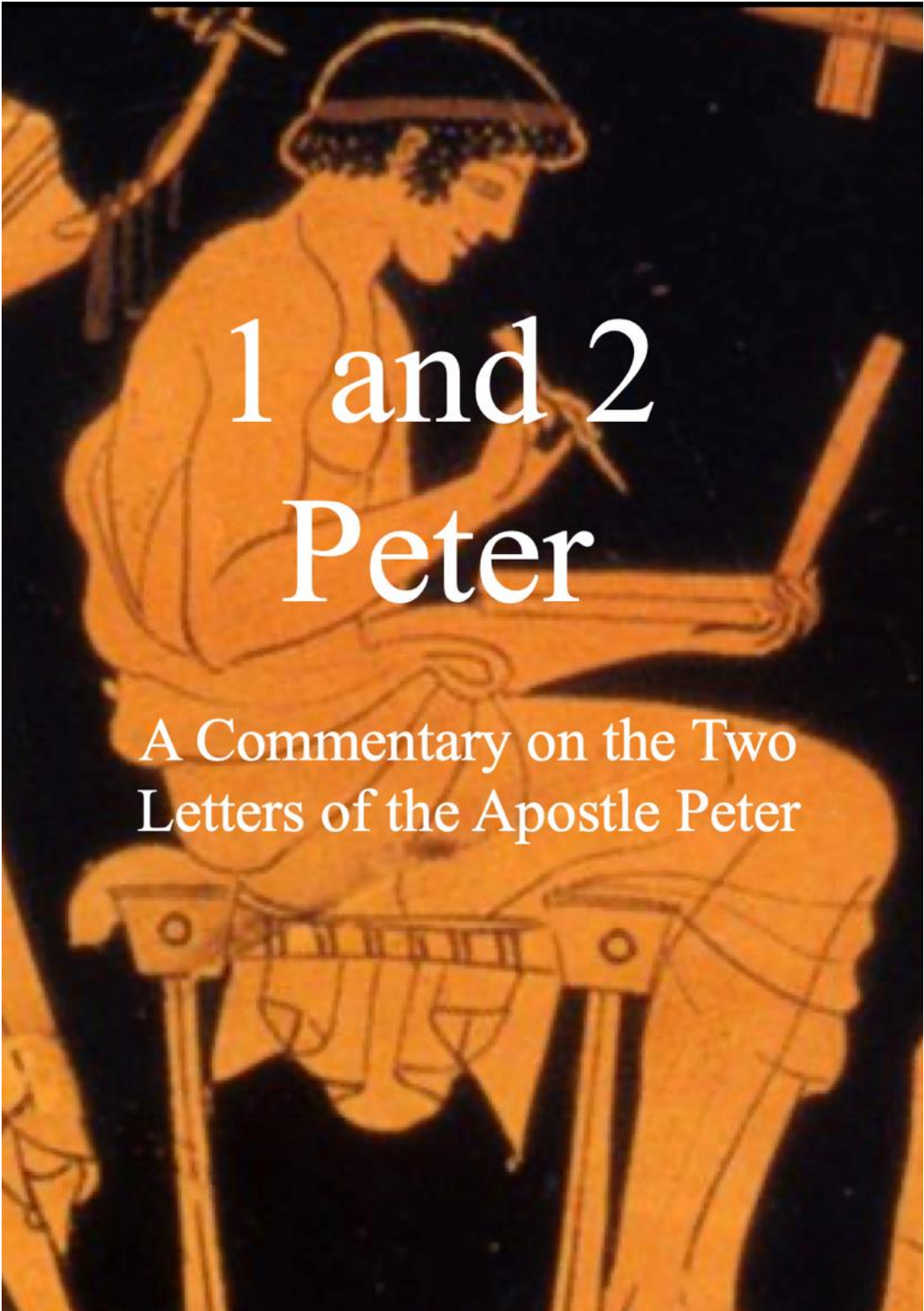


1 and 2 Peter

A Commentary on the Two Letters of the Apostle Peter

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Joshua M. Haub

Researched and Published Independently

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1 and 2 Peter: A Commentary on the Two Letters of the Apostle Peter

Joshua M. Haub
Year: 2026

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To those who reside as aliens, and to those who have received the same kind of faith as ours.

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Acknowledgements

This work would not have been possible without the express help of several individuals. Firstly, I want to thank those whose shoulders I stand on. Without them, this book would be a shell of what it is today. You may read this commentary (or glance at certain parts) and notice the vast number of footnotes, citations, allusions, and influence from other works which I have repeatedly noted time and time again. You may get tired of seeing a number at the end of almost every sentence. I assure you, those numbers are there for a reason.

For 1 Peter, this work would not have been possible without these commentaries:

For 2 Peter, this work would not have been possible without these commentaries: Richard J. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, WBC 50 (Waco, TX: Word, 1983); Michael Green, *2 Peter and Jude: An Introduction and Commentary*, Tyndale New Testament Commentaries 18 (Downers Grove: InterVarsity, 1987); Joseph B. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter* (London: Macmillan, 1907); and finally, Thomas R. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, New American Commentary 37 (Nashville: Broadman & Holman, 2003). I am deeply indebted to these for works. To them I owe a great deal of gratitude.

Secondly, I would like to thank several evangelists who have graciously given me permission to use (give them credit, more accurately) their material in this commentary. While it has been my usual practice in my various papers and other works to shy away from using my fellow evangelists' material and to stick with scholarly journals, books, and the like, I decided in this book to use what I thought my audience would find most helpful. The benefit of using the work of my fellow evangelists is their respective abilities to bring the text down to the applicable and relatable levels, at times even being more helpful than the many commentaries I read in writing this book.[1] I

1. I ought to note that the purpose of some of the commentaries I used is help readers understand the *text*, not make applications.

have also, per the SBL handbook (which I followed for my formatting), included links to the various sermons and Bible studies referenced in this work so you, the reader, can go back and hear them for yourself. I, therefore, want to personally thank *Jady Copeland*, *Lee Wildman*, *Gary Fisher*, *Andy Cantrell*, … for their immense work and help as I compiled this commentary. Without their insight and teaching, I would not feel as confident publishing this book.

Preface

1 and 2 Peter are two of the richest letters in the New Testament. However, it seems to me that both letters have been unintentionally degraded to "books of popular quotations" rather than two letters with specific agendas. Many cite the "Tested by Fire" motif in 1 Peter 1:7; large sections of chapter 2, such as the "Stone" motif and Christian realities (2:4-10), excellent attitude (2:11-12), submission (2:13-20) which climax in Jesus' attitude (2:21-25); husbands and wives (3:1-7); apologetics (3:15); baptism (3:18-22); suffering (4:12-19); anxiety (5:7); and Satan as a lion (5:8-9). While these are all pieces of the puzzle of 1 Peter, simply quoting these sections without diving into 1 Peter does them a disservice. 1 Peter was not written to be cherry picked but to be read in its own context.

The same goes for 2 Peter. Often it is quoted for its sections on the Transfiguration (1:16-18); prophecy (1:20-21); false teaching (chapter 2); falling away (2:21-22); the second coming of Jesus (3:3-15a); and perhaps the most quoted section of the letter, the reference to Paul and his work which is equated with "Scripture" (3:15b-16). Like 1 Peter, 2 Peter has an audience and a *specific* message. These are *letters*, after all, not divine motivation quotebooks meant for motivational speeches.

It seems to me that since 1 and 2 Peter are quoted so often, a detailed analysis of both has gone by the waste side. Many feel that they understand the letters well, and perhaps they do. However, I believe a comprehensive commentary on both letters would do much good for both the reader and I.

My hope is that by writing this commentary, you will grow in your knowledge and understanding of these two letters. Any and all errors found within are my own. May God be glorified in this work.

To Him Be the Glory,
Joshua M. Haub

Author Notes

There are some important notes that I want to address before you begin reading this commentary.

1. *Type of Commentary*. This is a "Expositional" commentary, although I do not try to fit within a single defined type of commentary. I try to both give technical information about Greek words, background, and utilize sources that are considered "Technical" commentaries. However, I also used other types of sources and include practical applications.
2. *Approach to the Text*. It may be that some of my readers come from a more "devotional" background when it comes to understanding and applying the text. I do as well. However, in this work, I have taken a much more "academic" approach. That is not to say that there is not "devotional material" (such as application, admonition, and exhortation) but instead that I deal more with Academia and its theories about things concerning the *meaning* of the text. The reader may feel bogged down with "this scholar" or "that scholar," "this theory" or "that theory." The point is not that these scholars hold the keys to all understanding of the text, or that one can only understand with their help, but rather that they can provide helpful insight into the text that may be allusive to a reader who is not versed in the world of the early Christians.
3. *Probability over Certainty*. At the outset, I want to make it clear that I do not work with "absolute" conclusions. I much prefer to use the statements "probable," "probably," "likely," etc. This is because I do not believe that there are "absolute" conclusions for many of my beliefs explained in this commentary. That is not to say I do not believe in absolute *truth*, only that I wish to exercise epistemic humility in saying that I very well could be wrong about many of the things I claim are true concerning

these two letters. This also falls under point 2 in which I am working within the realm of Academia.

4. *Greek Words*. I have chosen to render Greek words using the Greek alphabet instead of transliterating into English letters. I have chosen to do so because I prefer reading the Greek words as they appear in the Greek text. At every point I include a new Greek word, I have also included its English translation. In the back of this commentary, I have a glossary of all the Greek words used. If you come to a Greek word and would like the English translation, please refer to the Glossary (pp. 122ff). While my translations (sticking to the NASB95) can be helpful, I highly recommend getting a Greek lexicon to have alongside this commentary. I highly recommend the newest editions of Nestle-Aland and United Bible Society, respectively.
5. *Exegesis*. For most sections, the way I organize the discussion usually starts with my thoughts and then others. At times, I quote other works without offering my own thoughts on them. I even go so far as to include multiple conflicting interpretations without comments on which I think is the correct one. This is because I want to offer ideas for you to digest so you can come to your *own* conclusions. You may disagree with me at times and instead agree with an alternative interpretation I have included. I have included those alternative interpretations because I believe the more angles utilized, the better the discussion.

About the Author

Joshua M. Haub was born and raised in Columbus, Indiana, and worshiped with the Lakeview church. He is currently a student at Florida College in Temple Terrace, Florida, studying Communication and Biblical Studies. He is an evangelist at the Lake Gibson church in Lakeland, Florida. He has been teaching the gospel for 5 years, including working with Ryan Boyer in Ellisville, Missouri, during the summer of 2024; working in Harrisburg, Pennsylvania, during the summer of 2025 with Scott Smelser and Stephen Rouse; and working with Andy Cantrell, Caleb Daniels, and Rick Lanning in New Hope, Minnesota, during the summer of 2026. He can be reached at haubfam2@gmail.com.

Introduction

The reader may be wondering: Why introduce a commentary on 1 and 2 Peter by discussing bilingualism, literacy, Greek rhetoric, and canonicity? What is not immediately apparent is how these four topics *directly* affect one's understanding of 1 and 2 Peter. More specifically, how one understands the authorship of both these letters, and thus whether or not the letters hold the authority to be regarded as "part of God's word," that is, part of the NT canon.

To be a bit clearer, and to say it another way, if Peter wrote these two letters, then what was his linguistic background?[1] These two letters were written in Greek.[2] Did Peter speak Greek? Was he even literate (that is, "able to read")? If he was both able to speak Greek and read Greek, where did he learn it? Even more complex than simply reading a language is *writing* it. Did Peter know how to write Greek? What about the Greek styles of rhetoric in which these two letters are written in? If the answer to these questions is *no*, then what are the consequences that conclusion has on the canonicity of 2 Peter?

There has been decades of debate on these topics and how they apply to the apostle Peter and his letters. I do not wish here to say anything specific about Peter's abilities as it pertains to the four sections below, but I do wish to expose the reader to the evidence that can be gathered from the 1st century concerning some generalities about these four topics as they pertain to the culture(s) at large.

I hope by now, one can see that these four coming sections are not an aside or pointless introduction. Rather, they are the bedrock for arguably the most pressing matter with these two letters: Who wrote 1 and 2 Peter?[3]

---

1. In this commentary, I will be avoiding the argument that Peter was able to write these letters because he was "divinely inspired." In my opinion, this argument has little weight to it because we do not know *how* inspiration worked. Additionally, it appears that the Holy Spirit allowed the distinct personalities and abilities of the authors He used to shine through "inspiration," such as Hebrews good Greek versus the Gospel of John's simple Greek and Paul's personal opinion in 1 Corinthians 7. However, the apostles receiving the gift of tongues in Acts 2 may need consideration alongside what I will argue in this book.

2. Some believe 2 Peter was originally written in Aramaic, see entry in 2 Peter Introduction.

3. For specific arguments for/against Petrine authorship, see the introduction for each letter, respectively.

Canonicity

The reader may be asking him or herself, "Why is there a section of the introduction to 1 and 2 Peter dedicated to the discussion of Canonicity? What does that have to do with 1 and 2 Peter?" I assure you, it has everything to do with 1 and 2 Peter. Often overlooked but deeply important to the question of authorship for *each* of the NT books, especially those whose authorships are questioned by many scholars, is the question of canonicity. What is its importance? The issue of canon is one that has to do with *authority*. If the canon is "a closed list of authoritative, sacred texts" coming from apostolic figures (such as Matthew, John, etc.) and holds their authority (given to them by Jesus), then the question of canon is deeply connected with the question of authorship.[4] Let me say it in another, simpler, and more straightforward way, "If Peter is not the author of 1 and 2 Peter, then why is it in our New Testament canon? Can these letters hold divine authority without being apostolic? If so, when (and how) were they given that authority? And if it should not be in our New Testament canon, then should we be reading it as if it was divinely inspired and has the same authority as the actually-divinely-inspired books of the canon?" This is a serious question. There is yet another question we must ask, *"Did the church fathers get it wrong?"*

1. What is "Canon"?

Before talking more specifically about the canonicity of 1 and 2 Peter, I would like to back up and explain what this discussion is about; namely, what *is* "canon"? The very first thing someone needs to know about the discussion of canon in biblical scholarship is "that 'much of the present confusion over the problem of canon turns on the failure to reach an agreement regarding the terminology.'"[5]

Before continuing, I would like the reader to know I am by no means covering everything that could be said about "canon." I am leaving many, many details out in hopes of offering a concise, only-the-

4. For my definition of "canon," I am indebted to one of my undergraduate professors.

5. Brevard Childs as qtd. in Michael J. Kruger, *Canon Revisited: Establishing the Origins and Authority of the New Testament Books* (Wheaton, IL: Crossway, 2012), 27. For a detailed and helpful analysis of different "canonical models" (that is, how people evaluate what should be part of the NT), see in Kruger's book, *Part 1: Determining the Canonical Model*, 25-122.

necessary-details-for-our-discussion analysis. If you, the reader, would like to read more on the canon, see footnote here.[6]

I referenced a definition in the last section, but let me restate it and dive into what it means. I defined "canon" as "a closed list of authoritative, sacred texts." What I mean is that the concept of "canon" refers to a closed list to which no new works is being added to, and these works are authoritative (meaning, perhaps among other things, that "we ought to obey it"). Thus in the context of the Bible, the "NT canon" refers to the twenty-seven books (Matthew-Revelation) and implicit in the terminology is that there *will never be* a "twenty-eighth book."

The word "canon" itself comes from a Greek word meaning "standard" or "rule" (see 2 Cor 10:13-16; Gal 6:16).[7] This Greek word is κανών and is used four times in the NT (three times in 2 Cor 10:13-16 and once in Gal 6:16). However, these passages are not necessarily using the term the same as modern scholars.[8]

2. "Canon" in Early Church Fathers

Seeing as my goal here is to show how the discussion of "canon" relates to 1 and 2 Peter and not to give a detailed analysis of the canon itself, I will summarize and briefly touch on the necessary portions of the vast array of debate and history.

How does one go about determining what is canonical and what is not? One needs a criteria. *The* criteria the early church fathers used to determine if a book was canonical was apostolic authorship/authority.[9] This means that for a book to be considered canonical it had to come

6. One ought to start by reading Bruce M. Metzger, *The Canon of the New Testament: Its Origin, Development, and Significance* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1987). Also check out M. Kruger, *Canon Revisited* (2012) for a helpful discussion and rebuttal of poorly established canonical models.

7. For much of what follows, I am indebted to my professors and undergraduate work.

8. It is said that Athanasius (4th century) was the first person to use the term to refer to a "canon of sacred scripture" (see Decrees of the Synod of Nicaea 18).

9. See M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," *JETS* 42, no. 4 (December 1999): 646-647, where he footnotes: "Bruce M. Metzger (*The New Testament: Its Background, Growth and Content* [New York: Abingdon, 1965] 276) declares that 'the chief criterion for acceptance of particular writings as sacred, authoritative, and worthy of being read in services of worship was apostolic *authorship*'" (italics added). Kruger also writes on p. 646-647: "There seems to be little dispute that apostolic *authority* was an essential criterion of canonicity for the early church" (italics added).

from (or use the authority of) an apostle. This is a very good criteria because it narrows the scope of possible works to only those with divine authority. Here is where the debate escalates, however. *What does this criteria actually mean*?

There are scholars today who are challenging our understanding of this criteria. To frame this, let us use 2 Peter.[10] Many scholars view 2 Peter was pseudepigrapha (meaning, the Apostle Peter did not truly write it. Instead, someone else did but used his name). How does this work with the criteria of the early church fathers? How could 2 Peter be in the canon *and simultaneously* not be written by an apostle? There are many arguments people use. K. Aland seems to suggest that some pseudepigraphal works are included in the NT not because they were written by their supposed author but because early Christians *believed* they were.[11] Others suggest that the letter "was composed in Peter's name to *convey his authority* to the next generation (or generations)."[12] Richard Bauckahm, whose 2 Peter commentary is considered to be one of the best, suggests that the letter may be written by a colleague of Peter in the Roman church using the "testament genre" for the purpose of "defend[ing] the ethical and eschatological teaching of the apostles, whom he [the author] regards as united in preaching the same message."[13] Bauckham then says, "To write Peter's testament he really only needed to be sure he was representing correctly the message Peter shared with all the apostles."[14] Why write in this genre? "Possibly an intention of writing not as an individual but as representing the Roman church and therefore under the name of its greatest leader [Peter]. More

10. I revisit canonicity for 2 Peter in Excursus B. Much of what follows is imported here from that discussion.

11. K. Aland, "The Problem of Anonymity and Pseudonymity in Christian Literature of the First Two Centuries," *JTS* n.s. 12, no. 1 (April 1961): 39-49 (49).

12. So Thomas R. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, NAC 37 (Nashville: Broadman & Holman, 2003), 255. Italics added.

13. See Richard J. Bauckham, "Authorship and Pseudonymity" in *Jude, 2 Peter*, vol. 50 of *Word Biblical Commentary* (Dallas: Word, Incorporated, 1983) 158-162 (160-161). Earlier, Bauckham said of the genre: "Second Peter bears so many marks of the testament genre (especially the conventional testamentary language in 1:12-15) that readers familiar with the genre must have expected it to be fictional, like other examples they knew. If they knew that it came from the Petrine circle in Rome…, then they might trust its author to have made a good job of reporting the essence of Peter's teaching, but they would not expect Peter to have written it. At any rate the presumption would be that he had not" (p. 134).

14. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 160, which he says in the context of specific Petrine material used in the book, which Bauckham thinks is lacking besides a few places.

certainly, the intention of defending the apostolic message in a postapostolic age"[15] Thus the author of 2 Peter was attempting to "remind" (to use the language of 2 Peter) his readers of the apostolic message (of the past).[16] And what about the author's authority? It "lies in the faithfulness with which he transmits, and interprets for a new situation, the normative teaching of the apostles. 'Peter's testament' is the ideal literary vehicles for these intentions."[17]

Bauckham then addresses our question head on,

> The pseudepigraphal device is therefore *not* a fraudulent means of claiming apostolic authority, but embodies a claim to be *a faithful mediator* of the apostolic message. Recognizing the canonicity of 2 Peter means recognizing the validity of that claim, and it is not that this is so alien to the early church's criteria of canonicity as is sometimes alleged…. What the church actually recognized in 2 Peter was its *apostolic content*…. There is no reason why 2 Peter should not hold an honorable place in the *canon of Scripture*.[18]

There is more to Bauckham's arguments, but this is sufficient for our discussion.

I suspect by now you, the reader, can see the arguments some scholars use to suggest that a book is pseudepigrapha *and* still worthy of being in the NT canon. However, there is a fundamental issue we need to note: *what did the church fathers think about pseudepigrapha*?[19]

It seems to me that Serapion (c. 180 AD) and his rejection of the *Gospel According to Peter* offers a helpful point of reference for what the church fathers (and early Christians) believed about pseudepigrapha. Serapion wrote, "We receive both Peter and the other apostles as Christ, but the writings which *falsely bear their name* (ψευδεπίγραφα [pseudepigrapha]) we reject."[20] Bart Ehrman also, "Indeed, despite its

15. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 161.
16. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 161.
17. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter,* 161.
18. R. Bauckhma, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 161-162. Italics added.
19. For a more detailed discussion, see T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, and Jude*, 270-274, and Donald Guthrie, *New Testament Introduction*, 4th rev. ed. (Downers Grove, IL: InterVarsity Press, 1990), 1011-1028.
20. Serapion as qtd. in M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," 647. Italics added. For more on Serapion and also the example of the strong rejection of the pseudepigraphal *3 Corinthians*, see R. Guthrie, *New Testament Introduction*, 1015-1022.

common occurrence, forgery was almost *universally* condemned by ancient authors."[21] To put it another way, perhaps it is appropriate to say that the early church fathers viewed pseudepigrapha as we view works today which claim to be written by someone they are not: lying. Pseudepigrapha is lying. There is more to say about this, but what I want to impress upon the reader is this:

The claim that pseudepigrapha was willingly accepted into the New Testament by early church fathers is wrong.

In my opinion, there is no way around this. Either 1 and 2 Peter were written by Peter and should be canonical, or it is pseudepigrapha and the early church fathers were deceived.[22] Without Petrine authorship, I must agree with G. Klein who "say[s] that it is unfortunate the letter was even included in the canon."[23] If 1 and 2 Peter were not written by the apostle Peter, then the early church fathers *got it wrong*. And if that is the case, 1 and 2 Peter ought not be found within the bounds of our NT.

Do you, the reader, now see the seriousness of canonicity in regard to the discussion of 1 and 2 Peter? The discussion of the authorship of these two letters is bigger than simply "Bible trivia." This is a matter of what books we believe are canonical and, by extension, inspired and therefore God's word.

Bilingualism

Let us begin examining more specific evidence for Petrine authorship. Before we can even evaluate the evidence from the text itself, we must begin with the most fundamental question: *Could Peter even speak Greek?* (Mark 5:41)

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21. B. Ehrman as qtd. in M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," 648. Italics added.

22. As footnoted before, Bauckham suggests that the original audience would have understood the testament genre and known Peter did not write it. My question: Where is the evidence of this claim? If Bauckham is correct, why is there so much debate over authenticity rather than a more outspoken voice saying, "This is written in the testament genre and not by the apostle Peter"? See Schreiner's discussion of the testament genre in which he deems Bauckham's theory as failed, T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, and Jude*, 274-276. Guthrie concludes his discussion of pseudepigraphy by saying, "The only conclusion to which the evidence would seem to point is that if pseudepigrapha must on the basis of criticism be admitted within the New Testament canon, they must have been received without their recipients being aware of their true character. If this is a valid conclusion the charge of deliberate deception can scarcely be avoided." See R. Guthrie, *New Testament Introduction*, 1020.

23. G. Klein as noted in T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, and Jude*, 265.

Literacy in Galilee: Could Peter Read and Write?

If it is acceptable that Peter could have spoken Greek, the next question that must be addressed is whether Peter was literate and could write.

1. Hints and References to Literacy in the NT

Consider the following[24]:

1. Jewish religious leaders:
    a. Knew *written* Torah (Matt 2:3-6)
    b. Knew *written* Torah but medium unstated (Matt 19:7; 22:24; Mark 12:18-19; Mark 12:32-33; Luke 20:28; John 7:51-52)
    c. Read *written* Torah (Matt 12:2-3, 5, and probably 7; Luke 10:26-27; John 5:39)
    d. Read other writings (John 19:21)
    e. Knew the law, probably the *written* Torah, though the medium is not stated (Mark 2:24)
    f. Called "experts" by Jesus (Mark 7:9)
    g. Questioned Jesus on 'law' (Matt 22:17; Mark 12:14; Luke 20:22)
    h. Knew stories and people from the *written* Torah but medium unstated (John 8:33, 39, 52-53, 57; 9:28-29)
2. Jesus:
    a. Knew *written* Torah but medium unstated (Matt 4:4, 7, 10; 11:10; 19:18-19; 22:37, 39, 43-44; 24:15; 26:24, 31, 54; Mark 10:19; 11:17; 12:35-36; 14:27; Luke 4:4, 8, 12; 7:27; 16:16-17; 18:20; 19:46; 20:17, 37, 41-44; 22:37; 24:25-27, 44-47; John 6:45; 7:38; 13:18; 15:25; 17:12)
    b. Read from *written* Torah (Luke 4:16-21; 6:3-4)

24. Here, "Torah" simply refers to the OT, also called the Hebrew Bible. Additionally, "medium" here refers to the *way* a person or group learned the OT. Perhaps they read it, heard it in the synagogue, or another way. Just because a person 'knew' something was in the OT does not necessarily mean they were able to *read* it.

c. Knew stories and people from the *written* Torah but medium unstated (Matt 12:39-42; Luke 4:25-27; 11:51; 12:27; 13:16, 28; 16:23, 29-31; 17:27-29, 32; 19:9; John 3:14; 6:32; 8:37, 39-40, 44[25], 56, 58)
d. Critiqued the religious leaders for their lack of understanding what they *read* in the written Torah (Matt 12:2-3, 5; 19:4-5; 21:16, 42; 22:29, 31-32; Mark 2:25-26; 12:10-11, 24, 26, 29-31; Luke 6:3-4)
e. Critiqued others based on *written* Torah but medium of how He knew it is unstated (Matt 21:13; John 5:39, 45-46, 7:19, 22-23; 10:34-35)
f. Critiqued religious leaders for neglecting 'the law,' possibly *written* Torah (Matt 15:3-4, 7-9; 23:23; Mark 7:6-8, 9-10)
g. Knew the law, probably the *written* Torah, though the medium is not stated (Mark 3:4)
h. Questions the religious leaders on matters of 'law' (Luke 6:9; 14:3)

3. Jewish crowds and others:
    a. Knew written Torah *orally* (Matt 5:21, 27, 31, 33, 38, 43; Luke 24:32, 45; John 12:34)
    b. Knew *written* Torah and prophecies through an unstated medium (21:9; Mark 11:9-10; John 6:14, 31; 7:26-27, 31, 40-42)
    c. Knew the law, probably the *written* Torah, though the medium is not stated (John 19:7)
    d. "Many" Jews "near [Jerusalem]" could *read* signs (John 19:20)
4. Government officers and agents:
    a. Could write (Matt 27:37; John 19:19, 21-22)
5. Satan:

25. Perhaps "He was a murderer from the beginning" is a reference to the story in Genesis 3?

   a. Knew *written* Torah through an unstated medium (Matt 4:6; Luke 4:10-11)
6. The authors of NT books[26]:
   a. Matthew (Matt 1:22-23; 2:15; 2:17-18; 2:23?; 3:3; 4:14-16; 8:17; 12:17-21; 13:35; 21:4-5; 27:9-10)
   b. Mark (Mark 1:2-3)
   c. Luke (Luke 2:23-24; 3:4-6)
   d. John[27] (John 1:17; 4:5-6; 12:14-15, 38-41; 19:24, 28, 36-37)
7. Zacharias:
   a. Prophesied about what 'God's holy prophets' said, but the medium of how he knew is not stated (save the Holy Spirit, Luke 1:67) (Luke 1:70-71, possibly 76 and 79)
8. John the Baptist
   a. Knew *written* Torah but medium unstated (John 1:23)
9. 12 Apostles
   a. Knew *written* Torah but medium unstated (John 2:17, 22)
   b. Did not understand *written* Torah (John 20:9)
10. Woman at the well
   a. Knew stories and characters from the OT but medium unspecified (John 4:12)
   b. Knew OT prophecy but medium unstated (John 4:25, 29[28])
11. Possible illusions and inferences:
   a. Jesus and the Pharisees knew *written* Torah, but the medium through which they knew it is not specified (Matt 9:13; Mark 10:2-8)

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26. Since these authors could write, I have presumed here that they could also *read* the OT.

27. Sometimes John quotes from the OT but sometimes makes references to characters and stories.

28. The woman telling the city about the "possible Christ" suggests they too knew about the prophecies of him. Again, medium is unstated.

b. John the Baptist knew *written* Torah through an unstated medium (Matt 11:3-5)
c. Scribes read written Torah and then spoken *orally* (Matt 17:10)

Note: I did not include any quotations, citations, or allusions to the OT that may be made in passing (e.g., Mark 3:12). This is because I wanted the list to be *explicit* references to the literacy of those in the 1st century, with some exceptions. A simple Internet search or Bible software may illuminate more passages that could be used alongside this list. Also, parallel passages in the Gospels are included separately, so one occasion may have multiple references above, let the reader understand. Finally, passages that are textually questionable are left out (e.g., Mark 15:28).

TEXT

Peter and Rome: Where Did He Learn Greek Rhetoric?

TEXT

1 PETER

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Introduction to 1 Peter

"Peter, an apostle"

Test

External Evidence

Text

Internal Evidence

Text

Excursus A

The Communication of 1 and 2 Peter: How Different Are They?[*]

Over time, the authorship claims of several New Testament books have come into question. Of all the letters attributed to Paul, only seven are considered by some scholars to be genuine. 1 and 2 Peter are among the other "questioned" letters. Who wrote these two letters? Did one person write both or was it two separate individuals? Both are attributed to Peter, but did he pen them, have them penned, or do they simply hold his authority? Richard Bauckham writes, "It can safely be said that if 1 and 2 Peter had been anonymous documents, no one would have thought of attributing them to a single author."[1] But is Bauckham correct? While the question of authorship cannot be solved *solely* on the basis of the way both letters communicate, these two letters can be shown to be deeply connected in important ways which suggests they may be from a single source.

The Internal Similarities, Differences, and Connections

I. First Peter

Joseph Mayor notes that, "The style of 1 P. is clearer and simpler than that of 2 P., but there is not that chasm between them which some would try to make out."[2] He continues, "As to the use of the article, they [1 and 2 Peter] resemble one another more than any other book of

* Originally written as a paper, Joshua M. Haub, "The Communication of 1 and 2 Peter: How Different Are They?" (unpublished senior paper, Florida College, 2026), 1–26. It has been adapted for this commentary. For paper edition, see https://joshuahaub.com/peter/communication-of-1-and-2-peter/.

1. Richard J. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, WBC 50 (Waco, TX: Word Books, 1983), 145.

2. Joseph B. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter: Greek Text with Introduction, Notes, and Comments* (London: Macmillan and Co., 1907), civ.

the N.T."[3] Mayor works through several more grammatical characteristics and notes that they are very similar to one another.[4] Mayor does note, however, that 2 Peter is much more ambiguous and difficult than 1 Peter. Mayor concludes by stating, "On the whole I should say that the difference of style is less marked than the difference in vocabulary, and that again less marked than the difference in matter, while above all stands the great difference in thought, feeling, and character, in one word of personality."[5]

William Dalton shows how 1 and 2 Peter are connected by examining how 2 Peter interprets 1 Peter 3:19 and 4:6. Before he discusses those passages, Dalton convincingly shows, "Great similarity in ideas and structure between 1 Pet [3:13-4:11] and 2 Pet [2:1-3:18]."[6] Then, he turns to 1 Peter 3:19 and 4:6. Dalton notes that 1 Peter 3 is closely associated with 2 Peter 2 and that 1 Peter 3:19's "spirits in prison" is parallel with "angels…committed…to pits of darkness" in 2 Peter 2:4. Dalton believes that 1 Peter 3:19-20 is a source for 2 Peter 2:4-5. 2 Peter 2:4-5 shows that 1 Peter 3:19-20 must be in reference to a proclamation to "sinful angels, a message that cannot be one of salvation."[7] Less convincing is his explanation of 1 Peter 4:6. He explains that this passage is connected with 2 Peter 3:7-12, stating that the "dead" in 1 Peter 4:6 are the Christians of 2 Peter, "Who accept the reality of the Lord's promise 'of new heavens and a new earth in which righteousness dwells' ([3:9-13])."[8]

II. Second Peter

G. H. Boobyer discusses how 2 Peter is indebted to 1 Peter. Boobyer sees 2 Peter 3:1f as a reference to 1 Peter 1:10-12. He cites B. Weiss'

3. J. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, civ.
4. J. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, civ.
5. J. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, cv.
6. William J. Dalton, "The Interpretation of 1 Peter 3,19 and 4,6: Light from 2 Peter," *Biblica* 60, no. 4 (1979): 551.
7. W. Dalton, "The Interpretation of 1 Peter 3,19 and 4,6: Light from 2 Peter," 553.
8. W. Dalton, "The Interpretation of 1 Peter 3,19 and 4,6: Light from 2 Peter," 554.

view that when it comes to general Christian teachings, "'No document in the New Testament is so like 1 Peter as 2 Peter.'"[9] Boobyer also cites Mayor's list of parallels between the two letters: The Second Coming, Noah and seven persons being saved from the flood, μακροθυμία ("patience") in 2 Peter 3:15 and 1 Peter 3:20, and "Prophecy as a divinely inspired foretelling of Gospel events now announced by apostles."[10] Also, note the exact reduplication of 1 Peter 1:2 and 2 Peter 2:2: "χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη πληθυνθείη," translated, "Grace to you and peace be multiplied."[11] Boobyer notes that πληθυνθείη "As the verb of a NT formula of greeting occurs only in 1 and 2 Peter and Jude."[12] Boobyer insightfully comments that in the pursuit of establishing authorship for 2 Peter, many have either overstressed the resemblances with 1 Peter or exaggerated the disconnections depending on who they believe wrote 2 Peter.[13] He goes on to note how 1 Peter 1:3-9 and 2 Peter 1:3-11 seem to be closely connected. While this connection seems less satisfactory, the other data he provides is helpful in showing some of the similarities between the passages. Besides those already mentioned, he also sees connections between 1 Peter 1:10-12 and 2 Peter 1:12-21, and 1 Peter 5:1 with 2 Peter 1:16-18.

Donald Guthrie provides a helpful analysis of Boobyer's work. In one section, Guthrie examines Boobyer's evidence that 2 Peter is literarily dependent on 1 Peter. Guthrie notes, "His [Boobyer's] justification for maintaining a literary dependence is based on his acceptance of 2 Peter's literary use of Jude."[14] At this point, Guthrie

9. G. H. Boobyer, "The Indebtedness of 2 Peter to 1 Peter," in *New Testament Essays: Studies in Memory of Thomas Walter Manson, 1893–1958*, ed. A. J. B. Higgins (Manchester: Manchester University Press, 1959), 35.

10. G. H. Boobyer, "The Indebtedness of 2 Peter to 1 Peter," 35.

11. The Greek here is Barbara Aland et al., eds., *Novum Testamentum Graece*, 28th rev. ed. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2012), 696. The English is Robert Young, trans., *The Holy Bible: Consisting of the Old and New Covenants; Translated according to the Letter and Idioms of the Original Languages*, rev. ed. (Edinburgh: G. A. Young & Co., 1898; repr., Grand Rapids: Baker Book House, 1997), 1 Peter 1:2.

12. G. H. Boobyer, "The Indebtedness of 2 Peter to 1 Peter," 39.

13. G. H. Boobyer, "The Indebtedness of 2 Peter to 1 Peter," 36.

14. Donald Guthrie, *New Testament Introduction*, 4th rev. ed. (Downers Grove, IL: InterVarsity Press, 1990), 852.

presses, "His evidence here would equally well support the contention that the same author wrote both 1 and 2 Peter, for in that case we should expect the kind of parallels to which he refers."[15] Then, he questions Boobyer's view that 2 Peter is pseudepigrapha yet 2 Peter 1:12-13 overflows from 1 Peter 1:10-12. Guthrie asserts, "This could equally well have happened in the mind of one man through association of ideas, as in two minds with one drawing from another."[16]

Richard Bauckham maintains that the two letters have different styles and vocabularies, which has been noted since Jerome.[17] Bauckham states that the most important differences in the two letters "Are not those of grammar and style but thought, themes, theological terminology…"[18] For more of Bauckham's observations, see *The Greek of 1 and 2 Peter* below.

III. Conclusion

There are many similarities and differences between these two letters. Boobyer is correct that both sides of the authorship debate surrounding 2 Peter must examine the evidence honestly and not overstate their case. It seems reasonable to state that these letters are correctly put side-by-side in the NT. At the very least, they share some of the same thoughts, subject matters, and other qualities mentioned above. Bauckham is correct that they use different terminology, but is different terminology sufficient evidence to suggest a different author? There are more similarities and differences to note that will help in answering the questions at hand.

15. D. Guthrie, *New Testament Introduction*, 852.
16. D. Guthrie, *New Testament Introduction*, 852.
17. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 143.
18. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 145.

The Greek of 1 and 2 Peter

I. First Peter

One of the most significant questions concerning 1 and 2 Peter is their different Greek styles and vocabulary. Often, the Greek of 1 Peter is deemed an "Elevated style of Greek."[19] Wayne Grudem rightly states, "The Greek may be said to be excellent, but to say it is a literary masterpiece is probably an overstatement."[20] The difference in the style of Greek of both letters is important but should be neither underplayed nor overstated. A balanced approach is necessary.

One of the most helpful works on the Greek of 1 Peter is Karen Jobes' excursus in her commentary on 1 Peter. She evaluates the Greek of 1 Peter by using criteria of what would be usual Greek tendencies for a Semitic individual when writing Greek. These tendencies include things such as the way prepositions are used, the use of articles, and others, totaling 17 criteria. She notes, "Of the fourteen criteria relevant to 1 Peter, nine clearly fall on the side of the scale showing Semitic influence."[21] This demonstrates that 1 Peter may not be written by someone whose first language was Greek. Instead, it may be written by a Semitic person (e.g., *possibly* a Jewish person). Although Jobes notes, "The style of 1 Peter, with its long sentences and rhetorical elements, may suggest someone who has a greater proficiency in Greek than would be expected of a Galilean fisherman. Nevertheless, Semitic interference is indicated…"[22] Because of Silvanus' mention in 1 Peter 5:12 as a possible scribe, Jobes examines 1 Thessalonians (another letter noting Silvanus). What Jobes found was that 1 Thessalonians and

19. Travis B. Williams and David G. Horrell, *1 Peter: A Critical and Exegetical Commentary*, 2 vols., International Critical Commentary (London: T&T Clark, 2023), 125.

20. Wayne A. Grudem, *1 Peter: An Introduction and Commentary*, rev. ed., Tyndale New Testament Commentaries 17 (Downers Grove, IL: IVP Academic, 2024), 7.

21. Karen H. Jobes, *1 Peter*, 2nd ed., Baker Exegetical Commentary on the New Testament (Grand Rapids: Baker Academic, 2022), 329.

22. K. Jobes, *1 Peter*, 331.

1 Peter are very similar in their use of Greek, both leaning toward Semitic influence. Jobes concludes, "The major conclusion drawn from this study is that the extent of Semitic interference in the Greek of 1 Peter indicates an author whose first language was *not* Greek."[23]

Michael Green is also helpful in evaluating the Greek of 1 and 2 Peter. Like Williams, Green notes that the Greek of 1 Peter is "Polished, cultured, dignified; it is among the best in the New Testament," while 2 Peter is "Grandiose…like baroque art, almost vulgar in its pretentiousness and effusiveness."[24] He suggests that 1 Peter may be the work of Silvanus.[25] Green states that 1 and 2 Peter have as many remarkable stylistic resemblances as they do differences. Both letters have "Strong Hebraisms and the striking habit of verbal repetition…these are features likely to have survived through the employment of different secretaries."[26] Green argues that while some of 1 Peter's frequent words are missing in 2 Peter, "Others are replaced with synonyms."[27] Green cites several scholars who argue the similarities between 1 and 2 Peter. First, Joseph Mayor, who said, "'There is not that chasm between 1 and 2 Peter which some would try to make out;'" then, B. Weiss' conclusion on a linguistic analysis, "'The Second Epistle of Peter is allied to no New Testament writing more closely than to his First;'" Next, Holzmeister, who "Showed that 1 and 2 Peter are as close linguistically as 1 and 2 Corinthians;" Then A. E. Simms, who demonstrated that 1 and 2 Peter are as close "On the score of words used" as 1 and 2 Timothy (which have a unified author); and finally A. Q. Morton, who wrote that, 'From cumulative sum analysis on the computer…1 and 2 Peter are indistinguishable linguistically.'"[28]

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23. K. Jobes, *1 Peter*, 334. Italics added.
24. Michael Green, *2 Peter and Jude: An Introduction and Commentary*, Tyndale New Testament Commentaries 18 (Downers Grove, IL: InterVarsity Press, 1987), 23-24.
25. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 24.
26. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 24.
27. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 24.
28. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 24-25.

Joseph Mayor lists 3 comprehensive charts of the Greek words: (1) those used in both 1 and 2 Peter, (2) only in 1 Peter, (3) and only in 2 Peter. For words used in both letters, he totals 100. For words used only in 1 Peter, he notes a total of 369 (59 are *hapax legomena* [Greek words only found here in the NT]). For words used only in 2 Peter, he notes 230 (56 are *hapax legomena*). The final count is 100 words used in both and 599 that are not.[29] Mayor concludes that, "The Greek of the one is not by the same hand as the Greek of the other."[30] However, as noted before, after a complete analysis of the Greek of both letters, Mayor notes that they are more similar than sometimes stated (see quote on previous paragraph).

II. Second Peter

Richard Bauckham states that 2 Peter "Must be related to the 'Asiatic' style of Greek rhetoric which was coming into fashion in 2 Peter's time…with its love of high-sounding expressions, florid and verbose language, and elaborate literary effects."[31] Bauckham questions if there are any "Genuine Semitisms."[32] He concludes, however, "A native Semitic speaker cannot be ruled out" but suggests another possibility is "A native Latin speaker."[33]

Bauckham also compares 2 Peter's Greek with 1 Peter's, much like Mayor. He states Holzmeister's percentages: "38.6 percent [of words used in 2 Peter] are common to 1 and 2 Peter, 61.4 percent peculiar to 2 Peter, while…the words used in 1 Peter…28.4 percent are common to 1 and 2 Peter, [and] 71.6 percent peculiar to 1 Peter."[34] 1 and 2 Peter both have a large number of *hapax legomena*, showing that the author(s) had a wide vocabulary.[35] Finally, Bauckham states that the

29. J. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, lxix-lxxiv.
30. J. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, lxxiv.
31. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 137.
32. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 138.
33. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 138.
34. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 144.
35. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 144.

common words in both letters are "Mostly very common words" with only ἀπόθεσις being "Used exclusively in 1 and 2 Peter among the NT writings."[36] While he deems the following list "Not very impressive," he does share possible "characteristics" of words used in both letters: ἀναστροφή, ἄσπιλος, ἀρετή, and φιλαδελφία.[37] He also shows that the letters chose to use different words for the same idea. For the Second Coming of Christ, παρουσία is used in 2 Peter 1:16, 3:4, 3:12 and ἀποκάλυψις in 1 Peter 1:7, 1:13, 4:13 (and φανεροῦν in 5:4). Bauckham makes an important statement, "Of course, both letters are relatively short, are evidently directed to different issues and situations, and deal on the whole with different subjects."[38] However he goes on to state, "If 1 and 2 Peter had been anonymous documents, no one would have thought of attributing them to a single author."[39]

Michael Green writes that 2 Peter has Aramaic thought behind it, footnoting Chaine, who lists a host of Semitisms behind 2 Peter.[40] The footnote continues, stating that G. Wohlenberg suggested that 2 Peter may originally have been in Aramaic and then translated into Greek.[41] Green also wrote an article titled, "2 Peter Reconsidered," in which he notes some of the Hebraisms in the letter. He lists "φθορᾷ φθαρήσονται, καταρᾶς τέκνα, and τοὺς ὀπίσω σαρκὸς πορενομένους."[42] He then says that the form of Peter's name in 1:1 may be "A genuine Hebraism used by Peter himself."[43] If it is not, Green suggests an alternative that it is "A brilliant archaism without parallel in the writings of the second century, including the whole corpus of pseudo-Petrine literature."[44]

36. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 144.
37. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 144.
38. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 145.
39. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 145.
40. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 27. See footnote 28 there.
41. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 27. See footnote 28 there.
42. Michael Green, *2 Peter Reconsidered* (London: Tyndale Press, 1960), 11. Accessed at https://biblicalstudies.org.uk/pdf/tp/2peter_green.pdf.
43. M. Green, *2 Peter Reconsidered*, 14.
44. M. Green, *2 Peter Reconsidered*, 14.

III. Conclusion

The Greek of both letters is a complicated issue. However, at times there can be a temptation to overstate how different the Greek of these two letters are. The Greek of both is clearly different, however Bauckham's note that they are short letters to different groups in different situations is important. In both letters, there seems to be signs of a possible Semitic speaker or at least influence and an overlap of some Greek words. While it is unclear if both letters come from a common source, the different style and word choice does not outweigh the possibility that the author of the letters simply made choices based on the need of his audiences, resulting in completely different letters. While this result seems far from satisfying on its own, it may be the case if other evidence works to show a common author.

The Use of the OT

I. First Peter

Karen Jobes wrote the entry on "1 Peter" in D. A. Carson's *Dictionary of the New Testament Use of the Old Testament* (2023). In it, she notes that 1 Peter primarily quotes from the Septuagint ("LXX" used for the first five books. "Old Greek" is used for the rest of the OT). Jobes notes two primary purposes for 1 Peter's use of OT: "To explain that Jesus was the Messiah, who, it was predicted, would suffer and die (prophetic interpretation)" and "To explain how Christian believers are to live out their new live in Christ."[45] Jobes notes that there are two OT sections that are prominent in 1 Peter: Psalm 34 (OG) and Isaiah, along with many other connections. See Table 1.

45. Karen Jobes, "1 Peter," in *Dictionary of the New Testament Use of the Old Testament*, ed. G. K. Beale, D. A. Carson, Benjamin L. Gladd, and Andrew David Naselli (Grand Rapids: Baker Academic, 2023), 594.

Table 1

1 Peter and the OT: Quotations, Citations, Allusions, and Influence

1 Peter	Exodus	Leviticus	Psalms	Proverbs	Isaiah	Hosea	Other
1:1							Israelite Exile
1:2	24:3-8						
1:3			34:2 (33:2 OG)				
1:6			33:20 (OG)				
1:16		19:2					
1:17			33:5, 8 (OG)				
1:18			33:23 (OG)				
1:24-5					40:6-8		
2:3			33:1ff (OG); 33:9 (OG)				
2:4-8			118:22 (117:22 OG)		8:14, 28:16 (OG)		
2:6			33:6 (OG)		28:16 (OG)		
2:7			117:22 (OG)				
2:8					8:14		
2:9	19:5-6 (LXX)				43:4, 20-1 (OG)		
2:10						2:23 (2:25 OG)	
2:11			33:5 (OG)				
2:17			33: 10, 12 (OG)				
2:18-3:7					53:1ff		
2:22					53:9 (OG)		
2:23					53:7		
2:24					53:4-5 (OG)		
2:25					53:6 (OG)		
3:6							Abraham and Sarah (cf. Gen 18:22 LXX)
3:10-2			33:12-7 (OG)				
3:12			33:18 (OG)				
3:14-5					8:12-3 (OG)		
3:20-1							Noah and Flood
4:8				10:12?			
4:14					11:2		
4:18				11:31 (OG)			
5:5				3:34 (OG)			
5:13							Israelite Exile

Information from Jobes (2023, p. 594-600).

Note: 4:8 and Proverbs 10:12 is marked with a "?" due to Jobes' comment that this is probably not a quotation but rather Peter utilizing a "proverbial use" of the proverb "that was in circulation" at that time (Jobes, 2023, p. 597).

Jobes notes that 1 Peter's use of the OT shows that he viewed the OT as authoritative and being fulfilled in Jesus.[46] She also observes that the use of OT in this letter "Contribute[s] specific content to Peter's thought, some of it distinctive and unique within the NT."[47] She makes two lists: "Contributions to Christology" (9 items listed) and "Instructions for Christian life" (12 items listed).[48] Jobes concludes with stating that the use of OT in 1 Peter is meant to "Orient its readers…to see themselves drawn by faith in Jesus Christ into the long and magnificent heritage of Israel."[49] Deeply connected are the sections on Jesus (Christology) and one's new life in Jesus (paraenesis). Finally, in her commentary on 1 Peter, Jobes notes that 1 Peter is similar to Romans and Hebrews in OT reference frequency.[50] Also, she mentions that at times 1 Peter quotes the LXX/OG exactly while other times it is slightly different forms of the text, possibly suggesting a different version was available to 1 Peter.[51]

II. Second Peter

Matthew Harmon wrote the entry on "2 Peter and Jude" in D. A. Carson's *Dictionary of the New Testament Use of the Old Testament* (2023). For 2 Peter, Harmon notes that the letter seems to, on some level, know Second Temple Jewish texts and traditions and uses them "Potentially in the way that… [2 Peter] interpret[s] OT texts."[52] Also, 2 Peter frequently refers to OT people and events without noting specific passages. Harmon states, "As a result, it can be difficult to determine the OT text form… [2 Peter] use[s]."[53] There are three main theological

46. K. Jobes, "1 Peter," 599.
47. K. Jobes, "1 Peter," 599.
48. See K. Jobes, "1 Peter, 599-600.
49. K. Jobes, "1 Peter," 600.
50. K. Jobes, *1 Peter*, 46.
51. K. Jobes, *1 Peter*, 47.
52. Matthew Harmon, "2 Peter and Jude," in *Dictionary of the New Testament Use of the Old Testament*, ed. G. K. Beale, D. A. Carson, Benjamin L. Gladd, and Andrew David Naselli (Grand Rapids: Baker Academic, 2023), 412.
53. M. Harmon, "2 Peter and Jude," 412.

themes in 2 Peter: "The Word of God, God's judgment on his enemies and salvation of his people, and the return of Christ to consummate a new creation."[54] See Table 2.

54. M. Harmon, "2 Peter and Jude," 412.

Table 2
2 Peter and the OT: Quotations, Citations, Allusions, and Influence

2 Peter	Genesis	Numbers	Psalms	Proverbs	Isaiah	Habakkuk	Malachi	Other
1:11?								*Daniel 7:27 (OG)?*
1:17	22:2, 12, 16		2:7; *8:5 (8:6 OG)?*		42:1			*Daniel 7:14?*
1:19		24:17-9	19:8; 37:6; 46:5; 130:6; 119:105, 130		9:2		4:2	Luke 1:78-9; *Song of Songs 2:17?*
2:2					*52:5 (OG)*			
2:4	6:1-4							Jewish Interpretations of Gen 6:1-4 ("e.g., Jub. 4:15-5:9; T. Reu. 5:6-7; T. Naph. 3:5" [p. 413])
2:5	*6:17 LXX*							
2:6-8	chs. 18-9 (*19:29 LXX*)							
2:15-6		chs. 22-4 (*22:21-35*)						
2:20-2				26:11				
3:5	*1:1*; 1:9-10		24:2; 102:25					
3:6								Noah and the Flood (cf. Gen 6-8)
3:7	9:11							
3:8			90:4 (*89:4 OG*)					
3:9, 12-4						*2:3*		
3:12					*34:4 (OG)*; 60:22?			
3:13					32:16; 60:21; *65:17 (OG)* (cf. 43:16-21; 51:3; 66:22)			

Information from Harmon (2023, p. 412-5). Also, Bauckham's (additional) observations (discussed below) included in italics (see Bauckham, 1983, p. 138).

Note: Isaiah 60:22 marked with a "?" due to Harmon's comment that Peter may be drawing on Jewish tradition but still may be an allusion to Isaiah, noting some Jewish texts that connect the idea of "God hastening the end, sometimes in connection with Israel's repentance" (Harmon, 2023, p. 415). Observations from Bauckham (italics) which have "?" indicate possible (but uncertain) allusions.

Harmon concludes, "The frequently allusive manner in which 2 Peter… use[s] the OT assumes the reader is so familiar with those OT persons and events that even a name or a brief phrase is enough to evoke the entire OT context of that reference."[55] It seems to Harmon that 2 Peter does not so much directly quote (or cite) the OT as much as it does allude to and (potentially) echo it. Harmon notes that the main way that 2 Peter uses the OT is by blending "Analogies and typology, with the line between those categories not always clear."[56] 2 Peter uses "Stock-in-trade language from the OT" to describe false teachers.[57]

Bauckham also lists possible allusions to the OT in his commentary on 2 Peter. See Table 2 above. He notes, "Unlike Jude, 2 Peter's allusions are habitually to the LXX."[58] Bauckham then lists 2 Peter passages that "Correspond to the language of the LXX" including:

> 1:11 (Dan 7:27 θ, LXX); 1:17 (Ps 8:6); 1:19 (Num 24:17); 2:2 (Isa 52:5); 2:5 (Gen 6:17); 2:6 (Gen 19:29); 3:12 (Isa 34:4); 3:13 (Isa 65:17). In the following cases the allusion is certainly not to the LXX version: 1:19 (Cant 2:17); 2:22 (Prov 26:11); 3:9, 12–14 (Hab 2:3); 3:12 (Isa 60:22), but in all except the first of these cases the author has probably taken the allusion from an intermediate source.[59]

Bauckham goes on to state that because of 2 Peter's familiarity with the LXX/OG, the phrases in the letter that are typical in the LXX/OG should be listed: "πορεύεσθαι ὀπίσω, 2:10; ἐπ' ἐσχάτων τῶν ἡμέρων, 3:3; ποῦ ἐστιν; 3:4."[60] He also affirms that the author may be familiar with "Extrabiblical Jewish haggadic traditions (2:4-5, 7-8, 15-16)."[61]

55. M. Harmon, "2 Peter and Jude," 415.
56. M. Harmon, "2 Peter and Jude," 415.
57. M. Harmon, "2 Peter and Jude," 415.
58. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 138.
59. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 138. These are found in Table 2 above.
60. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 138.
61. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 138.

III. Conclusion

1 and 2 Peter are both full of OT references. There are a few overlapping OT references in these two letters. The clearest is Noah and the Flood (1 Peter 3:20-21 and 2 Peter 3:6). Both letters also have a (distant) reference to Isaiah 43 (1 Peter 2:9 with Isaiah 43:3, 20-1 (OG) and 2 Peter 3:13 with Isaiah 43:16-21). Another (distant) reference may be found in Israelite Exile in 1 Peter 5:13 with Daniel and 2 Peter 1:11, 17 with Daniel 7:14 and 7:27 (OG), but the 2 Peter reference is questioned by Bauckham (see above). There is also a connection in Genesis 18-19 (LXX) (1 Peter 2:9 with Genesis 19:5-6 and 2 Peter 2:6-9 with Genesis 19:29). In addition to these connections, both books cite from three of the same OT books: Psalms, Proverbs, and Isaiah. Outside of Isaiah 43, these books share no OT reference in these respective books. However, passages in Psalms and Isaiah that are referenced are near one another (see Tables 1-2 above).

Of interest is 1 and 2 Peter's commitment to the LXX/OG version of the OT. As stated above, Jobes and Bauckham note in their respective works that 1 and 2 Peter use this translation the majority of the time. The use of a single translation for most of the references in these letters shows another layer of similarity between these two letters. However, the LXX/OG was a common translation in the New Testament, so the connection here must not be pressed too far. If Jobes is correct that the readers of 1 Peter are supposed to see themselves as joining Israel's heritage found in the OT, then the readers of 2 Peter have already done that, having become, in Harmon's words, "So familiar with those OT persons and events that even a name or a brief phrase is enough to evoke the entire OT context of that reference."[62]

62. M. Harmon, "2 Peter and Jude," 415.

The Gospels in 1 and 2 Peter

I. First Peter

1 Peter has several connections with the Gospels and their traditions. Before exploring them, there are a few things about the Gospels that must be noted. When a connection is identified between the Gospels and another writing, the key question becomes whether the author of the other writing (here, 1 Peter) knew what Jesus *said* or only what the Gospel author *wrote*. Some scholars do not believe the words of Jesus in the Gospels are his actual words, but simply what he either was believed to have said or what his teachings meant. This is called *ipsissima verba* ("the very words") and *ipsissima vox* ("the very voice"). Therefore, the question is often raised whether the connections in 1 Peter are to the written Gospels, their sources or traditions, or to Jesus himself.

Robert Gundry wrote an extensive article on the connections between 1 Peter and the Gospels. His connections are noted in Table 3 (see below). Of all the *verba Christi* (Jesus' words) in 1 Peter, "Only two are not directly related to gospel contexts in which the Apostle Peter plays a prominent part or would have had a special interest."[63] The two places are 1 Peter 1:8 with John 20:29 and 1 Peter 1:23-2:1 with John 3:3, 7. Gundry also qualifies that there are certain teachings in 1 Peter that could connect back to the Sermon on the Mount but because they are also taught in other NT epistles, they cannot be used to show a dependence on the Gospels and Jesus. However, the connections are still noted in Table 3 below.

I do not believe that all of the connections Gundry makes are necessarily accurate. It seems that one could make connections just about anywhere if one tries. Even Gundry himself says, "Several of the Dominical sayings reviewed… may be questioned."[64] However, his

63. R. H. Gundry, "'Verba Christi' in I Peter: Their Implications Concerning the Authorship of I Peter and the Authenticity of the Gospel Tradition," *New Testament Studies* 13 (1966): 348.

64. R. Gundry, "'Verba Christi' in I Peter," 348.

work shows that there are connections with the Gospels and Jesus' teachings which cannot be overlooked. The presence of teachings from Jesus in 1 Peter which Peter himself was present for are significant. Gundry writes, "It is unthinkable that a pious forger who knew the gospel tradition cleverly inserted very allusive references to *verba Christi* from only those parts which Peter would most likely have remembered."[65] This gives weight to the pro-Petrine argument for 1 Peter.

65. R. Gundry, "'Verba Christi' in I Peter," 348.

Table 3
1 Peter and the Gospels: Connections, Allusions, and Influence

1 Peter	Matthew	Mark	Luke	John
1:3				3:3, 7
1:4			12:33	
1:6	5:10ff			
1:8				20:29
1:10-2			24:25f	
1:13		8:3	12:32, 35, 45	
1:21				14:1, 6
1:22				8:34f, 15:12
1:23				3:3, 7
2:1				3:3, 7
2:4, 7	16:18; 21:42	7:10		
2:9	5:16			
2:12	5:16			
2:13-7	17:26f			
2:18ff	5:10ff		6:27ff	
2:19f			6:32-5	
2:24				10:2-18
2:25				10:11, 14
3:8				13:5ff
3:14	5:10			
4:7		8:3; 14:32-42	21:31, 34, 36	
4:8				8:34f, 15:12
4:13f	5:10ff			
4:19			23:46	
5:2			12:32	10:11, 14; 21:15-7
5:3				8:4f
5:3-5	20:25-8	10:42-5	22:25-30	
5:4				10:11, 14
5:8f	26:40	8:3; 14:38	22:31f	

Information from Gundry (1966, p. 337-348).

Ernest Best, however, responded to Gundry (and others). He walks through many of the alleged connections and notes that the only connections that seem correct are blocks of texts in Luke 6 and 12 along with two isolated sayings: Matt 5:16 and Mark 10:45 (and possibly Matt 5:10).

Best makes an important observation: "Knowledge of the gospel tradition on the part of any author in the N.T. does not logically imply that he was present when that part of the gospel tradition was spoken by Jesus."[66] Paul, for example, knows of Jesus' teachings but that does not mean he was necessarily with Jesus when he taught them.

It seems to me, however, that while Best is helpful in balancing the possible connections, he is sometimes unfair in his use of criteria, as Gundry notes concerning 1 Clement (see below). In one part of the article, Best states if Mark 10:45 was a true saying of Jesus, then 1 Peter 1:18 would be dependent on it, but since Titus 2:14 is closer to Mark than 1 Peter is, "We cannot conclude that the author of 1 Peter was present when the logion was spoken without suggesting that the author of Titus was also present."[67] Here, Best overlooked that the author of Titus does not claim to be an eye-witness as 1 Peter does (by implication of its alleged author). Correctly, however, Best concludes that Mark 10:45 is probably a saying which 1 Peter uses.

Gundry responded to Best and pointed out issues with Best's rebuttal. He stated that, "The standards by which allusions are judged genuine drop in the comparisons between *1 Clement* and Lk 6."[68] He also maintains that his thesis was not that Peter used the Gospels but that "He used traditions *deriving from his own memory* and independently written by others in the gospels."[69] While Gundry may draw too many connections, Best appears to recognize too few. The

66. E. Best, "1 Peter and the Gospel Tradition," *New Testament Studies* 16 (1970): 95.
67. E. Best, "1 Peter and the Gospel Tradition," 99-100.
68. R. Gundry, "'Verba Christi' in I Peter," 232.
69. R. Gundry, "'Verba Christi' in 1 Peter," 221. Italics added.

evidence is best understood as lying somewhere between these two positions.

Thomas Lea gives an interesting case study of one instance of a possible connection between 1 Peter and the Gospels. Assuming Petrine authorship, he examines the use of what he calls "stone theology." In 1 Peter 2:4-8, Peter uses three different words for "stone" (λίθος, πέτρα, and ἀκρογωνιαῖον). Lea notes, "No other part of Scripture makes such extensive reference to stone and rock in relation to Jesus Christ as does this brief portion of I Peter."[70] In this passage, Peter uses Psalm 118:22-23, Isaiah 8:14, and Isaiah 28:16. Lea suggests that Peter learned to use these passages from his time with Jesus, noting that Jesus himself used Psalm 118:22 in Matthew 21:42 (parallel: Mark 12:10-1 and Luke 20:17). Lea states, "In each reference to the Old Testament there is a close conformity to the text of the Septuagint in the portion quoted, and this distinctive quality is true also of the reference to the Psalm appearing in I Peter 2:7."[71] Lea suggests that Peter would have been at this event to hear Jesus quote this Psalm. Interestingly, Peter also quotes the Psalm in Acts 4:11. Additionally, there is a possibility that Luke 20:18, directly following Jesus' use of Psalm 118, could have influenced Peter's mind to think of Isaiah 8:14-15.[72] This to me, however, seems less likely.

Lea, importantly, acknowledges that there are other sources which use "stone theology," such as Paul (see Romans 9:33 and Ephesians 2:20). Lea, therefore, says that it is possible Peter was "Influenced by these sources in addition to Jesus, or it is possible that all three may have their usage of stone theology traced to a common source."[73] Finally, Lea notes that because of Peter's nickname ("Πέτρος") he would have been interested in "stone" and "rock" motifs

70. Thomas D. Lea, "How Peter Learned the Old Testament," *Southwestern Journal of Theology* 22 (1980): 97.

71. T. Lea, "How Peter Learned the Old Testament," 98.

72. T. Lea, "How Peter Learned the Old Testament," 99.

73. T. Lea, "How Peter Learned the Old Testament," 110.

from Jesus. All this points Lea to see Jesus as a (likely) source for Peter's understanding of these OT passages, especially Psalm 118.

II. Second Peter

Richard Bauckham notes four allusions (and other possible ones) to the Gospels in 2 Peter. See Table 4.

Table 4

2 Peter and the Gospels: Connections, Allusions, and Influence

2 Peter	Matthew	Mark	Luke	John
1:14				21:18
1:16-18	Closest (deemed an independent tradition); 16:28?	9:1?		
2:9	6:13?			
2:20	12:45		11:26	
2:21		9:42? 14:21?		
3:4		9:1 (parallel: 13:30)?		
3:10	24:43		12:39 (cf. 1 Thess 5:2)	

Information from Bauckham (1983, p. 148).
Note: Passages marked with a "?" Bauckham states are possible but not definite allusions and/or echoes.

Bauckham states the author of 2 Peter seems to know Gospel traditions independent of the Gospels we use. He continues on to say that of the four we use, Matthew is the most likely source.

Boobyer and Schreiner give even more possible allusions in their respective works. Boobyer notes the use of the word ἔξοδος in 1:15, which is the same word used in Luke 9:31 for Jesus' departure.[74] Schreiner connects "honor and glory" (1:17) with the Transfiguration, suggesting that Jesus' face was glorious (Luke 9:29, 32) and God's message was honorable (Matt 17:5, Mark 9:7, and Luke 9:35).[75]

III. Conclusion

Thanks to the work of these scholars, it seems that both epistles use either Gospel traditions or the Gospels more directly. Interestingly, both books have possible allusions from all four Gospels, showing at the very least a diverse understanding of the life and teachings of Jesus, although some are heavily disputed, as Best showed. Schreiner is helpful here, commenting that when evaluating 2 Peter and the Gospels, one must remember that if he was an eye-witness, he was recalling events from memory and not necessarily from the four written Gospels, but does suggest Peter may have relied on Matthew.[76]

Notably, Mayor suggests that 1 Peter is written exactly how one would expect the apostle Peter to have written.[77] He does not believe this holds true for 2 Peter. However, it seems that Mark 9:9 sheds light on 2 Peter 1:16-18. Jesus instructed Peter (and others) to not share their experience on the mountain until after his resurrection. Whether one believes this is historical or a literary device, it is interesting that the Transfiguration is not again mentioned in the NT until 2 Peter, a letter said to have been written by an eye-witness of the event. Either a clever

74. G. H. Boobyer, "The Indebtedness of 2 Peter to 1 Peter," 45.

75. Thomas R. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, NAC 37 (Nashville: Broadman & Holman, 2003), 315.

76. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 315-316.

77. J. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, cxiii.

reader of Mark saw the note and decided to use it as he embodied Peter, or Peter himself understood that now, years after Jesus' resurrection, it was appropriate for him to discuss such a powerful event in his life. The underlying connections to the Gospels in these two letters give support to an author well-developed in Jesus' teachings.

Paul in 1 and 2 Peter

I. First Peter

Travis Williams writes that there has been debate over if 1 Peter was directly influenced by Pauline letters (like Romans and Ephesians). According to Williams, the current consensus is that the similarities between 1 Peter and Pauline literature are because of "'The use of common tradition in early Christianity.'"[78] Williams and Horrell, therefore, believe that 1 Peter was not a "Quasi-Pauline document, standing firmly in Pauline tradition" but rather used early Christian traditions.[79] Williams continues, stating some of the similarities, differences, and connections between 1 Peter and Paul's letters. Firstly, the opening and closing of 1 Peter seem to follow Paul's pattern (however, there are differences). Such similarities are ἀπόστολος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ ("Apostle of Jesus Christ," 1:1) and χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη ("Grace to you and peace," 1:2). Williams notes that the following word in 1:2, "πληθυνθείη," is "Unknown in the Pauline letters but found…in Jewish epistolary tradition…and in the greetings of Jude, 2 Peter, and 1 Clement."[80] Next, Williams notes the similarities between 1 Peter 1:3-9 and Eph 1:3-14. He also points out, "The most striking link with Paul is the exhortation ἀσπάσασθε ἀλλήλους ἐν φιλήματι ἀγάπης ['Greet one another with a kiss of love'] (1 Pet 5:14), which is paralleled only, and

78. Travis B. Williams and David G. Horrell, *1 Peter 1–2:10: A Critical and Exegetical Commentary*, vol. 1 of *1 Peter: A Critical and Exegetical Commentary*, International Critical Commentary (London: T&T Clark, 2023), 65.

79. T. Williams and D. Horrell, *1 Peter 1-2:10*, 65.

80. T. Williams and D. Horrell, *1 Peter 1-2:10*, 67. Italics added.

almost precisely, in Paul (Rom 16:16; 1 Cor 16:20; 2 Cor 13:12; 1 Thess 5:26)."[81] He goes further, "There is a distinction between Paul's holy kiss…and 1 Peter's kiss of love…though this is hardly enough to establish the independence…of 1 Peter from Paul."[82] Williams concludes that there is likely "Some kind of Pauline influence on 1 Peter."[83] Then, Williams comments, "The particular formulation of paraenetical tradition found in 1 Peter seems to reflect Pauline influence" with Romans being a possible source for 1 Peter's author.[84] Williams footnotes a rebuttal against those who would reject any form of Pauline influence on 1 Peter and state that the only connection between them is common tradition. Williams challenges those who claim no literary relationship between Romans and 1 Peter, stating that if both Romans and the author of 1 Peter were in the same place at the same time, why not see Romans to be a source for 1 Peter? Additionally, Williams sees a connection between 1 Peter 2:13-17 and Romans 13:1-7, noting, "1 Peter's household-code teaching and exhortations about submission to the governing authorities seem to reflect the influence of Pauline tradition."[85] There are also several parallels between the phrasing and terminology in both 1 Peter and Pauline literature such as ἐν Χριστῷ ("In Christ") (1 Peter 3:16; 5:10, 14), which "Occurs…in the NT [outside Paul's letters] only in 1 Peter."[86] For more, see Williams and Horrell, 2023, p. 72. In conclusion, Williams states, "1 Peter shows clear signs of awareness of and dependence upon Pauline language and tradition."[87]

II. Second Peter

81. T. Williams and D. Horrell, 69.
82. T. Williams and D. Horrell, 69.
83. T. Williams and D. Horrell, 69.
84. T. Williams and D. Horrell, 70.
85. T. Williams and D. Horrell, 71-72.
86. T. Williams and D. Horrell, 72.
87. T. Williams and D. Horrell, 73.

Richard Bauckham states that 2 Peter knew at least some of Paul's letters because 2 Peter 3:15 calls them "Scripture."[88] However, he goes on to say that "there is little sign of Pauline influence in 2 Peter."[89] Bauckham includes Lindemann's conclusion that "2 Peter is entirely uninfluenced by Pauline theology and contains no allusion to the Pauline letters."[90] Bauckham gives the only allusions he sees as even possible: 2 Peter 2:19 with Romans 8:21 (cf. 6:16; 7:5), 2 Peter 3:15 with Romans 12:3 (cf. 15:15), and 2 Peter 3:10 with 1 Thessalonians 5:2. He says, "They are far from certain."[91] It may be that 2 Peter did not see Paul's work as relevant to his own, but this may be unsatisfactory as a complete explanation.[92] Bauckham offers another possibility: "the author's theological thinking and terminology were formed before he had much contact with Pauline theology, and that a collection of Paul's letters was only just coming into use at the time when he wrote."[93]

III. Conclusion

1 and 2 Peter's relationship with Paul are clearly different. 1 Peter seems to be influenced by Paul, either by common tradition or Paul himself or both. There are several components of 1 Peter that remind the reader of Paul. The same cannot be said about 2 Peter. Interestingly, however, while 1 Peter seems influenced by Paul, it is 2 Peter that refers to him directly. It may be that despite Bauckham (and Lindemann) seeing it as very unsatisfactory, the reason for a lack of Pauline influence on 2 Peter is due to 2 Peter's focus—simply because he could have used Paul does not by necessity mean he had to. As Bauckman noted as a possible answer: 2 Peter could have developed his own respective theological thinking and terminology *before* he read much of

88. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 147.
89. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 147.
90. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 147.
91. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 147.
92. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 148.
93. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 148.

Paul's work. If Petrine authorship is acceptable, then this possibility may be plausible. However, when it comes to 1 and 2 Peter and Paul, it seems that these letters are quite different in their relationship to him.

Analysis and Conclusion

From a careful study of the material presented here, these two letters seem to be closer aligned than Bauckham suggests.[94] While they are by no means identical to one another in their presentation, style, vocabulary, or the like, they do share important similarities, such as the Semitic nature of both letters, use of OT and its characters and events, connection to the Gospels (both to Jesus' teachings and events involving Peter), and other general similarities discussed above.

While the question of joint authorship of these two letters cannot be finalized based solely on an analysis of their use of communication, it can be shown that these books are deeply connected in some important ways, which may lead the way to a "single-author" conclusion. There is more work to be done on the question of Petrine authorship, but these specific pieces of evidence demonstrate that the relationship between the two letters is defined by more than their differences. Boobyer is correct:

> The resemblances and differences between these writings seem to have been examined mainly…as an aspect…of the authorship [question] of 2 Peter. This may have led those concerned to establish a common authorship…to overstress the resemblances, whilst those convinced that the second was not by the same hand…could have exaggerated the disconnectedness.[95]

When the similarities and differences are evaluated, it is reasonable to accept the opening words of these letters as accurate statements about their author: "Peter, an apostle of Jesus Christ."

94. See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 145.
95. G. H. Boobyer, "The Indebtedness of 2 Peter to 1 Peter," 36.

1 Peter

1:1-

Text

2 PETER

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Introduction to 2 Peter

"Simon Peter, a bond-servant and apostle"

1. Authorship

The letter begins with a claim of authorship: "Simon Peter." In some manuscripts, the name is "Simeon Peter."[1] There has been much debate over whether Peter wrote it, dictated it, gave approval of it, had someone else finish it, and the like.[2] It seems to me that the best answer is that Peter wrote it. I do not know if he wrote it himself or used a secretary (amanuensis), but the letter's introduction follows the typical NT epistle: a claim who it is from and greeting.

The significance of the claim that Peter wrote this letter should not be lost on us. This letter claims to have apostolic authority, which was a key factor in the early church's evaluation of NT letters.[3] For those who reject Petrine authorship and claim this was a pseudepigraphal work (that is, written by someone else but claimed it was by Peter), some have opted to say that 2 Peter should be *removed* from the NT canon.[4] This is an alarming claim. If Peter did not write it, why is it in our NT? Should it be? This raises a host of questions. The importance of understanding the authorship of 2 Peter is essential. So, did Peter write this letter or not?

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1. According to H. A. G. Houghton, "Simon" is found in "$\mathfrak{P}^{72}$, 03, 044, 5, 81, etc." while "Simeon" is found in "01, 02, 025, 33, 307, etc." See H. A. G. Houghton, *A Textual Commentary on the Greek New Testament: A Companion to the Sixth Edition of the United Bible Societies' Greek New Testament* (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2025), 349. So, while "Simon" is found in the oldest extant manuscript ($\mathfrak{P}^{72}$ is dated to 3rd-4th century), codices 01 and 02 ("Simeon") are dated to a similar time (01 = 4th century; 02 = 5th century). Houghton notes that it may be more likely that the Hebraic form of Peter's name ("Simeon") would have been corrected to the more common form: "Simon." Thus the UBS6 has "Simeon" instead of "Simon." For more on "Simeon" and its significance, see p. 15 and discussion below on the Internal Evidence for Petrine authorship.

2. For some of these, see Excursus: "Who Wrote Second Peter?" below.

3. See footnote 7 on p. 38.

4. See footnote 4 on p. 36.

External Evidence

See Excursus below (page 58). I have written a previous paper on this issue and have adapted it for this commentary.

Internal Evidence

Text

Excursus B

Who Wrote Second Peter? Assessing Its Authorship, Dating, and Early Reception[*]

The most controversial book within the NT canon is, without a doubt, 2 Peter. It has often been debated by scholars as to whether it was written by Peter or by someone either pretending to be him or using his authority (pseudepigrapha).[1] Even scholars such as Bruce Metzger doubted Peter wrote this epistle.[2] If Peter did not write it, then one might ask why it was included in the NT canon.[3] Did the Church Fathers make a mistake adding it to the canon?[4] In this paper, it is my

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* Originally written as a paper, Joshua M. Haub, "Who Wrote Second Peter? Assessing Its Authorship, Dating, and Early Reception." (unpublished paper, Florida College, 2026), 1-9. It has been adapted for this commentary. For paper edition, see https://joshuahaub.com/peter/second-peter-authorship/.

1. I use the word "pretending" in substitute for "forger," which is what a pseudepigrapher is, so B. Ehrman, as noted in M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," *JETS* 42, no. 4 (December 1999): 645-71 (648). Ehrman states "'Indeed, despite its common occurrence, forgery was almost universally condemned by ancient authors.'" It may be said, then, that forgery was condemned in the early centuries and perhaps can be classified as a form of lying.

The argument that a pseudepigrapher used Peter's name in order to write under Peter's authority is stated by T. Schreiner as the view of most scholars, see T. Schreiner *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, vol. 37 of *The New American Commentary* (Nashville: Broadman & Holman Publishers, 2003), 255.

2. Stated by B. Ehrman in his blog, B. Ehrman, "A Writing of Peter that *Barely* Got Into the New Testament," *The Bart Ehrman Blog*, August, 2022, https://ehrmanblog.org/a-writing-of-peter-that-barely-got-into-the-new-testament/.

3. This question is anticipated in K. Aland, "The Problem of Anonymity and Pseudonymity in Christian Literature of the First Two Centuries," *JTS* n.s. 12, no. 1 (April 1961): 39-49. Aland seemingly suggests that the reason some writings in the NT (ones that he supposes are pseudepigrapha) are included in the canon is not because they *were* written by their supposed author but because the early Christians *believed* they were written by them. See p. 49.

4. So G. Klein and J. Dunn as noted in T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, vol. 37, 265. Schreiner writes, "[Klein] proceeds to say that it is unfortunate the letter was even included in the canon. Dunn remarks that some of the writings of Luther and Wesley are equal to, or even better than, what we find in 2 Peter." According to R. Wall in his work R. Wall, "The Canonical Function of 2 Peter," *NTS* 39, no. 4 (October 1993): 645-59, he states, "A growing number of interpreters now read 2 Peter within the context of a wider body of pseudo-Petrine writings, all of which are deuteron-canonical and mostly heterodox." Thus, some modern critics treat 2 Peter's theology "in a manner similar to writings of the New Testament pseudepigrapha," 65. For a short discussion of some wishing to remove 2 Peter from the canon (or mark it as pseudepigrapha), see M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," 651-6.

objective to show that while the argument for Petrine authority is not without difficulties, it still seems that there is enough external evidence to suggest it is plausible that Peter *did* write 2 Peter and therefore should be part of the NT canon.

Importance of Authorship

To begin a discussion of 2 Peter, I must state why authorship matters for 2 Peter. Michael Kruger puts it succinctly: "There seems to be little dispute that apostolic authority was an essential criterion of canonicity for the early church."[5] The early church, therefore, accepted writings they believed came from those with apostolic authority, of which Peter was one.[6] The writings which claimed apostolic authority, while not being from an apostle (and therefore were considered pseudepigrapha), were often rejected.[7] This is the heart of the issue. If Peter did not write it, perhaps we ought to not accept it as Scripture![8]

Now, let us turn to the dating of the letter. R. Bauckham, in his commentary on Jude and 2 Peter, notes several factors that help us estimate when 2 Peter was written.[9] He identifies several connections, but I will point out two: (1) 2 Peter may have been an authoritative source for the *Apoc. Pet*. in the early second century, and (2) 2 Peter shares verbal similarities with the late first—and early second—century

5. M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," 646-7. He also footnotes: "Bruce M. Metzger (*The New Testament: Its Background, Growth and Content* [New York: Abingdon, 1965] 276) declares that 'the chief criterion for acceptance of particular writings as sacred, authoritative, and worthy of being read in services of worship was apostolic authorship.'"

6. R. Bauckham disputes this claim in his work R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, WBC 50 (Waco, TX: Word, 1983), 161-2, stating that the key in 2 Peter's authorship for the early church was not the writer but the "claim to be a faithful mediator of the apostolic message." Therefore, according to Bauckham, the message is more important than the author.

7. See M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," 647. It is here that Kruger notes Serapion (c. AD 180) and his rejection of the *Gospel According to Peter*. Serapion wrote, "'We receive both Peter and the other apostles as Christ, but the writings which falsely bear their name (ψευδεπίγραφα [pseudepigrapha]) we reject.'"

8. See footnotes 4, 6, and 7 for conflicting views.

9. For much of what follows, I am indebted to R. Bauckham and his work found in *2 Peter, Jude,* WBC 50.

writings of *1 Clem.*, *2 Clem.*, and the *Shepherd of Hermas*.[10] He goes on to say that all four of these works may have been written in close proximity, "perhaps no more than twenty years" apart.[11] Taking into account other evidence, such as his interpretation of 3:4, he suggests that the dating is probably "c. AD 80-90," well after Peter's death.[12]

Michael Kruger largely agrees with Bauckham on dating.[13] Kruger turns to the early Church Fathers, noting that "Clement of Alexandria (c. 150-215)" wrote a now-lost commentary on 2 Peter.[14] "Irenaeus (c. 130-200)" may have also known the epistle.[15] Also, "Justin Martyr (c. 115-165)" may allude to 2 Peter 2:1 in his work *Dialogue with Trypho*.[16] In agreement with Bauckham, Kruger notes the possibility "that the *Apocalypse of Peter* (c. 110) was dependent upon 2 Peter."[17] Finally, Kruger pushes the date back into the first century with his notation of "1 Clement (c. 95-97)."[18] Where Kruger and Bauckham diverge is at 3:4. Bauckham interprets "the fathers" to mean the apostolic fathers (and the first generation of believers), thus signaling 2 Peter comes from a post-apostolic age.[19] By contrast, Kruger notes that this is not necessarily the correct interpretation because "nowhere in the NT or in the Apostolic Fathers is οἱ πατέρες [, the fathers,] used to refer to Christian 'Fathers,' but is consistently used to refer to Jewish patriarchs."[20] Thus, a fundamental piece of evidence in Bauckham's

10. Ibid., 149-50. Bauckham suggests these dates for these works: *Apoc. Pet.* (perhaps c. AD 110-40), *1 Clem.* (c. AD 96), *2 Clem*. (perhaps end of first century, beginning of the second), and Hermas (c. AD 80-100). He states, "these three works are 2 Peter's closest relatives in the early church," 150.

11. Ibid., 150.

12. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 158.

13. For much of what follows, I am indebted to M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," *JETS 42*, 645-71.

14. Ibid., 652.

15. Ibid., 653.

16. Ibid., 654.

17. Ibid.

18. Ibid.

19. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 158. Peter is believed to have died somewhere from AD 60-8. See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 276. Bauckham believes one can be confident it is "in AD 64 or 65." See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 159.

20. M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," 665.

dating loses its power.[21] Bauckham also states that Jude (either a source *for* 2 Peter or a book which used 2 Peter *as* a source) may be dated to the AD 50s. If Bauckham is correct in saying that 2 Peter is connected with *1 Clem., 2 Clem.,* and the *Shepherd of Hermas* and that Jude was written in the AD 50s, but Kruger is right about how 3:4 ought to be interpreted, then we are no longer required to say that the book must be post-apostolic and therefore the claim of Petrine authorship has more plausibility than is often acknowledge.[22]

Early Reception into the NT Canon

It must be stated that some in the early church doubted Petrine authorship. R. Bauckham writes, "Evidently 2 Peter was known throughout the second century, at least in some circles, but not widely used."[23] He states that the churches that had the letter may have known that Peter did not write it and consequently viewed it as being in the same category as the rest of the pseudo-Petrine works.[24] This could explain the lack of widespread circulation.[25] Bauckham concludes by stating that the letter was gradually accepted, and Jerome's firm stamp of approval probably helped its case.[26] Thus its attestation in the early church is clearly weak.

Kruger, as stated above, notes those who acknowledge its canonicity: Origen (c. AD 254; who used it, calling it Scripture, though he had some doubts about its authorship), Athanasius (c. AD 373), Gregory of Nazianzus (c. AD 390), Jerome (c. AD 420), and Augustine (c. AD 430).[27] Notably, Jerome believed that the different linguistic

21. Bauckham admits that the interpretation of "Fathers" as OT fathers has "the weight of usage," R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 290.

22. Ibid., 13. Bauckham's view restricts him to a window that is post-apostolic but pre-second century. However, if 3:4 is as Kruger states, the window may be more like AD 50-90.

23. Ibid., 163.

24. Ibid.

25. Ibid., 162-3.

26. Ibid. 163.

27. For the full discussion of 2 Peter and Church Fathers, see M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of Peter," 649-51. See also B. Warfield, "The Canonicity of Second Peter," *Southern Presbyterian Review* 33, no. 1 (January 1881): 45-75 (54-64). The dates of deaths are supplied by K. Aland in K. Aland et al., eds., *The Greek New Testament*, 3rd ed. (Stuttgart: United Bible Societies, 1975),

styles of 1 and 2 Peter were due to "different amanuenses" (i.e., different secretaries).[28] Kruger says, "After Jerome's time, there were no further doubts concerning 2 Peter's place in the NT canon."[29] While 2 Peter is absent from some canonical lists such as "the Muratorian Fragment (c. 180)," Kruger says that this does not mean it was absent due to rejection.[30] The earliest papyrus containing 2 Peter is $\mathfrak{P}^{72}$ (found within the Miscellaneous Codex): c. AD 250-300.[31] Interestingly, this codex contains 1 and 2 Peter, Jude, Psalm 33 and 34 (LXX), and other books, thus suggesting a high view of 1 and 2 Peter.[32] It is also included in "Codex Sinaiticus (4th century), Codex Vaticanus (4th century), and Codex Alexandrinus (5th century)."[33] Ultimately, 2 Peter was accepted into the canon based on the belief that Peter wrote it.[34] Kruger makes a

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xxxvii-ix. Here are the citations for each of these Church Fathers: Origen, *Homilies on Joshua*, Hom. 7.1, trans. Barbara J. Bruce, *Ancient Christian Writers* 71 (New York: Paulist Press, 2002), 74, https://books.google.com/books?id=Yq6reMY6KMUC&pg=PA74&source=gbs_toc_r&cad=1#v=onepage&q&f=false; Athanasius of Alexandria, "Festal Letter 39," *Early Church Texts*, accessed April 10, 2026, https://earlychurchtexts.com/public/athanasius_39th_festal_letter.htm; Gregory of Nazianzus, "Concerning the Genuine Books of Divinely Inspired Scripture," *Bible Research*, accessed April 10, 2026, https://www.bible-researcher.com/gregory.html; Jerome, *Epistula 120 (Ad Hedibiam)*, in *Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers*, 2nd ser., vol. 6, trans. W. H. Fremantle (New York: Christian Literature Publishing Co., 1893), accessed April 9, 2026, https://www.tertullian.org/fathers/jerome_hedibia_2_trans.htm; and Augustine, *On the Spirit and the Letter (De spiritu et literra*), chap. 52. In *Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers,* First Series, vol. 5. Translated by Peter Holmes and Robert Ernest Wallis. Buffalo, NY: Christian Literature Publishing Co., 1887. New Advent, https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/1502.htm.

28. Ibid., 650. For a discussion of the linguistic differences and similarities, see R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 143-147; and M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," 656-61. For Jerome's mention of two interpreters for 1 and 2 Peter, respectively, see Jerome, *Epistula 120 (Ad Hedibiam)*. It can be found under question #11.

29. Ibid.

30. Ibid.

31. For a detailed discussion of the significance of this manuscript, see P. Strickland, "The Curious Case of $\mathfrak{P}^{72}$: What an Ancient Manuscript Can Tell Us about the Epistles of Peter and Jude," *JETS* 57, no. 4 (December 2014): 781-91. The dating is found on p. 784.

32. Strickland, in ibid., states that, in addition to this Miscellaneous Codex, the community who had $\mathfrak{P}^{72}$ also had a "third century copy of 1 Peter, written in Sahidic Coptic" and "Psalms 33 and 34 were probably included in the Miscellaneous Codex because of the use of those psalms in 1 Peter…[and] the decision to include Melito's *Paschal Homily*…is probably largely due to Melito's literary dependence upon 1 Peter," 789. It appears, then, that the community who owned the Miscellaneous Codex may have seen the Petrine tradition, including 2 Peter, as *authoritative texts* in the middle third to beginning of the fourth century, the time during, or after, Origen's lifetime.

33. M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," 651.

34. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 264.

helpful point: the letter was accepted as Petrine despite its early controversy and the presence of pseudo-Petrine literature; and we ought to at the least acknowledge that this may be evidence that the letter is from Peter.[35]

Analysis and Conclusion

In my research, I found both sides of the argument for and against Petrine authorship to provide helpful information to the discussion. However, I found the pro-Petrine arguments sufficient to challenge the conclusion that Peter did not write it. From the dating of the letter, it seems that it was probably written in the first century, perhaps reaching early enough for Peter to have been the author.[36] From the Church Fathers, it is clear that some questioned the letter but ultimately accepted it as coming from Peter. There is more to discuss, such as the internal evidence; however, based on the external evidence, it seems plausible to me that Peter wrote 2 Peter and that it therefore holds its rightful place in the NT canon right after 1 Peter, his first canonical letter.

35. M. Kruger, "The Authenticity of 2 Peter," 651. He also writes, "Is it so easy to dismiss the conclusions of Origen, Cyril of Jerusalem, Gregory Nazianzen, Ephiphanius, Athanasius, Augustine, Rufinus, Jerome, and the church councils of Laodicea, Hippo and Carthage?"

36. It is questionable whether Peter wrote the letter with his own hand or whether he used a secretary. Jerome believed Peter used a secretary. See *Epistula 120*; also, this view is suggested as "quite possible" by T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 265. Some scholars, such as B. Ehrman, question whether Peter would have even been capable of writing the letter, supposing that he was illiterate. See B. Ehrman, "But Could Peter Write Anything?" *YouTube* video, 42:44, posted 2024, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PshpCo28UpE. For a counter discussion of ancient illiteracy, see P. Eddy and G. Boyd, *The Jesus Legend: A Case for the Historical Reliability of the Synoptic Jesus Tradition* (Grand Rapids, MI: Baker Academic, 2007), 241-52 (249-50).

Dating

For discussion of the dating, see Excursus above. To summarize, it seems to me that the dating of the letter must have been before Peter died in c. 64-5 AD. Depending on if one believes Jude used 2 Peter or vice versa (see "Relationship with Jude" below) and if the dating of Jude is in the 50s AD, then the dating for 2 Peter would be sometime between c. 50-64/5 AD, probably closer to 60 AD.

Audience

Understanding who Peter wrote this letter to is a hard question to solve. However, there are some clues left in the letter as to who his audience might have been.

Destination: The Same as 1 Peter?

TEXT

Recipients

1. A Jewish Audience?

When evaluating if the audience of 2 Peter is Jewish, what jumps out is the clear use of the OT (e.g., 2 Peter 2:4-8, 15-16, 22; 3:2?[1], 4[2], 5-6). These are simply the most obvious references as you read the letters. For more allusions, connections, and the like, see "The Use of OT" (p. 33ff). M. Harmon is right: "The frequently allusive manner in which 2 Peter…use[s] the OT assumes the reader is so familiar with those OT persons and events that even a name or a brief phrase is enough to evoke the entire OT context of that reference."[3] This seems to give weight to a Jewish audience.

Another piece of evidence for a Jewish audience may be Gal 2:7-8 along with the narrative of Acts. Peter was distinguished as the apostle

1. It may be that the term "holy prophets" may be a reference to OT prophets. For more on this, see comments on the passage below.

2. "The Fathers" seems to be a reference to the OT fathers. For more on this, see p. 39 and also footnote 21 there.

3. Matthew S. Harmon, "Jude and the Second Letter of Peter," in *Dictionary of the New Testament Use of the Old Testament*, ed. G. K. Beale et al. (Grand Rapids: Baker Academic, 2023), 415.

to the Jews. This would logically lead to assume that the work Peter was doing at the end of his life was the same as in the days of Acts, some 30 years before. However, there is still evidence for a Gentile audience.

Another piece of evidence here is the spelling of Peter's name in verse 1: "Simon Peter." In fair amount of the manuscripts, it is actually "Simeon Peter."[4] It is here that Davids notes that "Simon" is a common Greek name yet "Simeon" is a common Jewish name.[5] Thus he states, "Our author knows what Peter was called in Jewish (especially Aramaic-speaking) circles and so is probably a Jew himself, despite his command of Greek."[6]

2. A Gentile Audience?

It took me a long time before I read 1:1 carefully enough to see what it said: "To those who have received a faith of the same kind as ours." NA28 cross references Acts 11:17, which says, "Therefore if God gave to them [the Gentiles; Cornelius and his household] *the same gift as He gave to us also after believing in the Lord Jesus Christ*, who was I that I could stand in God's way?" (Italics added). In Acts 11:17, Peter (interesting) relays to the Jews in Jerusalem that God has revealed that the Gentiles are able to be saved. The way God revealed this was in a dream and the Holy Spirit falling upon Cornelius and his household in Acts 10 (see 10:44). Peter comments in 11:17 that God had given the Gentiles "the same gift" (the Holy Spirit) as He had given to the apostles (and Jews?). So, does Acts 11:17 shed light on the audience referred to in 2 Peter 1:1?

> Richard Bauckham picks up on this connection and comments:
>
> This [phrase in 2 Peter 1:1] has been understood either as a comparison between Jewish Christians, of whom Peter is one, and the Gentile Christian readers (cf. Peter's words in Acts 11:17; 15:9, 11) (so Plumptre, Mayor, Boobyer, Leaney; Hanse in *TDNT* 4, 2), or as a comparison between the apostles, of whom Peter is one, and the readers, who

4. See H. A. G. Houghton, *A Textual Commentary on the Greek New Testament: A Companion to the Sixth Edition of the United Bible Societies' Greek New Testament* (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2025), 349. He rates the "Simeon" reading as a level B in confidence.

5. Peter H. Davids, *The Letters of 2 Peter and Jude*, Pillar New Testament Commentary (Grand Rapids: Eerdmans, 2006), 160.

6. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 160.

> are not apostles (so Spitta, Lumby, James, Moffatt, Reicke, Spicq; Zahn, *Introduction*, 206–7; Stählin in *TDNT* 3, 349). The latter is more probable because there is no other trace of the Jewish-Gentile issue in this letter, and because in that case the first person plural is being used in the same sense as later in the chapter (vv 16–18).[7]

So, in Bauckham's understanding, if there is a connection with Acts 11:17 (and also helpful, Acts 15:11), the understanding of 2 Peter 1 would be Jewish Christians exhorting Gentile Christians. Notice the pronouns in 1 chapter 1: "Our," "Us," "We," and "You." In 1:1-4a it is "Our" and "Us." In 1:4b-15 it is "You." In 1:16-19 it is "We" and "You."

It seems clear to me (and Bauckham) that in 1:16-18, the two groups being mentioned are "We" apostles and "You" Christians. However, is that what is meant in 1:1-15?

According to Bauckham, the view that 1:1-15 is apostles and Christians (generally) is the most likely. This seems reasonable to me as well.[8] However, it is interesting what Peter says in 1:4: "having escaped the corruption that is in the world by lust." In one sense that would be true of Jews, but the statement to me seems to be a comment that would be more applicable to the Gentiles, who would have *literally* come out of the world. Even if Bauckham is right that the audience is both Jews and Gentiles, it seems to me that there is a special emphasis on the Gentile audience of the letter.

As for Gal 2:7-8 and Acts? Notice Gal 2:7. Paul is noted as the apostle to the Gentiles, who is also mentioned in 2 Peter 3:15-16. Peter says that Paul "wrote to you" (3:15). Paul often wrote to churches that were made up of both Jews and Gentiles. If 2 Peter was written to a specific church, then it seems logical to say that the audience is a mix of Jews and Gentiles. And Acts, while Peter is the apostle to the Jews, it was he who first taught the Gospel to the Gentiles (Acts 10).

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7. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 167.

8. So also Gary Fisher, "II Peter 1," *Liveforit 2 Peter Study*, podcast audio, October 20, 2020, https://www.liveforit.us/new-testament/2-peter, minute 14:55. For my position that the "We" / "Our" in 2 Peter 1 is a reference to the apostles, I am indebted to Andy Cantrell in a private conversation during the summer of 2026. For a discussion from Cantrell on this, see Andy Cantrell and Ben Hall, "An Introduction to 2 Peter," *BibleABCs with Andy Cantrell & Ben Hall*, YouTube video, June 3, 2025, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gqnbWHHlkVs, minute 13:21. So also Davids in P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 161-162.

Additionally, the idea of "grace and peace" in 1:2 is helpful here. Davids comments, "The greeting arises from the typical Hebraic greeting of 'peace' (*shalom*, meaning 'total well-being') plus the typical Greek greeting of [*χαίρειν*] (as in Jas 1:1), morphed into the Judeo-Christian 'grace' ([χάρις])."[9] Thus even the greeting may point to a Jew-Gentile audience.[10]

When all of this is examined, it seems that the audience Peter wrote to was probably a mixed group with special focus on the Gentiles in some sections and the Jews with their Scriptures in others.

2 Peter Sources

TEXT

1. Jude

There is very little question, 2 Peter and Jude are deeply connected. Notice this chart by Schreiner[11]:

Jude	2 Peter
[4] For certain men whose condemnation was written about long ago have secretly slipped in among you. They … deny Jesus Christ our only Sovereign and Lord.	2:1 There will be false teachers among you. They will secretly introduce destructive heresies. even denying the sovereign Lord who bought them
[4] For certain men whose condemnation was written about long ago	2:3 Their condemnation has long been hanging over them, and their destruction has not been sleeping.
[6] And the angels who did not keep their positions of authority but abandoned their own home—these he has kept in darkness, bound with everlasting chains for judgment on the great Day.	2:4 For if God did not spare angels when they sinned, but sent them to hell, putting them into gloomy dungeons to be held for judgment.

9. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 164.

10. Although it must be noted that this was a very common greeting and thus may not necessarily be a deliberate attempt by Peter to point out two groups of people in his audience.

11. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 416-417.

[8] these dreamers pollute their own bodies, reject authority and slander celestial beings.	2:10 This is especially true of those who follow the corrupt desire of the sinful nature and despise authority. Bold and arrogant, these men are not afraid to slander celestial beings.
[9] But even the archangel Michael, when he was disputing with the devil about the body of Moses, did not dare to bring a slanderous accusation against him, but said, "The Lord rebuke you!"	2:11 yet even angels, although they are stronger and more powerful, do not bring slanderous accusations against such beings in the presence of the Lord.
[10] Yet these men speak abusively against whatever they do not understand; and what things they do understand by instinct, like unreasoning animals—these are the very things that destroy them.	2:12 But these men blaspheme understand. They are like brute beasts, creatures of instinct, born only to be caught and destroyed, and like beasts they too will perish.
[11] they have rushed for profit into Balaam's error.	2:15 They have left the straight way and wandered off to follow the way of Balaam son of Beor, who loved the wages of wickedness.
[12] These men are blemishes at your love feasts, eating with you without the slightest qualm—shepherds who feed only themselves.	2:13 They are blots and blemishes, reveling in their pleasures while they feast with you.
[12] They are clouds without rain	2:17 These men are springs without water
[13] for whom blackest darkness has been reserved forever	2:17 Blackest darkness is reserved for them.
[16] they boast about themselves	2:18 For they mouth empty, boastful words
[17–18] But, dear friends, remember what the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ foretold. They said to	3:2–3 I want you to recall the words spoken in the past by the holy prophets and the command

you, "In the last times there will be scoffers who will follow their own ungodly desires."

given by our Lord and Savior through your apostles. First of all, you must understand that in the last days scoffers will come, scoffing and following their own evil desires.

To put it succinctly, 2 Peter 2:1-3:3 and Jude 4-18 line up closer than simply coincidence. Something is going on here and it would be irresponsible to ignore, dismiss, or flat out claim there is not a literary dependence. The question, then, is not if one used the other, but rather, who used who?

Callan writes, "For the most part 2 Peter has not adapted Jude by quoting it directly. While 2 Peter contains many of the words and some phrases found in Jude, no sentence of Jude is quoted in 2 Peter."[12] (For now, let us assume (as Callan argues) 2 Peter used Jude.) There are a few places where 2 Peter seems to *almost* quote Jude—perhaps "borrow" is a better word.[13]

Jude 13b[14]	2 Peter 2:17b
οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους εἰς αἰῶνα τετήρηται.[15]	οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους τετήρηται.[16]
Jude 17-18	**2 Peter 3:2-3**
17 Ὑμεῖς δέ, ἀγαπητοί, μνήσθητε τῶν ῥημάτων τῶν προειρημένων ὑπὸ τῶν ἀποστόλων τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ **18** ὅτι ἔλεγον ὑμῖν ἐπ᾽ ἐσχάτου χρόνου ἔσονται ἐμπαῖκται κατὰ τὰς	**2** μνησθῆναι τῶν προειρημένων ῥημάτων ὑπὸ τῶν ἁγίων προφητῶν καὶ τῆς τῶν ἀποστόλων ὑμῶν ἐντολῆς τοῦ κυρίου καὶ σωτῆρος. **3** τοῦτο πρῶτον γινώσκοντες ὅτι

12. Terrance Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude by the Second Letter of Peter," *Biblica* 85 (2004): 42.

13. Callan says, "it seems that 2 Peter's use of Jude can best be described as a rather free paraphrase." See T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 43.

14. Chart thanks to T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 42-43. He includes several more of these charts, showing relationship between Jude 4-5 and 2 Peter 2:1-3, Jude 5-8a and 2 Peter 2:4-10a, Jude 8b-11 and 2 Peter 2:10b-16, Jude 12-16 and 2 Peter 2:17-22, and Jude 17-18 and 2 Peter 3:1-3. One does not need to understand Greek to see the connections. However, I attached the English translations for clarity.

15. "For whom the black darkness has been reserved forever."

16. "For whom the black darkness has been reserved."

ἑαυτῶν ἐπιθυμίας πορευόμενοι τῶν ἀσεβειῶν.[17]	ἐλεύσονται ἐπ᾽ ἐσχάτων τῶν ἡμερῶν ἐν ἐμπαιγμονῇ ἐμπαῖκται κατὰ τὰς ἰδίας ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι.[18]

Callan notes that 2 Peter used 80 of Jude's 311 words directly while also using synonyms for an additional 7, thus Peter used 28% of Jude 4-18.[19] 2 Peter 2:1-3:3 has 426 words, so the 87 words from Jude constitute 20% of this section of 2 Peter.[20]

The messages of 2 Peter and Jude are different. Jude seeks to "critique…the immoral behavior of its opponents" while 2 Peter argues "against both the teaching and the behavior of its opponents," thus Peter adapts what he can from Jude but is unable to follow it exceedingly close.[21] 2 Peter is also dealing with false teachers in the future while Jude is dealing with them in the present.[22]

It is interesting how Peter takes Jude 4 and disperses its contents across 2:1-3.[23] Also interesting that Peter takes Jude 6 and its reference to *1 Enoch* and glosses over it, "replacing these phrases [from Jude 6] with a single participle describing the angels as ones who had sinned."[24] The removal of *1 Enoch*, Callan suggests, may have been the author of 2 Peter's attempt "to minimize reference to non-biblical literature."[25]

Peter also attempts to make Jude's comments more explicit: 2 Peter 2:4 and Jude 6, 2 Peter 2:7 and Jude 7, and perhaps others.[26] At

17. "But you, beloved, ought to remember the words that were spoken beforehand by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ, that they were saying to you, "In the last time there will be mockers, following after their own ungodly lusts."

18. "That you should remember the words spoken beforehand by the holy prophets and the commandment of the Lord and Savior *spoken* by your apostles. Know this first of all, that in the last days mockers will come with *their* mocking, following after their own lusts."

19. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 43.

20. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 43.

21. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 44.

22. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 44.

23. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 48.

24. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 49.

25. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 50.

26. See discussion in T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 49-51. The entire article is an attempt to understand how Peter used Jude, so more connections may be dispersed in its discussion. On p. 63, he says, "The author [of 2 Peter] seems to have wanted to clarify obscurities in the Jude material. He did this both by the addition of words and phrases and by making the connections of the argument more explicit, as he does in 2 Pet 2,10b-11 and 18. However,

other times, Peter redacts and changes Jude, as when he seemingly avoids the reference to *1 Enoch*. Callan writes, "2 Peter omitted this, perhaps in order to avoid the citation of a writing not found in the bible."[27] He cites Fernberg who "suggests that *1 Enoch* may not have been known to the Gentile readers of 2 Peter and it would have been 'dangerous' to seek support from it."[28]

Callan concludes by summarizing his work. He says that 2 Peter adapted Jude's material and transformed it into a warning concerning false teachers in the future.[29] He then gives a synopsis of how 2 Peter used Jude:

> 2 Pet 2,1-3 also revised Jude 4 in various ways to make it a critique of false teachers. 2 Pet 2,4-10a revised Jude 5-8a into an elaborate refutation of the doctrine of the false teachers. 2 Pet 2,10b-22 revised Jude 8b-16, which criticizes the behavior of its opponents, into a critique both of the behavior of the false teachers and of their malign effect on others. Jude 17-18 argues that the rise of its opponents had been predicted; 2 Pet 3,1-3 revised this to make the same point concerning the false teachers.[30]

But the question remains, *who used who*? Is Callan right in suggesting that 2 Peter adapted Jude?

A. Who Used Who?

The vast majority of the time, it has been stated (and perhaps assumed) that 2 Peter used Jude. Part of the reason for this is the dating of the letters.[31] However, what is the evidence that 2 Peter used Jude versus Jude using 2 Peter?

Callan himself notes, "2 Pet 2,1 changed the aorist of Jude 4 into future tense."[32] I had a discussion in the summer of 2026 in which a

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unsurprisingly, his revision is at times more obscure than the Jude material with which he began. This is especially true in 2,10b-16."

27. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 59.

28. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 59.

29. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 62.

30. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 63.

31. Some suggest Jude was written in the 50s AD while 2 Peter was written either before Peter died in 64-65 AD or much later, say 80s-90s AD. See Excurses B for more discussion on dating (pp. 48f).

32. T. Callan, "Use of the Letter of Jude," 63.

friend of mine pointed out this very same idea to me.[33] It is peculiar that Peter would change a past tense into a future tense if he was using Jude. There could be a very simply explanation for this: Peter is about to die (1:12-15) and thus wants to warn about the future no matter if the same warning is being used in the present (about a present danger) in another context. Put another way, Peter uses Jude's present situation to warn his own audience of how that same situation (or at least similar) could happen to them *in the future* if they do not heed his warnings. However, let explore the possibility that Jude used 2 Peter.

Typically, the question of "who used who" is connected to one's stance on authorship of these letters: if one believes Peter wrote 2 Peter, then Jude borrowed from him, or vice versa.[34] In a fascinating article by Mark Matthews, he challenges the status quo of 2 Peter's dependence on Jude solely on the basis of both letters' literacy.[35] In a word, he takes the approach most scholars use to discuss the "Synoptic Problem" and imports it into the discussion of 2 Peter and Jude and concludes that it makes more sense that Jude used 2 Peter than vice versa.[36]

Before continuing with Matthews' finds, I must explain, briefly, what the "Synoptic Problem" is.[37] For decades scholars have notice "serious" similarities between the three Synoptic Gospels (Matthew, Mark, and Luke). Not only do they contain many of the same stories, but even the *same details*. But it goes deeper. If one examines the Greek text of each of these gospels, it becomes clear that even *the word order* is the same at times.[38] Scholars for years have been debating what the literary relationship is. Probably the overarching opinion among

33. I am indebted to Scott Smelser for this observation, in a private conversion in the summer of 2026.

34. Mark D. Mathews, "The Literary Relationship of 2 Peter and Jude: Does the Synoptic Tradition Solve This Synoptic Problem?" *Neotestamentica* 44.1 (2010): 47. Matthews notes that those who believe Jude borrowed from Peter are Spitta, Brigg, and Wallace. Those who argue 2 Peter is inauthentic are Abbott, Mayor, Bauckham, and Kraus.

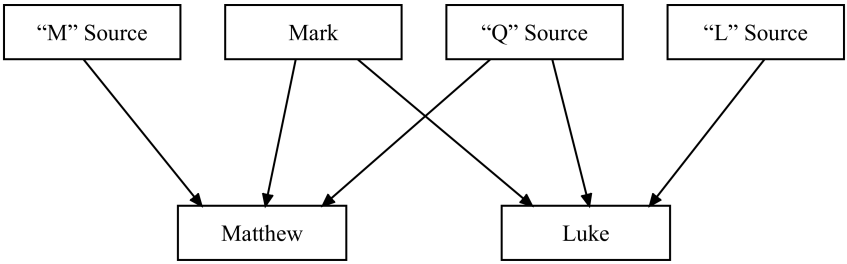
35. A link to a free copy of this article can be found in the biography entry for Matthews' article.

36. For a synopsis of his arguments, see his conclusion: M. Matthews, "The Literary Relationship of 2 Peter and Jude," 64.

37. You, the reader, may already know what I mean by "the Synoptic Problem" and the debates surrounding it, but I presume not all of my audience will, so I want to clear the air for those unfamiliar with the NT scholarship on the matter.

38. Word order in Greek is not as important as English. There is much more flexibility with where words can be placed in a sentence. Thus, this point is more striking than would be naturally apparent to a native English speaker, who would say, "Yes, of course the word order would be the same, that is how *English* works."

scholars is what is called the "four-source theory," which says that Mark was the first gospel written and Matthew and Luke both used Mark.[39]



Graph: Four-Source Theory

While this is not a commentary on the Gospels or the Synoptic Problem, I will note that I do believe this theory may prove to be helpful in better understanding the literary relationship between the Synoptics Gospels. However, I am not at all suggesting this is *the* correct theory, only something *like* this.

Now on to the observations scholars use to determine gospel-dependence on one another. Of all of them, the most important for our purposes is the observation that "a newer document tends to 'clean up' and 'clarify' an older one."[40] This makes sense because an author, who is using a source, is much less likely to complicate a more straightforward topic. We shall call this observation the *Clarify Theory* (CT).

39. It is called the "four-source theory" because there are four sources being used by Luke and Matthew: Mark, a hypothetic source designated "Q," the "M" source (material only found in Matthew), and the "L" source (material only found in Luke).

40. For more on the Synoptic Problem, see Craig L. Blomberg, *Matthew*, New American Commentary 22 (Nashville: Broadman & Holman, 1992), 37-40. For a fuller discussion, see Donald Guthrie, "The Synoptic Problem," in *New Testament Introduction*, 136-208. Blomberg says, "Mark is the most vivid, his rough grammar is smoothed out by Matthew and Luke, potentially embarrassing or misleading details are reworded (cf., e.g., Matt 19:16–17 with Mark 10:17–18), and individual passages are more often than not abbreviated" (p. 38). Also note Guthrie, "In many cases grammatical improvements are observed when Matthew and Luke are compared with the parallel passage in Mark, *e.g.* redundant negatives, unusual words and difficult constructions are absent" (p. 151).

Returning to Matthews' article, he uses CT to test the consensus that 2 Peter used Jude.[41] He gives examples of the arguments scholars use for the Synoptic Problem I just described in the previous paragraph.[42] He says, "If these kinds of grammatical corrections argue so strongly for Markan priority [that Mark was the first gospel written due in part because of its rougher Greek in comparison with the other Gospels], what does this have to say about 2 Peter and Jude? Any student of 2 Peter is aware of its poor grammar and style in relation to Jude's relatively good Greek, polished style and tight structure."[43] And later, "Thus, the consensus in modern scholarship, especially as regards grammarians, is that 2 Peter employs poor Greek grammar and style. This is especially true in relation to the epistle of Jude."[44] Matthew helpful states, "One can posit reasons why one author may rework material to suit his own purposes, but to suppose that one another would deliberately change good grammar to bad is far less plausible."[45] The passages he uses to argue his case are 2 Peter 2:4-10a with Jude 5-8, 2 Peter 2:12-13a with Jude 10, 2 Peter 2:13b with Jude 12a, and 2 Peter 3:2-3 with Jude 17-18. His conclusion: "If the argument from grammar holds true in favour of Markan priority, the evidence put forth here makes it possible to suggest that 2 Peter is also prior."[46]

This is not the only theory scholars have proposed. Bauckham notes four explanations for 2 Peter and Jude's literary relationship: (1) Jude used 2 Peter, (2) 2 Peter used Jude, (3) both used a common source, or (4) both letters were written by the same individual.[47]

(1) We have already examined this explanation.

(2) We will examine this view in a moment.

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41. He does not call use "CT" in his article. This is a term I have employed for clarity.

42. See M. Matthews, "The Literary Relationship of 2 Peter and Jude," 48-50. He says, "These examples represent only a few of the many instances in which Matthew and Luke have *improved* Mark's poor grammar and style" (p. 50).

43. M. Matthew, "The Literary Relationship of 2 Peter and Jude," 50.

44. M. Matthews, "The Literary Relationship of 2 Peter and Jude," 51. While Bauckham notes 2 Peter uses an "Asiatic" style, Matthew counters, "'Asianism' was not so much a style as it was a pejorative term for Greek Hellenistic writing that showed a lack of restraint or inability to use sententious phrases" (p. 51). Note also that Bauckham says, "Second Peter's style is so consistent that its author must in any case have rewritten his source fairly freely." See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 142.

45. M. Matthews, "The Literary Relationship of 2 Peter and Jude," 54.

46. M. Matthews, "The Literary Relationship of 2 Peter and Jude," 64.

47. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 141.

(3) Unless both letters are using the common source extremely closely, this explanation is less appealing to account for the *close* relationship of 2 Peter 2:1-3 with Jude 4.[48]

(4) It seems unlikely this explanation can account for the closeness. Would an author "plagiarize" (to use modern terminology) himself like this? Also, the style and background of these letters are so different a common author is against this explanation.[49]

Let us examine (2) more closely. Bauckham says,

> The most important literary reason for preferring 2 Peter's dependence on Jude to the opposite hypothesis [Jude used 2 Peter] is that this commentary shows Jude 4-18 to be a piece of writing whose detailed structure and wording has been composed with exquisite care, whereas the corresponding parts of 2 Peter, while by no means carelessly composed, are by comparison more loosely structured.[50]

Bauckham goes on to argue that he believes it is less likely Jude read 2 Peter 2 and that passage caused him to think to use it for his midrashic purposes than for 2 Peter to read Jude's more elaborate version and change it.[51] Bauckham goes on, "There are cases where a more complex literary work is based on a simpler one, and *a priori* that might even seem a more likely procedure, but consideration of this particular case seems to indicate that it must be one in which the more complex work is prior."[52]

Mayor also argues for the priority of Jude.[53] When discussing Jude's message about the new dangers within the church, Mayor states that "it seems hardly possible" that Jude received the idea to alarm his

48. So R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 141. Note what he says next, "The common source would have had to have covered so much of the content of Jude and Jude's own contribution would have been so small, that it is hard to see why he bothered." However, Bauckham does note that Jude 1-3, 20-23 would, in this explanation, be Jude's contribution, which also is "the author's main purpose in writing" (p. 141).

49. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 141.

50. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 142.

51. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 142. "Midrash" is a term used for a specific, ancient Jewish way of interpreting Scripture.

52. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 142.

53. See full discussion in J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, i-xxv.

readers from 2 Peter.[54] On Jude 5-7 with 2 Peter 2:4-9, Mayor says, "If P. had J. before him, these omissions are natural: if J. wrote after P., he would scarcely have gone out of his way to insert particulars so derogatory to the angelic nature."[55] Helpfully, he notes that 2 Peter 2:6 ("An example to those who would live ungodly lives thereafter") "is better expressed than Jude's rather confused" version in Jude 7 ("An example in undergoing the punishment of eternal life").[56] Additionally, Mayor says 2 Peter seems to make his charge against the false teachers stronger, calling them "brute beasts" in 2 Peter 2:12, while Jude simply says that "the libertines" have "animal instincts" in Jude 10.[57] (So if Jude used 2 Peter, he must have made the statement more general as compared to 2 Peter's more blunt exclamation.) However, then he says, "Here [2 Peter 2:12 and Jude 10] there can be no doubt that P.'s language is far more obscure than that of J" but "even J. is not quite clear."[58] Mayor wonders if 2 Peter may be using "an imperfect recollection of J." (writing from memory?) and "understood ἐν τούτοις φθείρονται to mean 'perish among them,' *i.e.* among the brutes."[59]

Next, Mayor looks at Jude 8 and 10 with 2 Peter 2:10 and 2:12. Mayor sees Jude 8-10 as a bit difficult to understand, but using *Ascensio Mosis*, the text is easier. But 2 Peter is not as understandable. Mayor says, "Standing by itself, [2 Peter 2:10-12, esp. verse 9] is merely a riddle, for which the answer is to be found in J."[60] Then, "That is to say, P. wrote with J.'s sentence in his mind, but for some reason or other chose to eliminate the points essential for its intelligibility."[61] Mayor suggests that the reason 2 Peter did this was because the author "objects…to make use of these apocryphal writings [like 1 Enoch], and generalizes the story by dropping the proper names and by twice

54. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, ii.
55. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, vi.
56. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, viii. Peter: "ὑπόδειγμα μελλόντω ἀσεβέσιν." Jude: "πρόκεινται δεῖγμα πυρὸς αἰωνίου δίκην ὑπέχουσαι."
57. "Like unreasoning animals, born as creatures of instinct to be captured and killed" (2 Peter 2:12). "They know by instinct, like unreasoning animals" (Jude 10). Mayor uses the word "brute" to show 2 Peter's stronger emphasis in the verse as compared to Jude. See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, viii.
58. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, viii.
59. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, viii.
60. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, ix.
61. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, ix.

changing a singular into a plural (ἄγγελοι, αὐτῶν)."[62] Mayor also notes other times in these passages that 2 Peter seems vaguer than Jude.[63] Mayor concludes the sentence (2 Peter 2:10b-11) "is meaningless expect to one who was already acquainted with its parallel in J." but suggests that Dr. Brigg's suggestion may be true: "P. felt himself justified in his generalization by the remembrance of an obscure passage in the Book of Enoch."[64]

Mayor gives another helpful note with Jude 13 with 2 Peter 2:17. He says that 2 Peter has now returned to Jude's metaphors. He asked, "How could the latter [Jude] have had the patience to gather the scattered fragments out of P. in order to form the splendid cluster of figures in *vv.* 12, 13?"[65] He also says that Jude 19 is more obscure than 2 Peter 3:4.[66] Then he says that it is hard to imagine Jude not including what the mockers say in 2 Peter 3:4 if he knew 2 Peter.[67]

2. OT

For how 2 Peter used the OT, see "The Use of OT" on p. 33ff.

3. Jewish Writings

TEXT

4. Hellenism

TEXT

Originally in Aramaic?

See Michael Green, Chaine, Wohlenberg

62. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, ix.
63. "So too a vague παρὰ Κυρίῳ takes the place of ἐπιτιμήσαι σοι Κύριος, and the vagueness is increased by the use of the indeterminate αὐτῶν and by the omission of the object of the comparative μείζονες." See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, ix.
64. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, ix.
65. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, xi.
66. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, xiii.
67. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, xiii.

2 Peter

1:1-4

"[1]*Simon Peter, a bond-servant and apostle of Jesus Christ, To those who have received a faith of the same kind as ours, by the righteousness of our God and Savior, Jesus Christ**: [2]Grace and peace be multiplied to you in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord; [3]seeing that His divine power has granted to us everything pertaining to life and godliness, through the true knowledge of Him who called us by His own glory and excellence. [4]For by these He has granted to us His precious and magnificent promises, so that by them you may become partakers of the divine nature, having escaped the corruption that is in the world by lust.*"

1 "SIMON PETER." For a detailed discussion of the authorship of 2 Peter, see Introduction to 2 Peter (p. 56ff). In this commentary, I will be taking the position that the letter was, in fact, written by the apostle Peter, probably sometime in the early 60s.

"A BOND-SERVANT AND APOSTLE OF JESUS CHRIST." These are both common introductions in NT letters.[1] As bond-servant, Peter has put himself under the servitude and leadership of Jesus. He now no longer is a mere Galilean fisherman. Instead, his mission has become to serve Jesus by any means necessary. His primary way he serves Jesus is by being one of His apostles. Thomas Schreiner notes: "The term [servant], then, not only suggests humility but the honor of serving

* There is a text-critical question here. See p. 59 for a chart of alternate readings.

1. "Bond-servant": Rom 1:1, Phil 1:1, Titus 1:1, James 1:1, Jude 1:1, Rev 1:1; "Apostle": Rom 1:1, 1 Cor 1:1, 2 Cor 1:1, Gal 1:1, Eph 1:1, Col 1:1, 1 Tim 1:1, 2 Tim 1:1, Titus 1:1, 1 Pet 1:1

Jesus Christ" much like other characters in the Bible (e.g., Moses in Deut 34:5 and Paul in Rom 1:1).[2] As a slave, Peter belongs to Jesus.[3] There are a few layers to this term "apostle." Firstly, it shows his special role and relationship to Christ. Peter walked with Jesus on earth. He was chosen to be part of Jesus' close group of followers called "the 12 disciples" or "the apostles." It was this group that Jesus gave special authority to (Matt 10:1, Mark 10:14-15, Luke 9:1) and the Holy Spirit in miraculous ways (John 14:16-17, 16:6, 13, Acts 1:8, 2:3-4, and so on). These were the men who would become leaders in the early church (Acts 6:2, 15:6). Second, the apostles were Jesus' representatives, meaning they were the ones carrying His message to the churches.[4] These two aspects of apostleship give Peter an important, let us say, rock to stand on. He had the authority from Jesus Christ to issue a letter of warning to these Christians.[5]

"TO THOSE WHO HAVE RECEIVED A FAITH OF THE SAME KIND AS OURS." For comments on this phrase, see "A Gentile Audience?" (pp. 65ff). In summary, it seems to me that this may have a connection to Acts 11:17 and 15:11,[6] but the primary application is found in the apostles ("ours") and the general audience (designated as "you" in ch.

2. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 284.

3. So Gary Fisher, "II Peter 1," minute 14:40.

4. "Apostle" is "one who fulfills the role of being a special messenger." See Johannes P. Louw and Eugene Albert Nida, in *Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament: Based on Semantic Domains* (New York: United Bible Societies, 1996), 541.

5. So T. Schreiner when he writes: "The term 'apostle' in some contexts may refer to missionaries or messengers (Rom 16:7; 2 Cor 8:23; Phil 2:25), but neither of those meanings fits here. Peter was speaking more technically of those whom Jesus Christ specially called and appointed to serve as apostles (Matt 10:1–11:1; Mark 3:13–19; cf. Acts 1:21–26). The authority of the apostles is communicated in 2 Pet 3:2 and the high estimate of Paul (2 Pet 3:15–16). Peter, therefore, was not merely sharing his opinion in his letter. He wrote as a commissioned slave of Jesus Christ and his appointed apostle. He wrote authoritatively to a church threatened by false teachers." See T. Schreiner, *1,2 Peter, Jude*, 284-285. Interestingly, Davids examines many of the NT letters' introductions and concludes, "Thus, in comparing this title [in 2 Peter 1:1] to those in the other letters, it appears that 'servant' is the expected title, while 'apostle' is added because of the need to assert the authority of the sender. That is, in letters where the congregation accepts the authority of the sender, the title 'apostle' is not used. The use of this title marks out this letter as something of an official letter rather than, for example, a friendly letter." See P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 161.

6. While he does not cite these passages, T. Schreiner does note: "Peter did not identify the recipients geographically, though they probably were Gentiles." Schreiner questions why Peter's point would be "apostles" ("us") and "Christians" ("you"). Schreiner concludes that Peter probably is making a general reference that all Christians share the same blessings. See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 285-286.

1). Thus, Peter is saying, "You [Jewish and Gentiles Christians] have received the same kind of faith as ours [apostles]."

A helpful connection with this "apostle" and "Christian" distinction may be 1 John 1:1ff, where John distinguishes the eyewitnesses from the audience (see also 2 Peter 1:16ff).[7] It is there that John says "We" and "Our" (apostles) and then turns and says, "proclaimed *to you*" (audience) (italics added).

> "A FAITH." Green comments that what Peter is referring to is the faith or trust which brings a man salvation as he grasps the proffered hand of God. Faith is the God-given capacity to trust him, available alike to Jew and Gentile, to apostle and twentieth-century Christian. This equality of opportunity and status is all due to *the righteousness of our God* which refuses to make distinctions between the various recipients of his mercy and love.[8]

Thus "faith" here ought to be understood as the common way it is used in Scripture; namely, the act of putting one's trust in God because one believes in Him.

Davids wonders if Bauckham is right in viewing it as referring "to the ability to commit oneself" or if it is a reference to "a belief system/version of the good news."[9] He concludes, "It seems to me that the latter meaning fits better here, that is, a version of the good news that they have received from God."[10]

So is it a version of the good news or "faith" in the more traditional sense? I think either are possible. It is hard to know for sure.

"BY THE RIGHTEOUSNESS OF OUR GOD AND SAVIOR." Bauckham chooses to translate part of 1:1 as "*To those who have received a faith which through the justice of our God and Savior Jesus Christ is of equal privilege with ours*."[11] Bauckham suggests that God's "righteousness" (translated here, "justice") refers to "the fairness and lack of favoritism which gives equal privilege to all Christians."[12] Thus, Bauckham understands the phrase "By the righteousness of our God…" as

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7. So Cantrell, A. Cantrell and B. Hall, "An Introduction to 2 Peter," minute 31:02.
8. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 78.
9. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 162.
10. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 162. He goes on to warn, "However, this good news that demanded a commitment (faith) should not be made into a credal formula or system."
11. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 165.
12. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 168.

indicating that God treats all Christians equally.[13] An apostle is not "holier" or "greater" than any other Christian. We are all equal in God's presence. Michael Green likewise states, "There is no distinction between believers. All alike are sinners who owe their presence in the heavenly city to the amnesty of the King."[14]

Another interpretation would be to see "righteousness" here being used like Paul does in Romans and Galatians: God making us right with by forgiveness.[15]

"OUR GOD AND SAVIOR, JESUS CHRIST." For the text-critical issue here, see table on p. 89 and the surrounding discussion. This is a phrase that can be interpreted different ways. Some see two distinct persons: "Our God" and "Savior, Jesus Christ." Some see this phrase as a divine claim about Jesus "Our-God-and-Savior, *Jesus Christ*." Mayor notes that it could be a reference to Jesus being God (comparing it to a passage like John 20:28 or Titus 2:13), however, he goes on to state: "On the other hand the next verse [2 Peter 1:2] clearly distinguishes between God and Christ, and it is natural to let that interpret this, as there seems no reason for identity here and distinction there."[16] Contra Mayor, Green says points out that 2 Peter 1:2 intentionally distinguishes between God and Jesus, while verse 1 does not. "Probably, therefore, the author *is* calling Jesus God here."[17] Green continues by saying that the term "Savior" is a name given to God in the OT and now being given to Jesus, just like Peter did on the day of Pentecost (Acts 2:21).[18]

Bauckham states, "The absence of the article before σωτῆρος ("Savior") favors the latter, but is not decisive."[19] He gives evidence for both sides. In favor of Jesus being called God, he notes (1) the similar construct in 1:11, 3:18, cf. 2:20, 3:2 ("our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ"), but notes as Mayor does 1:2 in favor of a two-person

13. Contra Schreiner, who objects to this interpretation, stating, "The gift of faith given by God is not understood in the New Testament to be 'fair' but entirely of grace. Hence, God's righteousness here does not denote his fairness but his saving righteousness." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 286. Davids agrees with Bauckham. See P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 162-163.

14. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 78.

15. Fisher hesitantly prefers this view. See G. Fisher, "II Peter 1," minute 18:16.

16. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 81–82.

17. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 79. So also Fisher, G. Fisher, "II Peter 1," minute 20:50. Fisher notes handful of passages that (in his interpretation) call Jesus "God": Isaiah 9:6; John 1:1, 20:28; Titus 2:13; and Rom 9:5.

18. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 79.

19. R Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 168.

separation; (2) the doxology of 3:18, where "God" can be supplied instead of "Christ"; and (3) Perhaps also the usage should be seen as part of the writer's use of Hellenistic religious language."[20] In favor of the two-person separation view, he notes (1) the separation in 1:2; (2) Käsemann's argument that since 3:18 uses "Lord" while 1:1 uses "God," the writer must be making a clear distinctions, but Bauckham states that "there is no reason why variations…should not be used"; and (3) "God" (θεός) is rarely used of Jesus (except John 1:1, 20:28, and Heb 1:8-9. Possibly also Titus 2:13, 1 John 5:20, Rom 9:5, 2 Thess 1:12).[21] Bauckham concludes by stating it is impossible to know for sure if the author is trying to say Jesus is God in verse 1 or not.[22]

In my opinion, either option is viable. The view that it is two separate people ("Our God" and "Savior, Jesus Christ") may have slightly stronger evidence alongside 2 Peter 1:2, but it is true that Jesus is both called God or implied to be God in multiple passages in the NT, see citations above from Bauckham.

Davids here interestingly notes that, based on his view that Jesus is being called "God" here, this idea of "savior-god" may be being used by Peter due to the provenience of "saviors" / "savior-gods" in the Roman culture around him and his readers. He says, "If so, our author is showing sensitivity to his Gentile environment: Jesus it the true Savior-God (as opposed to Caesar and others as bogus savior-gods), who has granted his readers the honor of a faith equal to that of the apostles."[23]

2 "GRACE AND PEACE BE MULTIPLE TO YOU." For this phrase's connection with 1 Peter 1:2, see "Second Peter" under "Internal Similarities, Differences, and Connections" in *Excursus: The Communication of 1 and 2 Peter* (pp. 24f). See also "A Gentile Audience?" (pp. 65ff) for its possible note on Peter's audience.

Peter is wishing to extend both God's grace and peace to his audience. They would need both of these in their walk with God. They

20. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 168.

21. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 168.

22. Schreiner comments: "The grammar clearly indicates that Jesus Christ is called 'God' in this verse." Stating G. Sharp's rule: "when two singular nouns, which are not proper nouns, fall under the same article, they refer to the same entity." The NET Bible agrees with this. See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 286. Cf. Bauckham, "There is no improbability in 2 Peter's use of…"God"…for Jesus," in R. Bauckham, *2 Peter and Jude*, 169. Although, his ultimate conclusion is noting in the paragraph above. Davids agrees with Schreiner, stating, "The Greek more naturally implies that one person is being intended." See P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 163.

23. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 164.

would need grace their sins both past, present, and future. They would also need peace (especially in regard to their future dealings with false teachers, see ch. 2!).

Schriner states,

> The term 'peace' represents a typical Jewish greeting, and the order may be significant. Those upon whom God has bestowed his grace experience his peace. Peter prayed that God would multiply his grace and peace in the lives of the readers, for he knew that their progress in the Christian life depended upon God alone.[24]

"IN THE KNOWLEDGE OF GOD AND OF JESUS OUR[25] LORD." For comments on the text-critical question on the different readings of this verse, see below (p. 89). This phrase is repeated in 1:8, 2:20, and 3:18. Here, it seems that the idea is that the grace and peace Peter wishes upon his audience will come to them as they continue to learn about God and Jesus (grow in *knowledge*). The more they learn, the more blessed they become.[26]

This terminology is used elsewhere in the NT (John 17:3 and Phil 3:8). At times, "knowledge" (or "knowing") seems to be more than just "having information" about something. In John 17:3, "knowing" is the idea of *truly* knowing—having a relationship with Jesus in a way that gives one a connection to Him, giving us eternal life. In Phil 3:8, like John 17:3, the idea is "knowing" in the sense of "a relationship with" something—namely, Jesus. However, the sense in 2 Peter 1:2 is more likely the idea of "understanding," as stated before.

Mayor comments on the Greek preposition translated "in" here (ἐν). He says, "The preposition ἐν denotes that grace and peace are multiplied in and by the fuller knowledge of God, cf. [John] 17:3."[27]

Bauckham states that the word "Knowledge" (ἐπίγνωσις) is used in different ways in the NT. One of which refers "to the knowledge gained in conversion."[28] He lists verses that have this usage: Heb 10:26;

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24. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 288.

25. Unlike most of the "we"/"us" pronouns in verses 1-4, here seems to be in reference to all Christians, not just the apostles.

26. Helpfully, Fisher notes that "knowledge" here could be both "having a relationship with" and "understanding" what Jesus has said. It is *by* this knowledge that one gets "grace and peace." See G. Fisher, "II Peter 1," minute 25:05.

27. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 82.

28. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 169.

1 Tim 2:4; 2 Tim 2:25, 3:7; and Titus 1:1. He continues, "Such terminology has its background in Hellenistic Jewish apologetic in which Judaism as knowledge of God was contrasted with pagan ignorance of the true God."[29] He concludes, "It seems clear that 2 Peter's use of ἐπίγνωσις (a favorite term: 1:2, 3, 8; 2:20) conforms to this usage: it is 'the decisive knowledge of God which is implied in conversion to the Christian religion.'"[30]

To Bauckham, it is important to differentiate ἐπίγνωσις and γνῶσις (also translated "Knowledge"). The former is "always refers to that fundamental saving knowledge on which the whole of Christian life is based."[31] He says that the latter "is used in 2 Peter for knowledge which can be acquired and developed in the course of the Christian life (1:5, 6; 3:18)."[32] Bauckham goes on, "The reason for our author's emphasis on the fundamental Christian conversion-knowledge and its ethical implications is the danger of apostasy through ethical libertinism (2:20-21) which his readers faced."[33]

Green takes this word "Knowledge" to be different than Bauckham. Green states, "No doubt…*knowledge* here…has a polemical thrust."[34] He says, "Peter was writing to people who claimed a real knowledge of God and of Christ, but continued in immoral behavior. *Knowledge* may have been a catch-phrase of theirs which Peter takes up and fills with authentic Christian content."[35] Thus, "True knowledge of God and Christ produces grace and peace in the life; what is more, it produces holiness (v. 3). The whole New Testament united in denouncing a profession of faith which makes no difference to behavior."[36] Green cites J. B. Lightfoot's definition of ἐπίγνωσις, which says that this is a "'larger and more thorough knowledge' than

29. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 169-170.

30. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 170. Bauckham at the end of this citation quotes Bultmann in *TDNT* 1, 707. So also Davids who says, "He [Peter] is thinking of that knowledge gained in conversion rather than that which one may develop on one's own (as in 1 :5-6)." See P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 165.

31. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 170

32. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 170.

33. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 170.

34. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 80. Davids notes Green's position but says, "We must evaluate the claim [that Peter is using 'knowledge' here to oppose the false teachers of chapter 2] as unproved." See P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 165.

35. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 80.

36. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 80.

[γνῶσις]."[37] Finally, Green says, "A deeper knowledge of the Person of Jesus is the surest safeguard against false doctrine."[38]

Schreiner sees this "knowledge" as "personal and relational, but it also involves intellectual content."[39] According to him, Biblical writers never separate "the head and the heart in terms of spiritual growth."[40] Schreiner believes that "grace" and "peace" come about when believers understand God deeper and deeper "in the crucible of experience."[41] Schreiner agrees with Bauckham when he states, "It is probable that the term [ἐπίγνωσις] focuses on conversion (1:3, 8; 2:20)" but disagrees when he says, "It is doubtful, though, that we should separate [ἐπίγνωσις] from [γνῶσις] (1:5, 6; 3:18)."[42] Contra Bauckham, Schreiner states, "Knowledge of God and Christ begins, of course, at conversion, but it is difficult to sustain the view that Peter confined [ἐπίγνωσις] to conversion and [γνῶσις] to postconversion growth."[43] Contra Green, Schreiner does not see "knowledge" here as "a polemic against Gnosticism since the opponents do not clearly fit into such a mold."[44] He concludes, "In this verse knowledge refers both to the knowledge of God they had at conversion and for its increase in their lives."[45] With Schreiner, I agree. However, as we continue with 2 Peter, it may seem reasonable with Green to see "knowledge" as being a call forward to chapter 2, where Peter will deal with the false teachers. For more on who they are, see the Introduction to 2 Peter.

3 Davids interestingly notes that he sees 1:3-11 as a "exordium," a rhetorical device used in classical compositions to introduce the speaker's topic and win favor with the audience.[46]

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37. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 80.

38. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 81. Bauckham responds to Green by writing, "Some commentators (…Green…) think that ἐπίγνωσις in 2 Peter has a polemical reference to the false teachers' claim to γνῶσις. However, its use seems to be sufficiently explained…without reference to specifically 'gnostic' adversaries." See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 170.

39. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 288.

40. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 288.

41. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 288.

42. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 288. As stated before, Bauckham believes that ἐπίγνωσις and γνῶσις can be used interchangeably but ultimately sees Peter use them in different ways. See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 170-171.

43. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 288.

44. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 288. For more on the opponents, see Introduction to 2 Peter.

45. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 288.

46. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 166. For more on the structure of 1:3-15, see P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 166-198.

"TO US." For comments on the pronoun "us," see below and also "A Gentile Audience?" (p. 65ff). As a reminder, it seems that the "Our"/"Us" in verse 1-4 and 16-19 are referencing the apostles while "You" in chapter 1 references to both Jewish and Gentile Christians. However, there is more to be said specifically about verse 3.

Bauckham states, "All the pronouns of v 3 are problematic."[47] It is difficult to know if "us" here is a to the apostles like in verse 1 or to all Christians like in verse 2 ("Our Lord"). Bauckham notes that some commentators, because of the "you" in verse 4 being Jewish and Gentile Christians, see the "us" in verse 3 as a continuation of the "our" in verse 1 (which is in reference to the apostles, see discussion above). To say it another way, some commentators say that "our" in verse 1 and "us" in verse 3 are the same group—namely, the apostles—while the "you" of verses 2 and 4 are a different group—the Jewish and Gentile Christians. Bauckham disagrees, pointing out 4 things. (1) in connection with verse 2, verse 3 "must speak of the knowledge the *readers* have received."[48] (2) If verse 3a "means that 'everything necessary for a godly life'" was given to the apostles (only), did they pass it on?[49] According to Bauckham, the text does not say they do. Thus, why mention it? (3) The transition to "we Christians" in verse 3 "is easily and naturally made" especially in light of "our Lord" in verse 2.[50] And (4) "you" in verse 4 makes sense "as a transition to the exhortation in v 5."[51] Bauckham sees something similar happening in 3:11-14.

Mayor agrees with Bauckham stating, "the ['our'] of the former [verse] are included in the ['us'] of the latter."[52] By this, he means that everyone who is included in the "our Lord" (i.e., all Christians) are included in the "us" of verse 3. Green is vague on the point, only using the pronouns "their" and "them" but never identifying *who* "they" are. Schreiner, however, agrees with Mayor and Bauckham, "Verse 3 explains the resources believers have through knowing God. Those who know God have everything they need for life and godliness."[53] Again, he says, "The word 'us' refers to all believers, not merely the apostles

47. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 176.
48. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 177.
49. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 177.
50. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 177.
51. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 177.
52. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 83.
53. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 290.

or Jewish Christians. It is unlikely that Peter restricted what he said to any particular group of believers."[54]

This is a difficult issue. It is with hesitation that I question the view of those mentioned above. If there is not a distinction between apostle and Jewish and Gentile Christian in verse 3, then the "you" in verse 4 seems almost obsolete. If "us" in verse 3 includes Peter's audience, then does the "you" of verse 4 mean that the apostles are not "partakers of the divine nature"?

I see verse 3 as a continued distinction between the apostles and Jewish and Gentile Christians. Therefore, in view here is the thought that by divine power, the apostles received everything they need in the realms of life and godliness. As God's messengers, the apostles needed to know how they were to live and act. They were given this "knowledge" (see verse 2 for a discussion on "knowledge") through Him (more on who the "Him" is below).[55]

It appears that this is a reference back to John 14:26. The apostles received a special understanding of, shall we say, "life and godliness," that they passed on to Christians (which is why Peter says, "so that by them you," in 1:4).[56]

"DIVINE POWER." Bauckham notes that "divine" (θείος) is a flexible word.[57] Here, it means, "not that Christ possesses a divine or godlike power of his own, as though he were a second god, but that he shares in God's own power."[58] He equates this with the "power" of 1:16.

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54. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 291.

55. R. Bauckham comments on "knowledge" here by saying, "This was Christ's first gift, by means of which he also gave everything necessary for a God-fearing life." See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178. Fisher sees "the true knowledge" in verse 3 as a reference to *how* the "everything pertaining to life and godliness" is received. See G. Fisher, "II Peter 1," minute 31:30.

56. Contra Bauckham, as stated above, who wrote, "If v 3a means that 'everything necessary for a godly life' has been granted *to the apostles*, it is hard to see why this statement should be made. It could only be relevant if the apostles passed these things on to the readers, but it is not stated that they did." See Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 177. I see the phrase "so that by them you" as being the statement which shows the apostles passed on their understanding to the readers.

57. Interestingly, Schreiner comments on "divine" by stating: "Some scholars think Peter's use of this term, along with "divine" ([*θείος*])—another term uncommon in the New Testament—indicates pseudonymity. Would a Palestinian fisherman write like this? But Peter also used the term [*ἀρετῇ*] in 1 Pet 2:9, and his use of Hellenistic terms reveals that he wanted to communicate in the idiom of his readers. This could merely indicate that Peter was not closeted off from the rest of the world, and he was familiar with Hellenistic culture." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 293.

58. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 177.

Davids notes that this word for "divine" is only found three times in the NT (Acts 17:29; 2 Peter 1:3, 4; "cf. a related term in Rom 1:20"); nine times in the LXX/OG; once in *1 Clement*, *2 Clement*, Ignatius, and Papius; and nine times in Hermas.[59] However the term is most common in Hellenistic works such as "4 Maccabees (twenty-five times), Philo (*Quod deterius …* 83; *De Abrahamo* 26; *Spec. leg.* 2.2; *De confusion linguarum* 115), and Josephus (*Ant.* 19.69)."[60] He, like Schreiner (see footnote on Bauckham's "divine" in previous paragraph), states that while the word Peter uses is an unusual for the NT, it was a common Hellenistic word. Why use it? Because "it is the language of his [Peter's] pagan environment, indicating either his own linguistic context or else the background of the people to whom he was trying to communicate."[61]

"GRANTED." See Mark 15:45.

"LIFE AND GODLINESS." Life here may indicate "eternal life," giving this phrase the idea of "a life of godliness" (or "a godly life").[62] This term here for "godliness" is found in the NT only in Acts 3:12, 1 Tim 2:2; 3:16; 4:7-8; 6:3, 5-6, 11; Titus 1:1; 3:5; cf. also Acts 10:2, 7. Bauckham notes, "It denotes piety toward the gods, but also, especially in Jewish and Christian usage, the respect for God's will and the moral way of life which are inseparable from the proper religious attitude to God."[63]

Schreiner sees "godliness" being intentionally connected to "life." Godliness is what one does on the way to eternal life. "Eternal life is not merely the experience of bliss but also involves transformation, so that believers are morally perfected and made like God. Hence, believers should live in a godly way even now, though perfection in godliness will not be ours until the day Christ returns."[64] He also connects this phrase with 3:11, which shows that the future coming of Christ motivates how we live in the present.[65] However, some have interpreted

59. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 169.
60. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 169.
61. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 169.
62. So R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178; T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 291-292.
63. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178.
64. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 292.
65. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 292.

"life and godliness" as simply a hendiadys (two terms standing for a single thing), meaning, as stated above, the idea is a "godly life."[66]

Who is the "His"/"Him" in verse 3? It clearly refers back to verse 2, but does it refer back to God or Jesus?[67] Perhaps on one level, it does not matter, since both are divine. Christians recognize the authority and powerful of Jesus the same as they do God. However, there are some things worth noting about this pronoun.

Bauckham notes: "If the longer reading in v 2b is accepted, it is impossible to be sure whether αὐτοῦ ("his") refers to God or to Jesus, but the latter, as the nearest antecedent, is more probable."[68] The statement, "longer reading," is a reference to verse 2 where it says, "God and of Jesus our Lord." Not every manuscript has both God and Jesus mentioned. Here is the list of variations:

66. So P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 168.

67. Schreiner says, "The ambiguity in the text indicates that Peter did not clearly distinguish between God and Christ. We can conclude from this that God and Christ were venerated equally." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 291.

68. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 177.

Text-Critical Table 1

2 Peter 1:2

Manuscript	Reading
ℵ A 307. 442. 1735. 1739. 2492 r? vg^{mss}? bo	"Of God and Jesus Christ our Lord"
442	"Of God and Savior Jesus Christ our Lord"
5. 33. 81. 436. 642. 2344 r? vg^{mss}? vg^{cl}	"Of God and Christ Jesus our Lord"
𝔓^{72}	"Of God Jesus Christ our Lord"
1611 sy sa^{ms}	"Of our Lord Jesus Christ"
P Ψ 1175. 1852 vg$^{st.ww}$	"Of our Lord"
1243	"Of our God"
B C 1448 Byz	"Of God and Jesus our Lord"

Information from Eberhard Nestle and Erwin Nestle, Nestle-Aland: NTG Apparatus Criticus, ed. Barbara Aland et al., 28. revidierte Auflage. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2012), 708.

Schreiner agrees with Bauckham: "The immediate antecedent in v. 2 is Christ rather than God, and hence a reference to Christ would be more natural."[69] In addition, Schreiner points out verse 16. There, the word "power" is used in connection with Jesus, the same as in verse 3. Green also agrees, saying, "Jesus is the last person mentioned, and so the *glory and goodness* are more appropriate to him than the father."[70] Mayor too, stating, "If two Persons are mentioned in v. 2, it would seem most natural to understand αὐτοῦ of the nearer, but Keil, de Wette, Brückner, Wiesinger, take it of the Father as the leading idea, while Dietlein supposes it to refer to the Deity in general including the Son."[71] Therefore, it seems to if the longer reading of verse 2 (which includes Jesus) is the correct one, then Jesus is the "his"/"him" of verse 3.

"WHO CALLED US." The "who called us" is connected with the last phrase, "Knowledge of Him." Thus "who" is probably the same person as "Him," making Christ not only the one who we "know" (see discussion above) but also the caller.[72] Schreiner agrees, observing that if "His divine power" is in reference to Christ, then Christ is probably also in view here as the caller.[73] Mayor notes that some connect Christ's calling here with Matt 9:13, however ultimately he sees "the *Possessor* of the divine power" and "the *Caller*" as two separate persons, "the former we naturally identify with the Father, the latter with the Son."[74]

Bauckham discusses the "us" here. Those who take the position, as I do, that the "us" here refers not to all Christians (Peter along with his audience) but as a reference to the apostles see this calling as Jesus' calling of the apostles in the Gospels (e.g., Matt 4:18-19).[75] With this Bauckham disagrees, noting that books like *2 Clement* and Hermas (which he believes are closely associated with 2 Peter), shows Jesus' calling in 2 Peter 1:3 to be for all Christians, not just the apostles. He concludes, "Further confirmation that 2 Peter refers to the calling of Christians in general, not apostles in particular, is found in 1:10, which

69. T. Schreiner, *1,2 Peter, Jude,* 291.

70. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 81.

71. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 84.

72. So R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178.

73. Interestingly, Schreiner footnotes E. Fuchs and P. Reymond who see "His divine power" as a reference to God and "who called" as a reference to Christ. See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 291.

74. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 85.

75. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178. For a helpful counter to my argument, see P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 169, footnote 10. Davids agrees with Bauckham.

surely takes up the idea of calling from v 3."[76] I do not disagree that 1:10 is about Christians in general. However, I think Peter's point here is that God called the apostles so they could impart to Christians the necessary things for them to be right with God. Thus they need to be motivated to grow and show that their calling/choosing is certain. To paraphrase the section, "God has called us [apostles] and gave us [apostles] special gifts, *so that by them you* [Christians in general] may have the necessary things to be right with God. Now, because you have these things, work at your character. God chose you, too, so be diligent."[77] For more on these verses I have summarized, see below.

"BY HIS OWN GLORY[78] AND EXCELLENCE.[79]" The word translated, "by," here is a Greek dative "ἰδίᾳ."[80] Bauckham implies that the proper translation is "by" when he says that it cannot be translated "to" because there is no "εἰς + the accusative tense."[81] Whether Bauckham is right to connect "glory and excellence" with Hellenistic writers, I do not know.[82] He concludes that these terms are "closely related in meaning," "virtually synonymous," and "The phrase is a rhetorical variation on θεία δύναμις ("divine power") and presumably refers to the incarnate life, ministry and resurrection of Christ as a manifestation of divine power by means of which he called men and women to be Christians."[83]

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76. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178. Cf. also T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 291-292. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 81.

77. As a final note, since this letter is one of reminders (1:12-15; 3:1-2), it seems reasonable to me that what Peter is explaining in chapter 1 is content his audience is *already* familiar with. So, stating two separate "callings" (Apostles, 1:3; Christians, 1:10) does not seem like a stretch. They would have already understood that God chose them, so he does not need to give an in-depth explanation.

78. M. Green footnotes: "[glory] is a favourite word of Peter's, coming ten times in 1 Peter and five in 2 Peter." See M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 82.

79. M. Green footnotes concerning 'excellence': "Here…the language is polemical, the allusion to the Old Testament is probable, and the meaning is Hebrew, not Greek—goodness in action, concrete deeds of excellence. There is much the same thought in 1 Pet. 2:9. Christians are to show forth the [excellencies] of their Redeemer. In both cases the excellence in question is manifested in saving actions; it is no mere static quality." See M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 82. Cf. footnote 31 above where Bauckham disagrees with Green.

80. A dative can be translated a number of ways. The two relevant translations discussed here are "to" and "by." Thus "called *to*" or "called *by*."

81. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178-179.

82. See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178-179.

83. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178-179.

There may be an influence here from 1 Pet 2:9, Is 42:12 OG, and/or 1 Pet 5:10. However, Bauckham does not think so.[84]

Schreiner observes, "'Glory' … here refers to Christ's splendor and majesty as a divine being, not his "fame or honor."[85] He goes on to explain that the word "goodness" … refers to the moral life of believers in 1:5."[86] The word translated "excellence" in the verse was a common word "used in Greek literature for moral value."[87] Schreiner sees the attachment of "glory" to "excellence" gives the latter the sense of Christ's "divine moral excellence," focusing especially on the beauty of his goodness."[88] Thus those called by Christ have also seen his moral character and because of this "trust God for their salvation."[89] Similarly, Mayor concludes his discussion of the phrase by stating, "The meaning of the passage then will be: Christ has called us, not through our seeking, but through the attractive power of His own glory, *i.e.* through the revelation of His own perfection."[90] Here, Schreiner and Mayor may be saying more than the text intends. Finally, Schreiner sees an indirect

84. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178-179. Cf. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 82. He thinks Isaiah 42:8, 12 (OG) are in view here. He notes that "glory and excellence" in Isaiah 42 belong to God but here "Peter claims them for Jesus, through whom the divine excellence and glory have been supremely manifested."

85. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 292-293. Mayor notes: "By [glory] we are probably to understand the manifestation of the Divine character, which compels the veneration, the love, and the worship of men." See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 85.

86. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 292–293.

87. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 293. Cf. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 81-82. He says, "Jesus Christ calls men by his moral excellence ([excellence]) and the total impact of his Person ([glory]). … No doubt he is thinking, too, of the glory of Jesus which shattered him at the transfiguration, to which he refers in verse 17. But it was not only the transfiguration which revealed the impact of Jesus' Person. It was his whole life." Interestingly, Mayor states that excellence "is perhaps the inner perfect or excellence which is thus manifested. The only other passages in the N.T. in which it occurs are 1 Pet. 2:9…where it is usually translated 'praises'… [2 Peter 1:5], where it seems to bear the special sense of 'energy' or 'courage,' and Phil. 4:8…where Lightfoot…prefers the explanation 'whatever value may reside in your old heathen conception of virtue, whatever consideration is due to the praise of men.' The fact that philosophical terms…are used in 2 Pet. leads one to suppose that [excellence] has its usual Greek meaning." See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 85-86. However, Bauckham notes "the pair [glory and excellence] should be understood, like other pairs of words in 2 Peter, as closely related in meaning. It is therefore unlikely that [excellence] here means 'moral virtue.'" See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 178. Bauckham may be closer to the correct interpretation.

88. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 293.

89. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 293.

90. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 86.

critique of the false teachers discussed in chapter 2, whose lives are the opposite of Christ's excellence.[91]

This is a difficult phrase to parse out. However, I think Bauckham is closer to the intended interpretation. But there does seem to be a sort of 'powerful force' to the phrase, as Schreiner and Mayor try to pull out. The phrase leaves me with a sense of Christ's *awesomeness*. As noted before, one must remember that Peter is speaking of the calling of the *apostles* (see discussion above). Whatever Peter means here at the end of verse 3, it was the calling which He called the apostles, not us. Peter will not discuss our calling until 1:10.

4 "FOR BY THESE HE HAS GRANTED TO US PRECIOUS AND MAGNIFICENT PROMISES." Here, I think Peter, continuing the "us apostles" and (in the second half of the verse) "you Jewish and Gentile Christians" distinctions, refers to the promises Christ made the apostles. Possibly, Peter sees John 14:16-17, 26; 15:26 in view. Perhaps also Peter has in view other promises Christ made to the apostles in the Gospels—Matt 10:17-20?; 16:19; 28:20; John 14:1-4; etc. These promises Christ made to the apostles, by which we (Christians) have benefited. If it was not for the apostles and their special relationship with Christ, we would not have the NT, nor the additional instructions Christ has given us through the apostles' teachings.

Bauckham states, "By his saving activity Christ gave not only what is requisite for godly life in the present, but also promises for the future."[92] He notes that ἐπαγγέλμα ("promise") could mean "the thing promised" which would give the sense, "Christ has granted us the gifts which had previously been promised (in OT times?)."[93] This is the interpretation those who see the second half of verse 4 as referring to Christian conversion and baptism. Bauckham disputes it, saying, "It is more natural, and in line with the letter's general emphasis on the promises for the future (3:4, 9, 13; cf. 1:11, 6, 19), to think of promises

91. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 293. He says that the false teachers' "lives were marked by moral anarchy, but those whom Christ calls have seen Christ's goodness and glory and will live a godly life."

92. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 179. Green disagrees, saying, "Bauckham, whose detailed Commentary is incomparably the best in English, sees that Peter is not surrendering to Hellenism here, but wrongly regards 'the Christian eschatological goal of escaping mortality and attaining immortality' as the essence of Christ's promises, rather than the new birth of which Peter speaks in both his letters." See M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 84.

93. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 179.

which Christ gave."[94] Schreiner also connects "promises" with 2 Peter 3, where the mockers (in his opinion, the false teachers) denying Christ's promise of the second coming.[95] He writes, "Peter anticipated here later criticisms of the false teachers, for by denying the coming of the Lord they undercut the gospel that promises moral perfection when Christ returns. If there is no future coming of Christ, their salvation does not include the promise of likeness to God, and the gospel is a shame."[96]

Davids helpfully says that the word "promise" here is not used in the LXX/OG and only used in the NT in 2 Peter (1:4; 3:13), "thus it stands out and neatly brackets the whole letter."[97]

Green comments, "Like Paul, Peter begins with the theological indicative. They are in God's family; they have left the world; they possess precious promises; they know Christ. That is the basis for his ethical imperative, which comes so strongly in the succeeding verses. They must become in practice what they already are in God's sight."[98]

Schreiner sees the "promises" Peter mentions as probably a reference to the second half of the verse—that Christians can "become partakers of the divine nature."[99]

"SO THAT BY THEM YOU MAY BECOME PARTAKERS OF THE DIVINE NATURE." As has been stated before, "So that by them you" seems to me to be a reference to Peter's audience. The apostles were given promises by Jesus which they used, told, and gave to the people they converted. It was by the blessings Christ gave to the apostles, such as the Holy Spirit, which they used to bless Christendom.

What does Peter mean here by "become partakers of the divine nature"? Some of the Greek patristic and Eastern Orthodox doctrines use this text to prove "the deification of man," which it does not.[100] It must be said that Peter does not mean Christians "become God."

94. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 179.
95. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 294.
96. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 294.
97. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 171.
98. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 83.
99. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 293.
100. Observation by Green. See M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 84. He states, "This verse has also been a classic proof-text for the Greek patristic and Eastern Orthodox doctrine of the deification of man. This needs to be treated with great circumspection." For Green's continued comments, see citation noted here.

Christians do not become "mini-gods" with God's supernatural abilities and cosmic status. Bauckham writes,

> It is not very likely that participation in God's own essence is intended. Not participation in *God*, but in the nature of heavenly, immortal beings, is meant. … *like* God, in that, by his grace, they reflect his glorious, immortal being, but they are "divine" only in the loose sense…. To share in divine nature is to become immortal and incorruptible.[101]

Bauckham goes on to state that Paul's idea that Christians are participants in the Holy Spirit "*could* be behind 2 Pet 1:4, but it is not required by the Hellenistic language there used."[102]

Schreiner states, "The other use of 'divine' … in the New Testament is found in Acts 17:29, where Paul spoke to those in Athens influenced by Greek culture."[103] Then, "What Peter meant by this is that believers are promised that they will be like God."[104] Schreiner finds Starr's analysis of this phrase helpful, noting his conclusions. "He [Starr] concludes…that sharing in the divine nature does not mean 'deified.' Instead Peter maintained that believers will share in the moral qualities of Christ."[105]

Some commentators see there being Hellenistic influence in Peter's phrase "the divine nature."[106] Schreiner comments on this by

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101. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 181. Left out of the quotation, along with comments around it, is Bauckham's notes concerning 2 Peter's influence from Hellenistic Judaism. For more on possible influences on 2 Peter with "partakers of the divine nature," see page cited here. Davids too notes that Peter's point here is to say that Christians ought to share some characteristic of God. However, he does disagree with Bauckham in the interpretation of "escape." See his discussion in P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 172-176.

102. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 181. Bauckham cites Rom 8:11; 1 Cor 15:42-53.

103. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 294.

104. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 294. He continues on, "The notion of sharing in the divine nature has exerted a tremendous influence in Eastern Christianity, where the doctrine of [θέωσις] (i.e., deification) has been emphasized. Peter was not saying (nor did Eastern Christianity) that human beings will actually become divine or that they will share in the divine nature in every respect. Believers will share in the divine nature in that they will be morally perfected; they will share in the moral excellence that belongs to God (1:3)."

105. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 295. So also Fisher, who states that Christians share in God's nature in the sense that they become holy and righteous like Him. "Holiness" is really what God's nature is. See G. Fisher, "II Peter 1," minute 32:40.

106. So R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 181-184; M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 84f; J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 86-89; and T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 294-295.

stating that Peter "presumably…wrote this way to speak to the cultural situation of his readers."[107] Bauckham helpfully comments on the Hellenistic tendencies of some of 2 Peter's terminology.

> The task of translating the gospel into terms appropriate to a new cultural milieu was (and has always continued to be) essential to the church's missionary role. 'The interpretation of experiencing salvation in Jesus is not bound up with the language of Canaan, as salvation is meant for all, including Greeks. They may relate their experience of salvation-in-Jesus *in their idiom*' (E. Schillebeeckx, *Christ: The Christian Experience in the Modern World*, tr. J. Bowden [London: SCM Press, 1980] 304, on this passage). Our author, like other NT writers, was able to use the bridges into Hellenistic thought which Hellenistic Jewish apologetic had already built.[108]

Green agrees with Bauckham's stance that this is phrase has Hellenistic influence behind it. He notes John 1:12 as being similar in concept to this idea.[109] He comments, "Peter does not mean that man is absorbed into the deity; that would at the same time dissolve personal identity and render impossible any personal encounter between the individual and God."[110] Instead, Green thinks, "As in 1 Peter, he speaks of a real union with Christ."[111] In 1 Peter, Christians are partakers of Christ's sufferings (1 Peter 4:13) and glory to be revealed (1 Peter 5:1) "because we are partakers of Christ. What Peter is saying here, though couched in this unusual form, is just the same content as Paul's claim in Romans 8:9; Galatians 2:20; John's, in 1 John 5:1; and his own, in 1 Peter 1:23."[112]

Green goes on to say that becoming a Christian (repenting, believing, and being baptized) is an individual's entering into a new relationship with God. In this, God becomes the individual's father and fellow Christians become his or her family. "It is in this sense that Peter

107. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 294.

108. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 183-184.

109. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 84; Cf. J. Mayor, , 87-88. He says, "The same idea occurs in slightly altered form in" and cites Hebrews 3:14, 6:4, 12:10; 1 John 1:3; 1 Peter 5:1; and 2 Corinthians 3:18.

110. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 84.

111. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 84.

112. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 84.

rightly claims that believers are *already* participants in the divine nature."[113] Green warns, however, that this verse does not necessarily teach that Peter has adopted the views of Platonism. He says, "It would be naïve, therefore, to suppose, as many have done, that this verse proves Peter's surrender to pagan ideas of divinization current in late Platonism and the mystery religions."[114]

While I think there may be something to Bauckham's view that the "partaking" is a future event where Christians will join God in Heaven and be eternal, I think Green strikes more at the heart of Peter's point.[115] Christians have *already* become partaking of the divine nature in the sense that we build a relationship with God, become like Him, and enjoy the blessings that come from being united with Him.[116]

"HAVING ESCAPED THE CORRUPTION THAT IS IN THE WORLD BY LUST." As noted above, it seems to be that while this phrase is itself is a reference to both Jewish and Gentiles Christians (Peter's audience), I see a possible specific reference here to Gentile Christians who *literally* escaped the world, unlike the Jewish Christians who were following God (YHWH) before converting to Christianity.

Green comments, "By *the world* Peter means society alienated from God by rebellion (2:20; cf. 1 John 2:15-17; 5:19). We *participate in the divine nature* only after we have *escaped* or turned our backs on (note the decisiveness of the aorist participle) that attitude (cf. Jas 1:21)."[117] He continues on, "The ancient world was haunted by the conception of [φθορᾶς], [that is,] *corruption*. The transitoriness of life, the pointlessness of it all, oppressed many of the best thinkers in

113. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 84. Contra Bauckham, who states that the partaking the author is referring to in 1:4 is a future event. See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 182. Schreiner states, "Even now believers are indwelt by the Holy Spirit and are like God to some extent. Believers begin to know God and to be changed by him at their conversion." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 295.

114. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 84-85. He goes on to say, "In contrast to Hellenistic ideas, Peter maintains that corruption and mortality are not due to matter, but to sin. You do not escape them by cult initiation now and the immortality of the soul after death, but by God implanting a new nature, Christ's own, within you, which will produce holiness of life now, and will flower into the fullness of knowing him after this life is over."

115. Schreiner helpfully bridges the gap between these two interpretations: "It is more likely, however, that Peter operated with an already-but-not-yet schema. Believers have already escaped the world's corruption in that they belong to God, but the full realization of such a liberation will be theirs on the day of resurrection. The parallel expression in 2 Pet 2:20 supports this interpretation." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 295.

116. It is here that I am reminded of John 17:20-21. Perhaps there may be a connection.

117. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 83.

antiquity (as it does today). Peter tells them that there is a way of escape—through Jesus Christ."[118] Green hits the nail on the head.

It is here that Green sees some contrast between Peter's teachings (1:3-4) with the false teachers of chapter 2.[119] (1) The false teachers emphasized knowledge while Peter emphasized knowing Jesus. (2) The false teachers thought they could do away with morality by way of knowledge, so Peter used two common pagan words for ethical endeavor: εὐσέβεια (godliness) and ἀρετή (excellence). (3) The false teachers did not think one could truly live a holy life, so Peter discusses "the divine power" (which is "a Hebrew periphrasis for God"). (4) The false teachers (or, at least, "Rival pagan schoolmen") said one can escape the "corruption" by "partaking in the divine nature" through either law-keeping or "nature," so Peter uses their language "and replies that it is by sheer grace." Green goes on to say, "Participation in the divine nature is the starting-point, not the goal, of Christian living. He [Peter] writes to those who have *escaped* from the deductive allegiance to society at odds with God."[120]

Schreiner comments, "God has given saving promises to his people, so that they will become like God. They will become like God and are becoming like God because they have escaped 'the corruption in the world caused by evil desires.'"[121]

But how does one "escape" the world? Schreiners sees this happening when they come to know Jesus Christ.[122] Schreiner also notes that the word "escaped" in 1:4 is the same as 2:20 and thus both passages should be interpreted similarly.[123] Davids says that this is "likely an ongoing process, beginning indeed with Christian initiation…, but not ending there."[124]

118. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 83.

119. For what follows in this paragraph, see M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 83-84. What are in quotation marks are either quotes from Green or 2 Peter.

120. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 84.

121. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 295.

122. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 295.

123. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 295.

124. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 176.

1:5-11

"[5]*Now for this very reason also, applying all diligence, in your faith supply moral excellence, and in your moral excellence, knowledge,* [6]*and in your knowledge, self-control, and in your self-control, perseverance, and in your perseverance, godliness,* [7]*and in your godliness, brotherly kindness, and in your brotherly kindness, love.* [8]*For if these qualities are yours and are increasing, they render you neither useless nor unfruitful in the true knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.* [9]*For he who lacks these qualities is blind or short-sighted, having forgotten his purification from his former sins.* [10]*Therefore, brethren, be all the more diligent to make certain about His calling and choosing you; for as long as you practice these things, you will never stumble;* [11]*for in this way the entrance into the eternal kingdom of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ will be abundantly supplied to you.*"

5 "NOW FOR THIS VERY REASON ALSO, APPLYING ALL DILIGENCE." Peter, standing on the shoulders of what he said in verses 3 and 4, presses forward to motivate his audience to begin working.[125] Peter is telling them, "Look at the blessings Christ has granted to you and get to work!"[126]

In my opinion, it seems that verses 5-7 may be similar to 1 Peter 2:2. For more on 1 Peter 2:2, see comments there.

I see verses 5-7 to be a sort of progression. It begins with faith and ends with love. The more one grows in *faith*, the more moral one becomes; the more moral, the more knowledgeable one becomes; and so on. This progression begins with faith and ends with love.[127] Mayor comments on this list,

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125. So R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 184. "'For this very reason,' probably refers to the whole of vv 3-4 as the salvation-historical basis for the exhortation."

126. Fisher notes that verses 3-4 seem to be what God gives while verses 5ff are what we give. See G. Fisher, "II Peter 1," minute 42:00.

127. So J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 91: "The list here agrees with the ordinary description of Christian growth in so far as it begins with πίστις and ends with ἀγάπη, intermediate between which comes γνῶσις according to Clem. Al. *Str.* 7. §§ 46, 55 f." Jady Copeland also states that there may be a since in which the following virtue helps give the previous one direction: faith needs to become *virtuous* (morally excellent), virtue needs to be based on *knowledge*, and so on. See Jady Copeland, "II Peter 1 – Spiritual Growth," Sermon audio, Lakeview church of Christ, October 13, 2024, https://www.lakeviewchurchofchrist.org/sermons/sermons/2024/10/13/ii-peter-1-spiritual-growth,

> to this [faith] must be added (1) Moral Strength which enables a man to do what he knows to be right; (2) Spiritual discernment; (3) Self-control by which a man resists temptation; (4) Endurance by which he bears up under persecution or adversity; (5) right feeling and behaviour towards God, (6) towards, the brethren, (7) towards all."[128]

More on this progression below.

There are other virtue lists in the NT. Davids lists the following[129]:

2 Pet 1:5-7	Rom 5:3-5	James 1:3-4	Gal 5:22-23
Faith (πίστις)	Suffering	Testing (of πίστις)	Love
Goodness (ἀρετή)	Perseverance	Perseverance	Joy
Knowledge	Character	Maturity	Peace
Self-control (ἐγκράτειαν)	Hope	Complete	Patience (= perseverance)
Perseverance	Love	Not lacking anything	Kindness
Godliness (εὐσέβεια)			Goodness (ἀγαθωσύνη)
Brotherly kindness			Faithfulness (πίστις)
Love			Gentleness
			Self-control

Not only is it a progression but it may also be a foreshadowing of what is to come in chapter 2. The false teachers are trying to dissuade the Christians into falsehood. Peter, however, calls on the Christians to grow, become more Christ-like, and keep serving God properly.[130] Thus

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minute 18:51. However, Fisher is right that Christians are to be working on all these qualities at the same time, see G. Fisher, "II Peter 1," minute 51:48. However, there does seem to be a progression occurring here.

128. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 93.

129. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 177. Originally, Davids had transliterations for the Greek terms. Those have been changed to the Greek alphabet.

130. So J. Copeland, "II Peter 1 – Spiritual Growth," minute 2:05.

here is one of the antidotes to the problem of the false teaching among Peter's audience. As we continue, we will comment more on the connections to the false teachers in this list.

The Greek word here for "diligence" is σπουδή. Different forms of this word are found in 2 Peter: 1:10, 15; 3:12 ("hastening"), and 14. Louw-Nida note that the phrase here "σπουδὴν πᾶσαν παρεισφέρω" ("applying all diligence") is "an idiom, literally 'to bring every effort to.'"[131] It is, "To do one's very best in attempting to do something—'to do one's best, to make every effort to, to try as hard as possible.'"[132] In 1:5, Louw-Nida sees this phrase being used to say, "'Do your very best to add goodness to your faith.'"[133]

Bauckham says,

> Moral effort is required because Christ has given us (a) everything necessary for godly life (v 3), and (b) the promises of immorality (v 4). We cannot expect to escape the morality which is due to sin (v 4) unless we ourselves avoid sin and make moral progress, the spiritual resources for which are available to every Christian through the knowledge of Christ he received when he became a Christian (v 3).[134]

While I disagree with (a) (see notes above), I think Bauckham's sentiment here is correct. Peter has detailed in verses 3-4 the blessings Christ has given to His people, now it is our responsibility to respond with immense gratitude and align our lives with His will.[135]

"IN YOUR FAITH SUPPLY MORAL EXCELLENCE." Bauckham critically notes:

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131. J. P. Louw and E. A. Nida, in *Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament: Based on Semantic Domains*, 662.

132. J. P. Louw and E. A. Nida, in *Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament: Based on Semantic Domains*, 662.

133. J. P. Louw and E. A. Nida, in *Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament: Based on Semantic Domains*, 662. So also J. Copeland, "II Peter 1 – Spiritual Growth," minute 27:40.

134. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 184.

135. Notice Green's statement here, "Because of our new birth and the precious promises and the divine power offered us in Christ we cannot sit back and rest content with 'faith' (cf. Jas 2:20). The grace of God demands, as it enables, *effort* in man. We are to bring *into* this relationship *alongside* what God has done…every ounce of determination we can muster." See M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 85. So also Schreiner, "A godly character does not emerge from passivity or lassitude." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 298.

> This verb [ἐπιχορηγήσατε, translated 'supply'] (also in v 11[136]) means "to furnish, to provide at one's own expense," but is difficult to translate here. The meaning of the clause must be: "by means of your faith supply virtue," i.e. each virtue is the means of producing the next. But it is difficult to capture this nuance in an English translation which can also reproduce the form of the sorites without awkwardness. The usual English rendering, "add to your faith virtue" (AV [the KJV]) is not what the Greek says.[137]

In his translation, Bauckham translates verse 5 as "*For this very reason make every effort, by your faith to produce virtue, by virtue knowledge*."[138]

Green gives more information concerning this Greek word ἐπιχορηγήσατε ("supply"; see also Bauckham's definition above). Green says that this word was a metaphor from Athenian drama festivals where a rich individual (called "χορηγός") would join "the poet and the states in putting on the plays" because he (or she) would fund the chorus.[139] Despite the great financial costs, these rich individuals would compete "with one another in the generosity of their equipment and training of the choruses."[140] So Green concludes, "The Christian must engage in this sort of co-operation with God in the production of a Christian life which is a credit to him."[141] In this, Green may go further than Peter's intent with the word, "supply," but such a metaphor is helpful in better understanding the cultural connotations Peter may have been working within.

This word, as Bauckham noted, is also used in verse 11. There is a possible connection Peter is making by using this word for "supply"

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136. Also three times in 2 Cor 9:10 along with Gal 3:5 and Col 2:19. So Mayor in J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 90.

137. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 184.

138. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 172.

139. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 86.

140. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 86. Mayor sums ἐπιχορηγήσατε by stating, "The simple verb means literally to be χορηγός, *i.e.* (in the first sense) one who leads the chorus, (in its second sense) one who defrays the cost of the chorus, and then, generally, one who supplies the costs for any purpose." See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 90. See also T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 299.

141. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 86.

in verses 5 and 11: Christians "supply" (and work on adding) these virtues and God will "supply" the entrance into His kingdom.[142]

Green comments on this list, stating, "The practice of making lists of virtues was already well established among the Stoics, who called it a [προκοπή], 'moral advance'."[143] Green quotes Bo Reicke who clarified that Peter was not trying to make the church more Hellenistic but, instead, he was employing "'such expressions because they would be familiar to his readers.'"[144] According to Mayor, similar lists can be found in Rom 5:3f; James 1:3f; Rom 8:29f; and 10:14.[145]

Bauckham notes the difficulty of trying to see how the next virtue comes from the previous.[146] He states, "We must conclude that we are dealing with a conventional form, based on the notion that the virtues are interconnected so that in the virtuous life one develops out of another" and "The order in which the virtues are listed is largely random."[147]

"FAITH." This word "occurs in Christian ethical lists (meaning either 'faith' or 'faithfulness') in Gal 5:22; 1 Tim 4:12; 6:11; 2 Tim 2:22; Titus 2:2; Rev 2:19…and occupies first place in the lists in 1 Cor 8:7; 2 Tim 3:10."[148] Bauckham sees this "faith" as the faith "in the gospel which is the basis of all Christian life."[149] This is the basis for all other virtues listed.[150] Interestingly, Bauckham notes that here is a reference to the beginning of verse 3. The "knowledge of Christ," he

142. So J. Copeland, "II Peter 1 – Spiritual Growth," minute 16:09.

143. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 86.

144. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 86. So Schreiner, "We should note that some of the virtues featured here are common in Greco-Roman culture, providing another indication that Peter drew some connections with the social world of his readers." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 299. For more on Hellenistic influence in 2 Peter, see the "Hellenism" section under "2 Peter Sources" in the introduction to the letter.

145. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 90.

146. Contra M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 86ff and J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 90ff, however on p. 91 he says, "It is not quite so clear that each of the series is in like manner dependent on that which immediately precedes, though this would suit 1, 2, and 7."

147. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 185.

148. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 185. Note also that Green sees Romans 5:1-5 as giving faith "the primary position." See M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 86.

149. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 185.

150. Mayor notes, "Since faith is the root of the Christian life (Eph. 2:8…), the other virtues may be said to be contained in it." See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 91.

says, "is received by faith."[151] As noted above, I disagree with Bauckham on his interpretation of verse 3a, but if he is right, then he is probably also right about this connection.

Schreiner says about "faith," "Some commentators maintain that Peter referred to 'the faith' here, so that he meant by 'faith' Christian doctrine" but goes to say that "personal faith or trust" is likely what Peter was referring to.[152]

"MORAL EXCELLENCE." This Greek word, ἀρετήν, is also used in 1:3. It is also translated "virtue." The other place in the NT that this word appears in a Christian list of virtues is Phil 4:8.[153] Bauckham comments that this word is a normal Greek word in moral philosophy. Its general sense is "virtue."[154] He prefers to leave this word in its general sense instead of trying to pinpoint a more precise meaning, reasoning, "Catalogues such as this often contain very general terms alongside more specific ones."[155]

Green comments that this word "means 'excellence', and was used to denote the proper fulfilment of anything. The excellence of a knife is to cut, of a horse is to run."[156] Green thinks that the idea, in connection with its usage in verse 3 about Christ's character, has to do with believers becoming like Christ.[157] "In a word, his life must reflect something of the attractive character of Christ. For he [Christ] was the man *par excellence*, the proper man. True human excellence, then, is the manliness which is Christlikeness."[158] How does this connect with faith, then? Green says that the way one encounters Christ's character is by faith.[159]

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151. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 185.

152. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 298-299. He goes on, "Trusting God is the root from which all other virtues spring. Those who rely on God and his promises begin to live a new way."

153. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 185.

154. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 185. While Mayor agrees that "virtue" is its more general sense, he translates the word as "moral energy" and then states later on, "Since it [ἀρετήν] is here simply one in a series of virtues, this seems better than to take it in the more general sense of virtue." See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 92.

155. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 186.

156. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 87.

157. Green says, "Here he claims that the same quality of life is to be worked out in the character of the believer." See M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 87. So also Jady Copeland, "Add to Your Faith – Excellence." Sermon audio, Lakeview church of Christ, November 3, 2024, https://www.lakeviewchurchofchrist.org/sermons/sermons/2024/11/03/add-to-your-faith-excellence, minute 5:30.

158. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 87.

159. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 87.

It may also be helpful to note that Christians ought not develop a "helpless mentality" when it comes to spirituality and growth. There can be a tendency among Christians to view themselves *only* through the lens of Luke 18:9-14 and forget that God wants to do more with us than to become sinners disheartened by their sins.[160] He wants us to become ἀρετήν.

"AND IN YOUR MORAL EXCELLENCE, KNOWLEDGE[161]." Green notes that "Christianity…is not merely a matter of personal faith and practical goodness; the intellectual element in our personalities has an important place."[162] Schreiner sees this "knowledge" as probably "the knowledge of God's will and ways that are necessary for every Christian."[163]

Perhaps another helpful thing to note is that the "knowledge" a Christian needs is knowledge of God's will (to use Green's language) found in His word. To have godly knowledge, one must continually be studying the Scriptures and see what it reveals about God, His will, and His expectations for His people.[164]

Bauckham comments on "knowledge," saying that it also occurs in 2 Cor 6:6; 8:7.[165] He goes on to write,

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160. So J. Copeland, "Add to Your Faith Excellence," minute 24:48.

161. Green notes, "It is not certain whether [γνῶσις], the word used here, is significantly different in meaning from [ἐπίγνωσις] employed there [in verse 2]. If there is a difference, the nuance of [γνῶσις] would be 'sagacity', 'practical wisdom.' … wisdom 'which distinguishes the good from the bad, and shows the way of flight from the bad' (cf. Heb. 5:14)." See M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 87. In the citation, he quotes Bengel. So also Schreiner, who critiques Bauckham, stating, "Bauckham separates too neatly [ἐπίγνωσις] from [γνῶσις], saying that the former relates to conversion and the latter relates to progress in discernment for Christian living. There is some truth in this characterization, but it should be noted that progress in all these moral virtues is necessary for one's heavenly inheritance, and hence progress in knowledge is necessary, ultimately, for eternal life." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 299-300. See also P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 179-180. He says on p. 180, "Knowledge, including knowledge of Scripture, that is not turned into practical action, does not produce the character of God/Jesus in one's life, is worth than useless, for it can blind one to his or her true sorry state."

162. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 87.

163. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 299.

164. So Lee Wildman, "Add to Your Faith – Knowledge," Sermon audio, Lakeview church of Christ, November 17, 2024, https://www.lakeviewchurchofchrist.org/sermons/sermons/2024/11/17/add-to-your-faith-knowledge, minute 19:50. Similarly, Cantrell notes that one cannot know what true "moral excellence" is unless they have real knowledge. See Andy Cantrell and Ben Hall, "2 Peter 1:1-15 - Partakers of the Divine Nature," *BibleABCs with Andy Cantrell and Ben Hall,* June 3, 2025, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8bpzjZxEVT8, minute 19:02.

165. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 186.

> γνῶσις ("knowledge") is not here that fundamental knowledge of God in Christ which makes a person a Christian; for 2 Peter that is ἐπίγνωσις [which is a different word translated "knowledge"]. γνῶσις here is the wisdom and discernment which the Christian needs for a virtuous life and which is progressively acquired. It is practical rather than purely speculative wisdom (cf. Phil 1:9).[166]

As stated in the footnote on "knowledge" in verse 5 above, Schreiner sees Bauckham here making too wide a distinction between these two words translated "knowledge" in 2 Peter. It seems to me that Bauckham is on the right track, but Schreiner is right to not fully remove the "knowledge" required for eternal life.

6 "AND IN YOUR KNOWLEDGE, SELF-CONTROL." The more one knows, the higher the demand for self-control in all areas of life. The more one knows about God and His will, the more responsibility to obey Him. The more wisdom one has, the more one needs self-control to influence situations among family, friends, and colleagues. One must ask, "What is the best decision I can make right now?" and do that.[167] Self-control is an important quality for a Christian. The idea of self-control is present in 1 Peter 1:14.

Bauckham notes that "self-control" also appears in Gal 5:23.[168] In other forms, Acts 24:25; 1 Cor 7:9; 9:25.[169] Between discussions of the word's usage in Hellenistic, Stoic circles and the NT references, Bauckham says, "It was often, but not exclusively, associated with sexual restraint."[170] He concludes, "The Christian, too, needed to be self-disciplined and not indulge his physical desires to excess. It is perhaps worth noticing that in Gal 5:23 it occurs in the context of warning against the misuse of Christian freedom in libertinism (Gal 5:13), which is also the problem in 2 Peter (2:19)."[171]

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166. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 186.

167. So L. Wildman, "Add to Your Faith – Self-Control," Sermon audio, Lakeview church of Christ, November 24, 2024, https://www.lakeviewchurchofchrist.org/sermons/sermons/2024/11/24/add-to-your-faith-self-control, minute 34:50. I subtitled "best" for Wildman's "most excellent."

168. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 186.

169. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 186.

170. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 186.

171. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 186.

Green here, as he has been through his commentary thus far, connects "knowledge" and "self-control" here to the false teachers soon to be mentioned in chapter 2. He says, "They [the false teachers] claimed that knowledge released them from the need for self-control (2:10ff; 3:3). Peter emphasized that true knowledge leads on to self-control."[172] Whether Green is right concerning the direct connection to the false teachers is up in the air (note 2:12), but his sentiment is helpful.[173] Atheists see "knowledge" as that which releases one from the need of God—"If only you knew and followed science." Green is right that Peter here shows that *true* knowledge leads to self-control. When one learns about God and His word, he or she will become motivated to obey Him.

"AND IN YOUR SELF-CONTROL, PERSEVERANCE." The next clear step is "perseverance." It is not enough to simply gain knowledge and exercise some self-control. One must *continue* to do so and thus grow in it.[174] Perseverance is the quality that causes all of the rest to continue and not end. It is easy to be godly, kind, loving, self-control, knowledgeable (or working to gain it), excellent, and faithful when life is a walk-in-the-park. But what happens when it is not? How do one continue to stay faithful even when life is difficult? To say it another way, how does one avoid being the rocky ground (cf. Matt 13:5-6, 20-21)? Without perseverance, all the other qualities become obsolete when the reality of life sets in. Satan is wrong, Christians *can* endure despite the difficulties they may face in this life.[175]

The word here for "perseverance" (ὑπομονή) is twice (in the NT) used alongside the word "long-suffering" (also translated "patience"; μακροθυμία): Col 1:11; 2 Tim 3:10. μακροθυμία is also used in 1 Peter 3:20 and 2 Peter 3:15. Perhaps one can see a connection between the two terms.[176]

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172. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 88.

173. Schreiner agrees with Green, stating, "A sideways glace is cast here at the false teachers, for their lives are marked by dissolution and licentiousness." He goes on to mention 2:2, 10, 13, 14, and 19 as proof of this. See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300.

174. So also J. Copeland, "Add Steadfastness to Your Self-Control," Sermon audio, Lakeview church of Christ, December 1, 2024, https://www.lakeviewchurchofchrist.org/sermons/sermons/2024/12/01/add-steadfastness-to-your-self-control, minute 16:03.

175. J. Copeland, "Add Steadfastness to Your Self-Control," minute 23:58.

176. So J. Copeland, "Add Steadfastness to Your Self-Control," minute 10:46.

Bauckham notes that this word is found in Rom 5:3-4; 1 Tim 6:11; 2 Tim 3:10; Titus 2:2; and Rev 2:19 (Mayor sees Heb 11:27 too. For more, see Schreiner below).[177] He states, "The word refers to courageous and steadfast endurance in the face of suffering or evil, and as such was a recognized virtue in Hellenistic culture," but it was also important in Jewish and Christian circles: "In Jewish and early Christian usage the endurance is associated not with personal bravery or Stoic detachment, but with the believer's trust in God and hope for the fulfillment of God's promises."[178]

Green says, "From the habit of self-control spring *perseverance*, the temper of mind which is unmoved by difficulty and distress, and which can withstand the two Satanic agencies of opposition from the world without and enticement from the flesh within. The mature Christian does not give up."[179] Green goes on to say about the mature Christian, "His Christianity is like the steady shining of a star rather than the ephemeral brilliance (and speedy eclipse) of a meteor. There are few more reliable tests of faith than this; true faith endures (cf. Rom. 5:1-3; Mark 13:13)."[180] Green sees perseverance here as deeply connected with what has come before in this chapter. When a Christian experiences verses 3-4, has faith and knowledge (verse 5), then all these produce "in the Christian a deepened awareness of a Father's wise and loving hand controlling all that happens. Like Jesus himself, who for the joy set before him endured the cross (Heb. 12:2), we are enabled to see our apparent misfortunes in the calm light of eternity."[181] There may be something to Mayor's point, as citated and explained by Green. Mayor sees a connection between Peter and Aristotle here. "'Self-control,' says Aristotle, 'is concerned with pleasures … and endurance with sorrows; for the man who can endure and put up with hardships, he is the real example of endurance.'"[182]

177. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 186. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 92.

178. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 186.

179. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 88.

180. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 88.

181. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 88-89. Note the slight hint here of Calvinism in the statement about God "controlling all that happens." However, the sentiment of the quotation is correct.

182. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 89. Note: In Mayor's commentary, his citation of Aristotle is in Greek. Here is the entry: "It corresponds to the Aristotelian καρτερία, which is distinguished from ἐγκράτεια in *Magn. Mor.* ii. 6. 34 ἡ μὲν ἐγκράτειά ἐστι περὶ ἡδονὰς καὶ ὁ ἐγκρατὴς ὁ κρατῶν

Schreiner adds more verses to what Bauckham cites (see above). Schreiner's list includes Rom 5:3-4; 8:25; Col 1:11; 1 Thess 1:3-4; 1 Tim 6:11; 2 Tim 3:10; Titus 2:2; Heb 12:1; James 1:3-4; 5:11; Rev 2:2-3, 19.[183] Here Schreiner sees a connection with the false teachers, stating, "The opponents were threatening the church, attracting others to follow them (2:2), so that some who began in the way of the gospel had since abandoned it (2:20-22). Moral restraint must be combined with endurance and steadfastness for those who hope to win the eschatological prize."[184]

"AND IN YOUR PERSEVERANCE, GODLINESS." The more one perseveres, continues growing in faith, in knowledge, and in self-control, the godlier he or she becomes. The idea of "godliness" here may be connected with "divine nature" (verse 4).[185] See notes there. We are becoming *like* God.[186] It so also found in 1 Tim 6:11.[187]

Another way of looking at the connection between perseverance and godliness is to "godliness" as a quality of "perseverance." What I mean is this: there are a lot of people who persevere through difficulty in life. However, many turn to *un*godly means to do so (e.g., alcohol, drugs, immorality, etc.). Christians must be careful what (and/or who) their source of motivation (and strength) is. Is one persevering for the right reasons and using the right "methods"? Is their end goal something godly or selfish and/or sinful?[188]

τῶν ἡδονῶν, ἡ δὲ καρτερία περὶ λύπας· ὁ γὰρ καρτερῶν καὶ ὑπομένων τὰς λύπας, οὗτος καρτερικός ἐστιν." See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 92. Green helpfully translates this as seen above.

183. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300.

184. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300.

185. If one takes the position that the "us" of verse 3 is not a reference to (only) the apostles, then one may connect this "godliness" to the "godliness" there. So T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300. Schreiner states there, "Christ has given believers everything to be godly, and yet believers must pursue godliness."

186. Bauckham here notes that this term for "godliness" (εὐσεβείαν) has a "very general meaning." See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 187. Green sees it as "a very practical awareness of God in every aspect of life." See M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 89. Schriener says, "The term godliness refers to piety or, more simply, to living a life that is like God." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300. Fisher says that it is less the idea of "being like God" and more the idea of "respect for God" and "desire to please Him." See G. Fisher, "II Peter 1," minute 46:40.

187. So Bauckham, R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 187.

188. So Cantrell in A. Cantrell and B. Hall, "2 Peter 1:1-15 - Partakers of the Divine Nature," minute 22:21.

Green notes that this word for "godliness" (εὐσεβείαν) "was the primary word for 'religion' in popular pagan usage."[189] He continues, "The 'religious man' of antiquity, both in Greek and Latin usage (where the equivalent word was *pietas*), was careful and correct in performing his duties both to gods and men."[190] Green, as he has for many of the previous qualities on this list, sees a connection with the false teachers.[191] The false teachers, according to Green, were not "proper in their behavior both to God and their fellow men. Peter is at pains to emphasize that true knowledge of God (which they mistakenly boasted they possessed) manifests itself in reverence towards him and respect towards men."[192]

Schreiner connects the need for godly living with 2 Peter 3:11. If Christ is coming back then Christians must prepare by living properly.[193] He also notes that this word is used in the Pastoral Epistles (1 Tim 2:2; 3:16; 4:7–8; 6:3, 5–6, 11; 2 Tim 3:5; Titus 1:1).[194] He rightly concludes, "Once again it [εὐσεβείαν] was a virtue prized in Hellenistic society, indicating that Peter appropriated and recast a cultural ideal in a Christian framework."[195]

Davids writes, "The point is that this virtue indicates appropriate respect and reverence toward the deity and those associated with him or her (something that is decidedly lacking in the teachers opposed in ch. 2; cf. 2:10-12); which is also expressed in respect to those relationships he has sanctioned."[196]

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189. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 89.

190. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 89.

191. So also Mayor: "No doubt εὐσέβεια here, as in *v.* 3, is in tacit opposition to the ἀσεβεῖς [(ungodly)] against whom a large part of the epistle is directed." See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 92.

192. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 89. An interesting note that Green makes in a footnote on p. 89: "Barclay appropriately cites Xenophon's (highly imaginative!) description of Socrates at this juncture, to illustrate the noblest conception of [*εὐσεβείαν*] to be found in the pagan world. 'He was so pious and devoutly religious that he would take no step apart from the will of heaven; so just and upright that he never did even a trifling injury to any living soul; so self-controlled, so temperate, that he never at any time chose the sweeter instead of the better; so sensible, so wise, and so prudent that in distinguishing the better from the worse he never erred' (*Memorabilia* i. 5. 8–11). It is something of this type of character which Peter means to delineate by the comprehensive word, [*εὐσεβείαν*]."

193. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300.

194. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300.

195. See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300.

196. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 181.

7 "AND IN YOUR GODLINESS, BROTHERLY KINDNESS[197]."
Godliness and brotherly kindness are two very connected ideas in the NT. It appears in different forms, such as the two greatest commandments (Matt 22:36-40 and Mark 12:28-34), 1 John 4:20-21, and possibly even the parable of the sheep and goats in that those who do not help Jesus' brothers are actually failing to help Him (Matt 25:31-46). One's relationship with God and character are important but there is more to Christianity than that. Do not forget to care for fellow Christians and treat them well.

Bauckham writes that φιλαδελφίαν ("brotherly kindness") is found in NT ethical lists only here and 1 Pet 3:8.[198] It is also used in Rom 12:10; 1 Thess 4:9; Heb 13:1; 1 Pet 1:22.[199]

Green recites 1 John 4:20 here and states, "But *godliness* cannot exist without *brotherly kindness*…. Love for Christian brethren is a distinguishing mark of true discipleship, and represents yet another area where the false teachers were so distressingly deficient."[200] He says, "Love for the brethren entails bearing one another's burdens, and so fulfilling the law of Christ; it means guarding that Spirit-given unity from destruction by gossip, prejudice, narrowness, and the refusal to accept a brother Christian for what he is in Christ."[201] He concludes, "The very importance and the difficulty of achieving this *[φιλαδελφίαν]* is the reason for the considerable stress on it in the pages of the New Testament (Rom. 12:10; 1 Thess. 4:9; Heb. 13:1; 1 Pet. 1:22; 1 John 5:1)."[202]

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197. Mayor comments, "The 'brotherly kindness' of the A. V. [the KJV] may not be an exact equivalent of the untranslatable φιλαδελφία, but it might easily be explained by a marginal note. In profane Greek (including Josephus *Ant.* iv. 2. 4 where Moses' feeling for Aaron is called φιλαδελφία) φιλάδελφος and φιλαδελφία are only used literally of the affection between actual brothers. Among the Israelites patriotism was so strong that they regarded one another as brothers (see my note on James 1:2) and thus φιλάδελφος is found with a wider meaning in 2 Macc. 15:14." See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 93. Schreiner along the same vein, "The focus is on the love between fellow believers, on the family-like devotion that should characterize the Christian community." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 301. Thus Davids is helpful here: "The NIV translation 'brotherly kindness' is unfortunate and restricting, and 'familial love' or 'kinship affection' would be better, as long as we understand that 'family' and 'kin' mean fellow Christians rather than blood relatives." See P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 183.

198. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 187.

199. So R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 187.

200. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 89-90.

201. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 90.

202. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 90.

Davids includes some ancient apologists who wrote that the world hated Christians because of their "brotherly-kindness" (Lucian, *Peregrinus* 13; Minucius Felix, *Oct.* 31.8; and Tertullian, *Apology* 39).[203] Felix wrote: "Thus we love one another, to your regret, with a mutual love, because we do not know how to hate. Thus we call one another, to your envy, brethren: as being men born of one God and Parent, and companions in faith, and as fellow-heirs in hope."[204]

"AND IN YOUR BROTHERLY KINDNESS, LOVE." Schreiner sees "brotherly kindness" and the next virtue as both dealing with love.[205] He notes that "love is the supreme Chrisitan virtue" so it makes perfect sense for that to be the climax.[206] He points to the false teachers of chapter 2 and states that they were not so loving (2:13-14, 17).[207] He also notes 1 Tim 1:5, 1 Cor 13:1-13 (esp. verse 13), and Col 3:14.[208] He concludes, "Anyone who loves will possess the other qualities Peter mentioned. The false teachers are lacking in faith and love and hence are not genuine believers at all."[209]

Bauckham connects "love" here with 2 Cor 6:6; Gal 5:22; Eph 4:2; 1 Tim 4:12; 6:11; 2 Tim 2:22; 3:10; Titus 2:2; and Rev 2:19, including a list where "faith" begins it and "love" ends it in 1 Cor 8:7.[210] He helpfully states, "The final member of the series comprises all the others. Similarly, in 2 Peter, love, as the crowning virtue, encompasses all the others."[211]

This love here seems to be an all-encompassing term for both love for God and love for others. Love is a term that has been unfortunately highjacked by modern culture. True love is deeper and stronger than the way modern culture uses it. Love is sacrifice; it is service; it is a way of life; and it is God Himself (1 John 4:8; see also the surrounding verses); not "acceptance," "tolerance," or "celebration." Davids writes, "The important point to keep in mind is that love is a

203. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 183.
204. M. Felix as qtd in P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 183.
205. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300.
206. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300.
207. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 301.
208. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 301.
209. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 300.
210. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 187.
211. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 187.

virtue, not an emotion," including reference to 1 Cor 13 which teaches "about what love does, how it acts, *not* how it feels."[212]

Schreiner helpfully concludes,

> Paul said love is the goal of Christian instruction (1 Tim 1:5). It is the most excellent way (1 Cor 12:31–13:13), the virtue that sums up all other virtues (Col 3:14). Anyone who loves will possess the other qualities Peter mentioned. The false teachers are lacking in faith and love and hence are not genuine believers at all.[213]

8 "FOR IF THESE QUALITIES ARE YOURS AND ARE INCREASING." Notice the important wording here. "Are yours" and "are increasing." The goal is not just to gain these qualities ("are yours") but to keep growing in them ("are increasing"). This is the same line of exhortation that Peter uses in 3:17-18. See comments there. The work of a Christian is rarely a one-time event. Instead, Christians are often called to live a life of continual action and growth. This is because God does not just want a "one time in my life" kind of people. Relationships are almost never built on a "one time event." Instead, they are built, changed, and improved over a long process of ups and downs, with the final product being the desired result.[214]

Mayor notes that the word for "increasing" (πλεονάζω),

> in classical writers is a term of disparagement, implying excess, to be, or to have, more than enough, to exaggerate. In the N.T. (except in 2 Cor. 8:15…which is a quotation from Exod. 16:18) it is eulogistic, implying increase or abundance of what is good, as in 2 Cor. 4:15…Phil. 4:17…2 Th. 1:3…Rom. 5:20.[215]

Schreiner also notes about this idea of "increasing," rightly cautioning against the unnecessary interpretation that "increasing" here means that "we are able to calculate our improvement" of these

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212. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 184. Italics added.

213. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 301.

214. Green rightly states, "There is no excuse for resting content with present attainment. Lack of spiritual growth is a sign of spiritual death. Nor is there any room for indolence and the slackening of effort ([*ἀργός*]); otherwise the Christian becomes *unproductive*, like the wheat choked by weeds (the cares, riches and pleasures of life) which produces no fruit ([*ἀκάρπους*])." See M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 91.

215. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 93.

qualities, "as if we become five percent more loving each year."[216] Instead, Schreiner says, "His [Peter's] point was that godly qualities must both exist and overflow in the lives of his readers."[217]

"THEY RENDER YOU NEITHER USELESS NOR UNFRUITFUL." The qualities of verses 5-7, when worked at relentlessly (verse 8a), change Christians. They work to change sinners or newly-redeemed into useful, productive, holy people, fit for God's service. God is not calling sinners to become simply "freshen up" their lives by water, but to be completely transformed into something that is fruitful and useful to God and His purposes. When one lives as God calls, he or she can be used by Him for great things.

Bauckham notes that "This phrase (literally, "they make you neither idle nor unfruitful") employs the figure of speech litotes: affirming an idea by denying its opposite. It cannot be literally reproduced in English."[218] Also, "useless" and "unfruitful" are "two words are "one of 2 Peter's pairs of nearly synonymous words."[219] He goes on to say, "Both words were used in early Christianity in the context of the need for Christian faith to have ethical effects in the Christian's life."[220] He goes on to note a handful of verses for each word. For "useless" he notes James 2:20. For "unfruitful," Prov 19:22 LXX; Matt 3:8, 10; 21:43; Mark 4:20; Luke 13:6–9; John 15:2–8; Gal 5:22; Eph 5:9; Col 1:10; Heb 2:11; Jas 3:18; and Titus 3:14, which is a similar usage to the one here in 2 Peter.[221]

Schreiner shows how to flip the negative statement Peter made into the positive: "When the virtues both exist and abound in believers, believers are effective and fruitful with respect to their knowledge of Christ."[222] He goes on to say that this word for "useless" "is used of idle workers who are wasting their day in the marketplace instead of working (Matt 20:3, 6). James said that faith without works is 'idle' or 'ineffective' [also translated, 'useless'] (Jas 2:20)."[223] He also mentions

216. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 302.
217. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 302.
218. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 188.
219. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 188.
220. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 188.
221. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 188.
222. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 302.
223. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 302.

Matt 13:22, Jude 12, and Col 1:10.[224] Schreiner here sees a connection to the false teachers of chapter 2, "The ineffectiveness and unfruitfulness relate to their knowledge ([*ἐπίγνωσις*]) of the Lord Jesus Christ. Perhaps the opponents are particularly in view, for their libertine lifestyle contradicts their profession of faith. Peter likely meant that they give no evidence that their conversion is genuine."[225]

"IN THE TRUE KNOWLEDGE OF OUR LORD JESUS CHRIST." While this phrase is not identical to the phrase in 1:2, it is easy to remember while reading 1:8.[226] While not saying too much of the Greek preposition "εἰς," it is interesting that this is the term used here, unlike 1:2, where "ἐν" was used. This preposition makes sense to be used here, since it is the idea of "into" or "in."[227] It is the idea of one thing going into another. In Greek textbooks such as Mounce's, often εἰς is visualized as a line going into a circle, signifying the *into* idea.[228] So if the εἰς of verse 8 should be emphasized, the idea would be that the qualities of verses 5-7 help us in developing and growing in the *true* knowledge of Jesus. Perhaps the illustration of water being poured *into* a glass would sufficiently demonstrate the thought.[229]

The NASB95 uses the word "true" to qualify what kind of knowledge Peter is referring to. However, the Greek lacks this word (see ESV). The NASB95, thus, adds this word. But it is helpful here. As has been noted thus far in this section, there appears to be (at least)

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224. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 302.

225. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 303.

226. In the Greek, 1:2 reads, "ἐν ἐπιγνώσει τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ Ἰησοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν,"while 1:8 reads, "εἰς τὴν τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ ἐπίγνωσιν" (NA28). Young's Literal translates 1:2, "in the acknowledgement of God and of Jesus our Lord," and 1:8, "in regard to the acknowledging of our Lord Jesus Christ." Interestingly, some read 1:2 as a reference to Jesus as God, which would make this connection stronger. See comments at 1:2 along with text-critical discussion on pp. 688989ff.

227. William D. Mounce, *Basics of Biblical Greek Grammar*, 4th ed. (Grand Rapids: Zondervan, 2019), 62. Mounce says there, "In Classical Gerek there was less overlap in meaning between εἰς ("into") and ἐν ("in"), but in Koine Greek [the Greek of the NT] there is more. *Eisegesis* is poor hermeneutical practice between it reads a meaning *into* the text instead of drawing it out of (*exegesis*) the text." However, Schreiner footnotes on "in their knowledge of Christ," "The word εἰς means 'in.' The use of εἰς for ἐν is typical of Hellenistic Greek." See T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 302, footnote 61.

228. See W. Mounce, *Basics of Biblical Greek Grammar*, 75.

229. Mayor says uses two illustrative sentences to explain εἰς: "'his prolonged and laborious studies were fruitful for the advance (or the attainment) of knowledge' or 'bore fruit in knowledge,' where 'in' expressive of result would be equivalent to the Greek εἰς." See J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 95.

some references and critiques of the false teachers of chapter 2. Here may be another instance of that. Peter tells Christians that if they act as they ought, they will gain *true* knowledge, unlike the false teachers who may claim to have knowledge but do not.[230] This true knowledge would become vitally important because soon Peter will die and not be able to continue to help his audience. They need not only to remember but to grow so that they can face these trials without him (1:12-15; cf. 3:1-2, 14-18).[231]

Davids discusses the disagreements between the interpretations of Bauckham and Mayor concerning the use of εἰς. The two interpretations can be summed up as "knowledge of… Christ" being either (1) knowledge at conversion or (2) deeper knowledge gained from growing in virtue.[232] Either εἰς means "in" or "into." If "in," then it is the idea of "with reference to" / "with respect to." If "into," then, "resulting in."[233] Davids notes Peter's usage of both ἐν and εἰς, commenting that the former is used forty-three times while the later eleven, but of those eleven, "eight point forward in time or reward to results and are thus traditional, while in 1:17 and 3:9 we have uses that are close to what is claimed for the first meaning here."[234]

Bauckham notes that "most commentators take this phrase to refer to the goal or product of the virtues: virtuous conduct leads to fuller knowledge of Christ" while others see "the knowledge of Christ to be the root from which moral progress proceeds."[235] Bauckham comments, "Through the knowledge of Christ he has given Christians

230. So M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 91. Green see this "knowledge" as spanning the life of a believer, from conversion to Judgment Day; thus, he connects 1:8 with 1 Peter 1:8 and Phil 3:10.

231. So J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 94. He also connects 1:8 with Col 1:6f

232. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 185.

233. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 185.

234. P. Davids, *2 Peter and Jude*, 185, footnotes 49-50. In footnote 50, Davids helpfully notes that the voice from heaven in 1:17 uses εἰς, contra the Gospel narratives (Matt 3:16[-17]; 17:5; Mark 1:9; Luke 3:22). This to me is a clear indication of the first interpretation mentioned above. However, I believe the second interpretation better explains the text.

235. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 188. "The latter is possible if εἰς has the vague sense 'with reference to,' 'in respect to,' which is possible in the Koine, and is required by 2 Peter's use of ἐπίγνωσις for the knowledge gained in Christian conversion…as well as by the general sense of the passage." See pp. 188-189. Cf. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 302, and footnote 63, where Schreiner seems to agree with the latter interpretation of the function of "knowledge" in this passage.

everything necessary for godly life (v 3); if they exercise the virtues, this knowledge will be fruitful."[236]

Mayor states, "It is surely a mistake to suppose that the writer of our epistle regarded the knowledge of God and Christ as merely the first step toward a holy life."[237] To Mayor, it is incorrect to see as verses 2-4 as coming out of one's knowledge, "but only that they are capable of being multiplied in and through knowledge."[238] Thus, "each step forward in the Christian life deepens and widens our knowledge and makes that knowledge more effectual in moulding our conduct."[239]

9 "FOR HE WHO LACKS THESE QUALITIES IS BLIND OR SHORT-SIGHTED." For Peter, it does not make any sense for a Christian to not have (or be working to have) the qualities of verses 5-7. He calls him or her "blind" and "short-sighted." "Blind" in Greek has some similar connotations as in English. A person can be physically blind or mentally (in the sense that one cannot understand something).[240] The latter is clearly closer to what Peter means. These people cannot truly see straight.

"Short-sighted" is a *hapax legomena*[241] term which means "closing or contracting the eyes" (squinting).[242] Louw-Nida defines it as, "To be extremely limited in one's understanding—'to fail to understand, to be restricted in understanding, to be shortsighted.' τυφλός ἐστιν μυωπάζων 'being so limited in understanding as to not realize' or '… as to not comprehend' 2 Pe 1:9."[243]

As one can see, the definitions and usages of "blind" and "short-sighted" are very similar.[244] To be blind and short-sighted is to be unable to understand—to not *see* in the metaphorical sense.

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236. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 189. For disagreement on "everything necessary for godly life," see comments on verse 3.

237. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 94-95.

238. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 95.

239. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 95.

240. See William Arndt et al., in *A Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament and Other Early Christian Literature* (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2000), 1021.

241. A term meaning, "A word which is only used here." In NT studies, *hapax legomena* means, "This word is not used anywhere else in the NT."

242. W. Arndt et al., in *A Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament and Other Early Christian Literature*, 663.

243. J. P. Louw and E. A. Nida, in *Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament: Based on Semantic Domains*, 385.

244. So R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 189. He says, "We should probably conclude that the writer uses the two words as virtually synonymous."

Bauckham notes that this metaphor for blindness is "inability or refusal to see the truth" and notes several passages where this occurs (Matt 15:14; 23:16, 24; Luke 6:39; John 9:40-41; 12:40; Rom 2:19; 2 Cor 4:[4,] 14), including two texts where it is used for Christians (1 John 2:11 and Rev 3:17).[245] Schreiner says, "They have become so shortsighted that they have forgotten the most important reality of all. The metaphor, then, could be used for rhetorical effect, not to convey a new thought."[246]

Green, unlike Bauckham and myself, makes a distinction between "blind" and "short-sighted." He notes that μυωπάζων ("short-sighted") has two meanings: short-sighted and "'to blink,' 'to shut the eyes.'"[247] Green believes Peter probably meant the second meaning. "Thus the meaning is that such a man is blind because he blinks or wilfully closes his eyes to the light."[248] This blindness occurs when a Christian *intentionally ignores* what he or she ought to be doing; namely, growing in verses 5-7.[249] However, Green does say that if Peter meant "short-sighted," the phrase would mean that the Christian "is blind to heavenly things, and engrossed in the earthly" and thus "he cannot see what is afar off, but only what is near."[250] This interpretation would make "excellent sense in view of the immorality and earthiness of the false teachers [of chapter 2]."[251]

"HAVING FORGOTTEN HIS PURIFICATION FROM HIS FORMER SINS." Peter further evaluates the Christian who is blind and short-sighted. His or her refusal to see what he or she needs to see, namely, verses 5-7, is because he or she has forgotten what Christ has done for him or her. This is one of the most common tropes in Christendom. A person turns to Christ because he or she needs salvation, only to get it and become unbelievably entitled and quickly forgetful concerning his or her old life. This person wants what Christ can give but has no real desire to give anything back.

245. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 189.
246. T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 303.
247. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 92.
248. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 92.
249. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 92. Bauckham's response to this interpretation is that "the etymological sense describes the fact that the shortsighted person screws up his eyes in his attempt to see better, not in order to avoid seeing." See R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 189; cf. J. Mayor, *The Epistles of Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 95-96; and T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 303.
250. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 92.
251. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 92.

"Forgetfulness" is a theme found in Scripture quite often. The children of Israel in Exodus, for example. One specific time was the crossing of the Red Sea, when they sang the Song of Moses, only to begin complaining three days later (Ex 15:22). One could also note all the times on the expedition to Canaan and in the Wilderness the Israelites grumbled for food, forgetting God's previous works and also the constant stream of manna before them. Forgetfulness is also, in part, why Christians partake of the Lord's Supper; Jesus said, "Remember Me" (cf. Luke 22:19; 1 Cor 11:24-25). It is understandable why this theme is so prevalent in Scripture: *people are forgetful*. It does not take much especially when our lives are hectic, plans are ever changing, and jobs take up forty hours every week. We have a lot on our minds already, so it is understandable when just even one thought goes awry. However, there are some things that just cannot ever be forgotten. Christ's saving blood is one of them; how He has brought us out of dark, hopelessness into the greatest kingdom existence has ever known. How can one forget *that*? It is easier than it seems when gratitude and the necessary meditation fall to the wayside. To forget such a wonderful gift is to say to God, "I do not really care about being forgiven."[252]

Bauckham states that this metaphor for "cleaning" originated from the OT (Lev 16:30 LXX; Job 7:21; and Ps 50:4), and also used in the NT (Titus 2:14; Heb 1:3; 9:14; 1 John 1:7, 9).[253] Then he says, "Here, as almost all commentators agree, the reference is to purification at baptism (Acts 22:16; 1 Cor 6:11; Eph 5:26; and Titus 3:5).[254] He also includes a list of verses connected to "from his former sins" (cf. Rom 3:25; Eph 2:2; 1 Pet 1:14; 4:3).[255] Bauckham warns that the Christian forgets his baptism (the start of a new, virtuous life) "is in danger of relapsing into his preChristian condition (2:22)."[256]

Green, like Bauckham, sees a connection to the event of baptism and then notes, "the man who makes no effort (v. 5) to grow in grace is

252. So T. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, 304.

253. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 190.

254. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 190. Mayor writes that the many passages he cites, the use of "former," the reference to pre-baptismal sin, and the connection to Heb 6:4-6, "prove conclusively that the writers must have had the thought of baptism in their minds." See J. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 97.

255. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 190.

256. R. Bauckham, *Jude, 2 Peter*, 190.

going back on his baptismal contract. This could be the start of apostasy."[257]

Mayor puts it like this: "One whose eye is fixed on the example of Christ, who remembers with gratitude what he has received from Christ, and looks to Him for daily supplies of the Bread of Life, cannot forget the time when he was incorporated with Him in baptism, cf. Col. 1:13, 14."[258]

257. M. Green, *2 Peter and Jude*, 92.
258. J. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter*, 96.

Glossary

Greek Words

ἀγαθωσύνη (Goodness)
ἀγάπη (Love)
ἀκάρπους (Unfruitful)
ἀναστροφή (Conduct)
ἀπόθεσις (Removal)
ἀποκάλυψις (Revelation)
ἀρετῇ (Moral excellence)
ἄσπιλος (Spotless)
αὐτοῦ (His)
γνῶσις (Knowledge)
δύναμις (Power)
ἐγκράτειαν (Self-control)
εἰς (To, into)
ἐν / ἐπ (In)
ἐπαγγέλμα (Promise)
ἐπίγνωσις (Knowledge)
ἐστιν (Is)
ἔσχἀτων (Last)
εὐσέβεια / εὐσεβείαν (Godliness)
ἡμέρων (Days)
θείος (Divine)
θεός (God)
καταρᾶς (Accursed)
λίθος (Stone)
μακροθυμία (Patience)
ὀπίσω / πορενομένους / πορεύεσθαι (lit. Go after; NASB95: Indulge)
παρουσία (Coming)
πίστις (Faith)
πλεονάζω (Increasing)
ποῦ (Where)
σαρκὸς (Flesh)
σωτῆρος (Savior)
τέκνα (Children)
τοὺς (Who)
τῶν (The)

φανεροῦν (Appears)
φθαρήσονται (Destroyed)
φθορᾷ (Destruction)
φιλαδελφία / φιλαδελφίαν (Brotherly Kindness)
χριστῷ (Christ)
ψευδεπίγραφα (pseudepigrapha)

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